

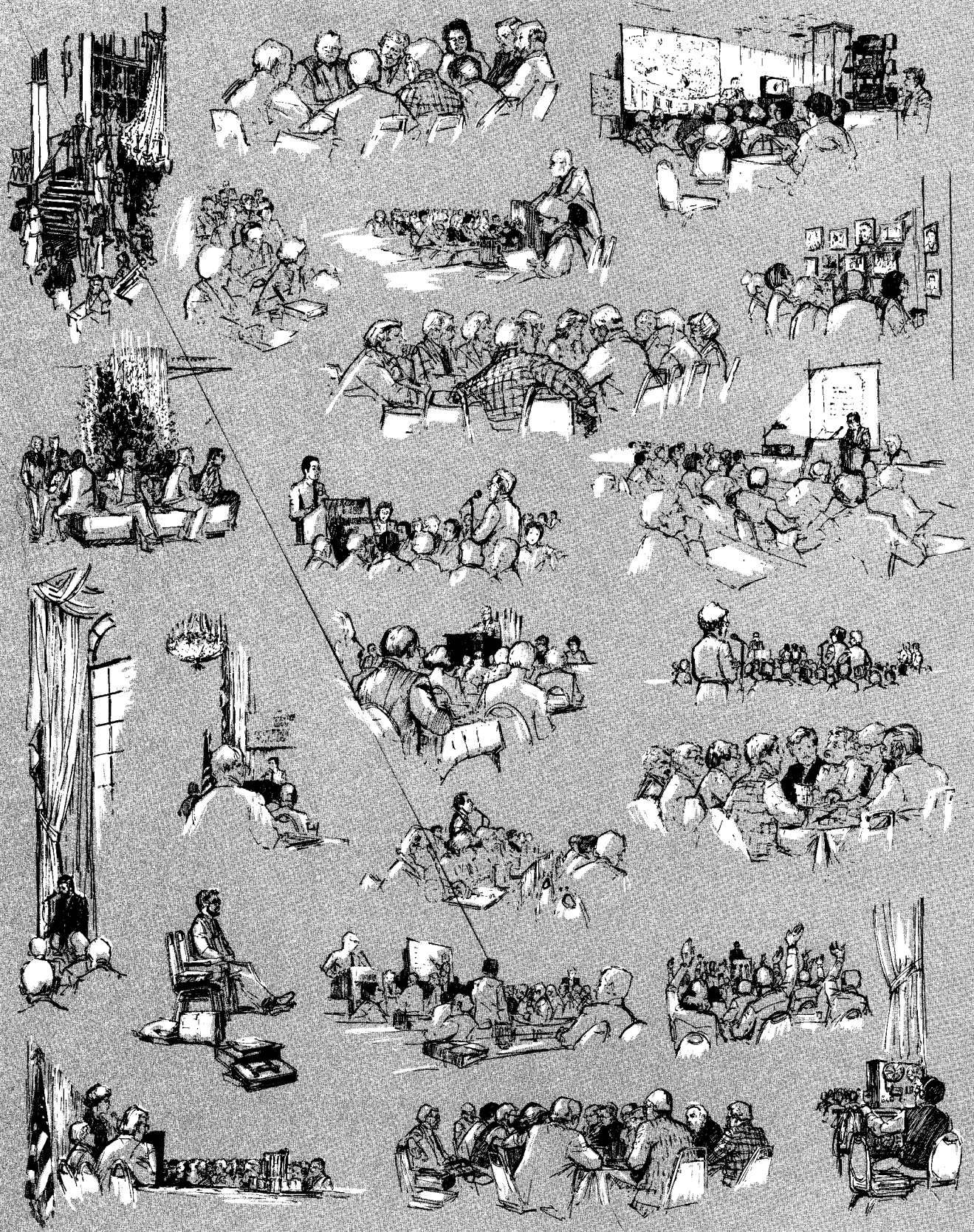
***Our Singleness of Purpose
– Key to Unity***

**THE THIRTY-EIGHTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

***1988
Final Report***

Roosevelt Hotel, New York City, April 17 – 23

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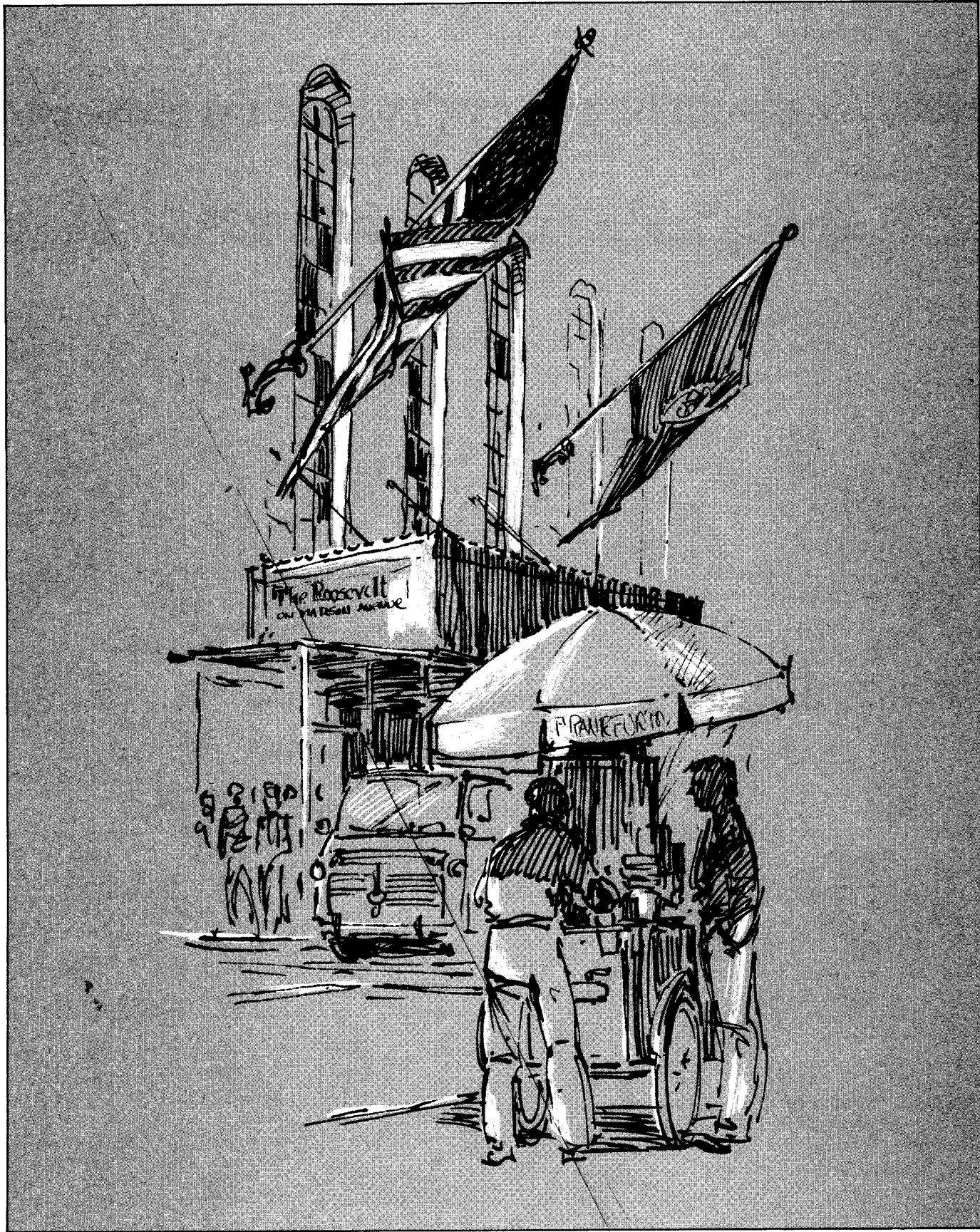
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Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage — to facilitate communication within the Fellowship — was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



38TH CONFERENCE —

“Our Singleness of Purpose — Key to Unity”

“Our Society . . . will prudently cleave to its single purpose: the carrying of the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Let us resist the proud assumption that since God has enabled us to do well in one area, we are destined to be a channel of saving grace for everybody.”

Thirty-three years after co-founder Bill Wilson addressed these words to A.A.’s Twentieth Anniversary International Convention in St. Louis, the 38th U.S./Canada General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous explored “Singleness of Purpose — Key to Unity.”

The 133 Conference members — delegates from the 91 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, and nonvoting assistants, met at the Roosevelt Hotel, New York City, April 17-23. As always, Conference week is exceedingly busy, with long, activity-packed days, informative presentations and highlights from service areas, stimulating discussions and committee meetings, and laborious, conscience-searching decisions which eventually result in Conference Advisory Actions (see page 12).

This was the first General Service Conference in quite some time to provide members with an in-house A.A. meeting. The G.S.C. Serenity Group met in the Terrace Room, Tuesday through Friday mornings. Each morning, from 7:30-8:30, a different number of sober alcoholics gathered — some in jogging clothes, some already alert, some just waking up with that first cup of coffee in hand — to begin their day reflecting and sharing with other recovering alcoholics the basic premise of Alcoholics Anonymous — one alcoholic speaking with another.

Chairperson of the Serenity Group was Norman Adams, a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board; Louise Adams, delegate from Connecticut, served as secretary. Steps Three, Seven, Ten and Eleven were the topics and delegate leaders for these meetings were, respectively, Bruce Sutherland, Colorado; Marilyn (Sam) Parsons, Western Missouri; Red Walker, Alberta/N.W.T.; and Elizabeth Currier, N.Y., Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire. Each day attendees received a raffle ticket and the winner of the drawing on Friday, Dean Rinehart from Oklahoma, accepted a Big Book. In the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, the self-supporting G.S.C. Serenity Group contributed \$134 to the General Service Office.

Another highlight of the 38th Conference was the presence of a General Service trustee from Australia, Ron Carr. After the Conference approved his presence as an observer, he presented General Service Board chairperson Gordon Patrick with a boomerang, a symbol not only of Australia, but of Bill Wilson’s singleminded determination (see “*Pass It On*,” pages 29-30). Speaking to Conference members Monday morning, Ron, 34 years sober, spoke of the privilege of seeing service in action and said that decisions made at this Conference would help to better carry the message on an international level. Later, speaking of A.A. in his country, he shared that big problems were complacency and a lack of awareness of the Legacies, Traditions and Concepts, and the need for more awareness of these through sponsorship.

The busy week began with an Easy-Does-It Sunday, when Conference members came together for the first time in the Oval Room. After registering, receiving badges and Conference Manuals, they sat at tables designated by the committees on which they would be serving. There were welcoming and introductory remarks by Helen Turnquest, G.S.O. Conference coordinator; Ruth Jagodzinski, Pacific regional trustee; and Joyce Korner, delegate chairperson from Northeastern Ohio. Delegates were then introduced; first Panel 37, serving their second and final year, and then the Panel 38 newcomers.

G.S.O. office manager, Tony Osnato, the liaison between the Conference and the Roosevelt Hotel, gave a brief rundown on the mechanics and housekeeping items and said he and his staff would see to any requests and try to solve any problems. Tony spoke of the pleasure it was for the nonalcoholic assistants to work at the Conference and that they too “got the message.” G.S.O. archivist Frank Mauser provided practical information: where to go for breakfast, the nearest drug store, how to buy a New York Lottery ticket and a biking map of Brooklyn. (No statistics are available on the number of Conference members who had time to tour Brooklyn by bike!)

A standing ovation greeted trustee emeritus Dr. John Norris. Dr. Jack, as he is fondly called, attending his 38th Conference, pointed out that he “believes in rotation.” In an easy reminiscent style, speaking from a wealth of information and long experience, Dr. Jack mesmerized his audience with a panoramic view of A.A.’s early history and pioneers. He spoke of Dr. Silkworth and his understanding of alcoholism as an illness of mind and body, and of his encouragement of Bill Wilson’s spiritual experience. He spoke of his hope of bringing co-founder Dr. Robert Smith “out of the shadows” via the Akron group bringing a Founders’ Day celebration to the east, and that all A.A.s would be recharged by such an experience. And how important it was to Bill that Dr. Bob and his wife, Anne, opened their minds, hearts and home to him. Dr. Jack reflected on the tremendous obstacles that those early A.A.s must have experienced, and the support that A.A. has received throughout its history from notable nonalcoholics including Ruth Hock, Bill’s first secretary, and treasurers Frank Amos, Archie Roosevelt and LeRoy Chipman.

Dr. Jack concluded by saying that the Conference was “an island of sanity in a world gone mad. Where else in society can this happen — an informed group conscience that is spiritually sound? I feel very secure in the future of A.A., so long as we observe the group conscience and Traditions. There is so much wisdom in the program and the people — if we will stay out of the way and let the process happen.”

Sunday evening, Conference members, past trustees and former staff members, G.S.O. and Grapevine employees, and all who have worked for the General Service Office during the year (printers, suppliers, volunteers, etc.) and their guests, attended the pre-Conference banquet in the Roosevelt’s Grand Ballroom.

After dinner John Bragg, G.S.O. general manager, introduced Bill Wilson’s beloved widow, Lois. Ninety-seven years of age, Lois remarked that she had been coming to this meeting for many years and looked forward to many more and to her 100th birthday. She told the rapt audience that Bill would be so happy to see so many joyous and smiling faces and that she and Bill, who had been together for 60 years, had had a wonderful life together. This remarkable lady concluded with, “Thank you all again for carrying on. You know, we make a big fuss about [the] people who started A.A., but more important are the people who carry on. I thank you so much; see you next year.”

The festive evening concluded with an open A.A. meeting chaired by Rita Jourdan, Eastern Missouri; Art McCord, Northeastern Ontario, led the meeting. Speakers were Lyla Bonney, G.S.O. staff; Harold Greene, A.A.W.S. director; Katherine Guy, Alabama/N.W. Florida; Ben Williams, Northern Indiana; and Jan Kelly Williamson, Southwest regional trustee.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson of the General Service Board, officially opened the 38th Conference on Monday morning, and gave a summary and overview of the board’s activities during the past year. John Bragg, G.S.O. general manager, called the roll and

presented the mechanics and procedures of the Conference. G.S.O. Conference coordinator Helen Turnquest, reviewed the agenda, followed by opening remarks from delegate chairperson Joyce Korner (see page 7). Jack Ford, Class B (alcoholic) trustee, gave the keynote address (see page 8).

Thus, the busy week was launched. Committee meetings, presentation/discussion sessions (see page 17), area highlights (see page 48), a workshop based on the Conference theme (see page 5) filled the agenda. Other items included a report by John Bragg on the Relocation Survey (see page 26), a Delegates-Only dinner and meeting, and a "What's On Your Mind?" sharing session in which delegates had an opportunity to bring up for discussion and input other matters of concern to them and the areas they represent. Another highlight of the week was the recommendation by the Site-selection Committee for the 1995 International Convention, that the four cities selected for final decision by the General Service Board be: (in alphabetical order) Atlanta, Minneapolis/St. Paul, San Diego and Toronto.

Just as rotation is the "spirit of service" at the group level, so it is on the General Service Board. On Wednesday afternoon Conference members voted to recommend the election of the following to the General Service Board: Donald Bruner, as West Central U.S. regional trustee; Phil Cels, regional trustee for Western Canada, and Desmond Towe, general service trustee. They were elected at the April 23 board meeting following the close of Conference, when the board also approved the appointment of two new directors: Fran Polek to the Grapevine Corporate Board and Hugh Freyer, A.A. World Services.

It was also rotation time for General Service Board chairperson Gordon Patrick. Gordon has served A.A. for 13 years — as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee from 1975 to 1982, when he was elected chairperson (see Closing Talk, page 10).

The board's new chairperson, approved by the board at the April 23 meeting, is Michael Alexander. No stranger to Alcoholics Anonymous, Mike served as a Class A trustee from 1976 to 1985. An attorney, he was a long-time associate of the legendary trustee Bernard Smith, referred to by Bill as "the architect of the General Service Conference."

Although the Conference — A.A.'s largest and longest business meeting — takes place only once a year, the work of the Confer-

ence goes on 365 days a year — in the groups, in the districts and areas, at the General Service Office and in the constant work of committees, from the local areas to the trustees' committees.

The 11 trustees' committees comprise trustees, directors, appointed committee members (A.A. members with expertise in a given field) and nonvoting consultants. They meet at three "board weekends" — July, October and January. There, they review suggestions, questions and concerns submitted by individual A.A. members, or sometimes by an entire area. After discussing these ideas, the trustees' committee may initiate work on a new project — such as a film, pamphlet or workbook, or the committee might wish to obtain a broader consensus from the Fellowship and submit the suggestion to its corresponding Conference committee for further discussion. Each trustees' committee submits a report of its activities to the General Service Conference. Other Conference members then take the opportunity to question, endorse or even disapprove the decisions reached by the trustees' committees during the previous year.

Conference committees' agendas consist of items forwarded by the trustees' committees as well as additional topics submitted by individual A.A. members, general service workers, or areas. After thoughtful deliberation on each agenda item each committee reports its recommendation to the entire Conference for discussion approval, or rejection. On Thursday, the delegate chairperson of each Conference committee presented the committee's recommendations. Conference members were then free to go to the floor mikes to ask questions, disagree, make suggestions or changes, and share the concerns of their area on any given issue. It is in this long, careful and arduous process — which stretched well into Thursday evening and continued through most of Friday — that the group conscience of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada emerges, resulting in the Conference Advisory Actions.

Friday afternoon following Gordon Patrick's closing talk the Conference officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in English, Spanish and French.

Friday evening was free for the hard-working Conference members to see a show, go to a ballgame, buy a Lottery ticket, or take an after-dinner nap. Many, of course, went to a local A.A. meeting.

Saturday morning Conference members came together for the last time in the Terrace Room — now stripped of its classroom-style work tables and floor mikes and set up for the closing brunch. The work was finished and now was the bittersweet time of farewells and the A.A. sharing by rotating trustees. The program was chaired by Gordon Patrick. Gordon, who through the years has always identified himself as a "still-practicing nonalcoholic," began by saying he "hadn't had a drink today yet." Delegate chairperson Joyce Korner said a few words and introduced the 1989 delegate chairperson, Herb Wales.

Everyone's new friend from Australia, Ron Carr, thanked those assembled for their love and caring. Before he had left Australia he had been told he would meet friends he hadn't met yet, "but this is ridiculous."

When Gordon introduced rotating West Central trustee Dan Byrne, Dan commented that Gordon "hadn't had a good drink yet!" Dan felt the most beautiful part of being a trustee was the spirituality that develops and commented on the "no-coincidence" aspect of how A.A.s paths continue to cross. Dan had served as trustee with three people whom he had served with as delegate, Jack Ford, Jan Kelly Williamson and Ruth Jagodzinski.



Michael Alexander and Gordon Patrick

Western Canada's rotating trustee Jack Ford said he had made 62 goodbye speeches between midnight and 6:00 a.m. — but decided in the end to just tell parts of his story, that any drunk anywhere could identify with “for it is the only thing we have that is unique and truly ours — our experience, strength and hope.” Jack spoke of going to his first A.A. meeting — angry and mixed up, and the feeling of safety that came from finding people who were genuinely happy to see him.

Rotating general service trustee Ralph Rosenberg, Jr. spoke of the importance of inventory taking — for the individual A.A. as well as for those who serve — so that we remain a part of, rather than apart from the Fellowship. Ralph thanked those assembled for allowing him to share with them “the greatest gift and joy an alcoholic can ever know — that world-class miracle called day-at-a-time sobriety.”

Before closing with the Lord's Prayer, Gordon Patrick, at the mike for the last time as a member of the board, said rotation was a wonderful thing, “I believe in it — philosophically. Every time we hold on to that ‘precious’ person we do them and us a disservice.” He cautioned, as Bill Wilson had, that we must watch over the Fellowship with eternal vigilance — “eternal vigilance with love.”

What was the “sense of the meeting” after this week-long A.A. business meeting? Victor Rosario, Panel 38 delegate from Puerto Rico, closed his Area Highlight with: “As far as I know there is no deviation in our area from our singleness of purpose. No other consideration, no other dream is prevalent.” The same might be said of the Fellowship at the close of its 38th General Service Conference.

Welcome

Last year when I came into the lobby of the Hotel Roosevelt, I wanted to turn around and go home! Never had I had such feelings of being so inadequate, scared, and what am I doing here! Why me? There were so many more that were more qualified than I. It didn't get any better as the day went on. I listened to presentations Sunday by people I didn't know. Then came coffee hour before dinner, standing around, still feeling alone and inadequate. I wanted to just run. Then dinner, herded into a room with about 300 other people, having dinner, and trying to make conversation, not too successfully! Listening to A.A. leads and not being interested. I was so glad it was over and went back to my room to pack! With my pride, I finally said to myself and God — “OK, will try another day!” It didn't get any better, just more confusing. Monday, Tuesday, more presentations — I almost fell asleep. Tuesday night at the fights and more presentations (Oh, God, is this all there is?). I felt my best when I was in with my committee; there I felt I was doing something! What I was sent here for! To share and make some decisions! Then came the committee reports and discussions! It took me until Friday morning to get the hang of how Robert's Rules worked! But somehow, after all the dust settled at the end, I felt God's presence. It was His final decision that prevailed over the 37th General Service Conference. When I left, I felt stronger and knew I had learned a lot and grown from this experience.

This year we have more sharing sessions, less workshops and presentations, and more time in committees. The Delegates-Only Meeting has been restructured, and there's even coffee and water! Robert's Rules have been sent out ahead of time; there are A.A. meetings in the mornings, and hopefully, yesterday's session was a lot more relaxing. It should be an exciting week!

Each Conference has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers. The aim of our services is to bring sobriety within the reach of *all* who want it! Clearly, our first duty to A.A.'s future is to maintain the full strength that we have now. Only the most vigilant caretaking can assure this. Never should we be lulled into complacent self-satisfaction by the wide acclaim and success that are everywhere ours. This is the subtle temptation which could render us stagnant today, perchance disintegrate us tomorrow. We have always rallied to meet and transcend failure, and critical situations have been our stimulants. How well, though, shall we be able to meet the problems of success? Are we now at this point? This Conference may become ruffled, individuals may become deeply disturbed, and with enough anger and righteous indignation both unity and purpose could be lost. My experience in A.A. has shown me that I am a bankrupt idealist who, having little sobriety, thought I had the answer to a lot of other things. What I needed to remember was that A.A. saved my life and it comes first. I must put my ego and personal ambitions aside in order to preserve the unity of A.A. as a whole. My watchword should be humility, to remain teachable. That I should be aware of the promoter instinct in myself as well as my natural desire for personal distinction as an A.A. member. I must remind myself that personal ambitions and desires have no place in this Conference. I don't want to be the person to cast my shadow on the principles of A.A. I must continually learn that the temporary or seeming good can be the deadly enemy of the permanent best. When it comes to survival for A.A., nothing short of my very best will be good enough.

Therefore, I am challenging myself and each of you to be an active guardian of our Fellowship and to embody this year's theme, “Our Singleness of Purpose — Key To Unity.” Bill expressed this so well when he wrote in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*:

“There are those who predict that A.A. may well become a new spearhead for a spiritual awakening throughout the world. When our friends say these things they are both generous and sincere. But we of A.A. must reflect that such a tribute and such a prophecy could well prove to be a heady drink for most of us — that is, if we really came to believe this to be the real purpose of A.A., and if we commenced to behave accordingly. Our society, therefore, will prudently cleave to its single purpose: the carrying of the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Let us resist the proud assumption that since God has enabled us to do well in one area we are destined to be a channel of saving grace for everybody.” (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 232.)

Joyce Korner (Northeastern Ohio), delegate chairperson



Keynote Address

Here we are at the start of the 38th Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. All of us should reflect for a few moments on how the delegates, directors of the corporate boards, staff, and trustees approached the last 37 Conferences — each one unique, with different problems; choosing which course the Fellowship would take. Think for a moment about their singleness of purpose; their key to unity; their dedication to and love of our Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Concepts; and their commitment to keeping our primary objective simple, direct, and totally uncomplicated. That primary objective is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. To further that simplicity and directness, it reminds us always that the only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no complications, no misinterpretations, no misunderstanding.

When I learned at the last board weekend that I would be given this loving invitation to give the keynote address, I thought to myself, no, I wouldn't know what to say. But, like any of you, I was told by my sponsor a long time ago that if I'm asked to do anything in A.A., I should do it and do it with a smile. I immediately began to worry about how I could give a talk that would start this Conference with the importance it commands.

As I was flying home from the board meeting, I noticed across the aisle a dog lying quietly at its master's feet. This was the first time I had seen a dog on a commercial flight and it caught my eye. During the five-hour flight I watched a marvelous story unfold. You see, it was a guide dog for a young lady who was blind. I watched with fascination as the dog lay quietly without moving and yet always alert. The flight attendants were very attentive to the passenger and periodically reached down to pet her dog who never whined, barked, ate, drank, slept, or fussed. I marveled at the dog. Just think of it. What dedication! What commitment! His only purpose was to serve his mistress; to protect her, to take her safely to her destination, to be always at her side; and to do it silently and without complaint. What are his rewards for this service above the usual food and shelter? Pats and hugs, words of love and praise, and most of all, the knowledge that without him, his mistress would be severely limited. The guide dog leads so that she can achieve. We are in a similar position: if we can stop when we see danger, our Fellowship can continue to achieve.

During the week we are going to examine issues that are prominent in the minds of our fellows. Issues like our singleness of purpose, chemical dependence, substance abuse, double winners, adult children, and many other self-help organizations that pervade our Fellowship. We'll also examine the need for more pamphlets for special purposes, and our Seventh Tradition. We will search for a way to spread the base of participation so that all groups will be involved, not just 50 percent. You will discuss a new problem: how do we deal with success. Your areas have responded to the call for group contributions to form the base of the General Service Office's financial support rather than relying on publishing income. The prices of our books and pamphlets have been dramatically reduced as a result of this response. Additionally there will be a one-price-only system that will eliminate price differences from purchasers outside of Alcoholics Anonymous. We will learn about our positions on carrying the message inside the Soviet Union and on the many A.A. members now visiting that country in an effort to establish the Fellowship there. We will hear of anonymity breaks and of an author whose book will create both controversy and misunderstanding.

This seems to be the year of the Traditions. The direction of our Conference reflects the mood of our Fellowship and seems to be asking us to examine the Traditions. Accordingly, I researched the words "singleness" and "unity" in the dictionary in hopes of finding the keynote I have been looking for. "Singleness" means freedom from selfish ends and "unity" means the state of being one. I still hadn't found my keynote. Then in my confusion, I turned to my *Twelve and Twelve* and *A.A. Comes of Age*. Bill's words on these subjects were plain and simple. Basically, he wrote that he owed his life to A.A.; what it is and what it stands for. He thanked God for the Traditions. On unity Bill said that through our faith and works we have built upon the lessons of our incredible experience. He stated that our experiences live in the Twelve Traditions and that, God willing, they will sustain us in unity for as long as God needs us. Bill cautioned that like other societies, A.A. found out that wanting power, domination, glory and money were forces that could threaten us more than alcohol or sex. Bill said that these forces are driven by self-righteousness, self-justification, and anger dressed up as righteous indignation.

Regarding singleness of purpose, Bill felt that we should do one thing well instead of trying to do many things to which we aren't called. He was adamant that A.A. gains unity from this concept and that the very life of A.A. depends on preserving it.

Of course, we might interest ourselves in fields of education, research, neurosis and the like. But as a Society, should we? Our experience says that we definitely should not. We can and we do help as individuals in those fields. That is good. But as a Fellowship we know that we must not be diverted. It is our experience as alcoholics that gives us unique value on the total alcoholic front. We can approach sufferers as no one else can. Therefore, the strongest kind of moral and ethical compulsion is upon us to do this and nothing more. Certain that we can do together what we cannot do separately, we shall always cooperate but never compete. We shall direct our energies where they count most. Most emphatically then, A.A. has but one single purpose: to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers. That is our basic objective, our very reason for existence.

Keep It Simple, Just For Today, Don't Drink and Go to Meetings, Carry the Message and from Bill's last message: Thank you for your lives.

John Ford, Western Canada regional trustee



Lee Dean, the cheerful voice on G.S.O.'s switchboard for 20 years.

Workshop

Wednesday evening Conference members split up into small groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme, "Singleness of Purpose — Key to Unity." Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 Tradition Three states, "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking." Does this imply that one has to say they are an alcoholic at a closed A.A. meeting?

It was generally agreed that an alcoholic, particularly a newcomer, should not be expected or required to identify himself as an alcoholic. That is clearly an individual choice that should be left up to the alcoholic. Moreover, the majority of newcomers, who need time to settle into the program, initially have a greater identification with the "desire to stop drinking" than with the label of "alcoholic."

2 Describe how groups in your area handle the problem of A.A. members speaking at length about:

A. Other substances.

The majority of groups appear to handle this matter by reading the Primary Purpose Card ("Blue Card") at the beginning of meetings. Nevertheless, a strong group chairperson who establishes, and adheres to, a policy of how to respond to the problem, is also deemed to be very helpful. In the spirit of tolerance, groups should be aware of the affliction of dual addiction, remembering that it is easier to chase someone away than to attract them. Additional ways to handle the problem include: seeing to it that speakers at meetings focus primarily on their drinking history; informing newcomers of outside groups, such as N.A.; having sponsors speak privately to them. No one, it was generally agreed, should be driven away.

B. Other self-help fellowships:

Similarly, in this instance, the reading of the Blue Card is most helpful, in addition to the steps mentioned above. Some groups reported switching their discussion meetings from open to closed ones, others said they stressed the Fellowship's primary purpose at beginners meetings. Many agreed it is better to avoid embarrassing an individual by speaking to him or her privately, after a meeting, remembering that a spirit of understanding should accompany firmness.

3 What steps are taken in your A.A. community to clarify what A.A. is and is not; and how A.A. cooperates but does not affiliate with:

Court programs — There was uniformity of agreement on two points: keeping open lines of communication with court officials, always informing them what A.A. can and cannot do. In addition, inviting professionals and the public to open seminars, maintaining strong C.P.C. committees and an effective contact sponsorship program are also helpful.

Treatment Centers — Again, a free flow of information between the centers and A.A. is considered of primary importance, in addition to the need to expose the centers' patients to A.A. meetings, either at the centers or by bringing them to group meetings where it is also useful to have an ongoing temporary sponsorship program.

Employee Assistance Programs — Representatives of these programs are best dealt with through frequent contact with C.P.C. committees.

4 How do we clearly state our singleness of purpose without creating division within the Fellowship?

The reading of both the Preamble and the Blue Card was reported to be in widespread use and — in some instances — the Declaration of Responsibility statement is also read. The reason these are read — to uphold the Fellowship's singleness of purpose — is by now generally understood and accepted by the membership. But unity is also served by the regular reading at meetings of the Traditions, and by maintaining a constant vigilance in carrying the message.

5 What has sponsorship and a home group to do with unity and participation?

It is the home group that gives to each member, particularly the newcomer, a sense of belonging, a growing knowledge of how the program works, and where an understanding of service begins. All of those lessons are strengthened by the help of sponsors, who, by their example, show the newcomers "How it Works." Where the home group is the cohesive substance that holds A.A. together — creating an atmosphere of welcome with greeters at the door, or instituting the award of chips for sober time, or other methods — individual sponsors, by their example of giving it away, are a strong part of that cohesive substance.

6 What is done in your area to better inform A.A. groups and members about our Singleness of Purpose?

Many groups hold workshops on the topic, keeping in mind the constant need to work with and educate a continuing influx of new members. At the workshops and at meetings the reading and dissemination of Conference-approved literature is often helpful, as is the periodic taking of group inventories. Emphasis should always be on communication with members with regard to the entire program and its basic tenets, personal responsibility and service.



Closing Talk

I would like to thank the trustees' Conference Committee for its "loving invitation" to share some observations and thoughts after seven years as a Class A trustee and six years as chairperson of the board.

It does not seem like 13 years! They say that time passes quickly when you enjoy what you are doing . . . especially in pleasant company. I have enjoyed serving the Fellowship and I can say with all honesty I have never been associated with more pleasant company.

I have been given a few minutes to reflect on some of my experiences extending over 13 General Service Conferences, three International Conventions, more than 50 board meetings, 30 Regional Forums, and many area meetings. I do not believe I have missed a single commitment, which may be a good indicator of how much I have enjoyed my service to the Fellowship. The observations and thoughts I will share with you are personal and, of course, are from the perspective of a friend and adopted member of the A.A. family.

First some observations:

On the subject of Alcoholics Anonymous and success: The wildest dreams of Bill, Dr. Bob, and the faltering few who founded A.A. have come true! Alcoholism is now widely recognized as a disease; treatment centers encourage patients to join A.A. to maintain sobriety; membership in A.A. is becoming respectable, and in some quarters, even a status symbol! We are now struggling to learn how to deal with success.

Now, about adjusting to rapid change: The rate of change appears to be accelerating in the world around us and within the Fellowship. Our success, as evidenced by growth in membership, increased literature sales, larger budgets, more employees, requires a more complex operation. We have been pushed helter-skelter into dealing with tax laws, trademark and copyright laws, labor law, personnel policies, unions and computers. Coping with these changes has added new dimensions to the demands being made on trusted servants throughout the Fellowship. Can recovering alcoholics deal with all these? That is a challenge for you, the Conference, as well as the board.

There appears to be a trend toward larger A.A. groups. Is this a healthy trend? Does a large group deprive new members of the full benefit of A.A.'s recovery program by diminishing one-to-one contact? Large groups appear to be very comfortable for those who have achieved some sobriety.

I have observed a change in attitude toward intergroup/central offices. My first experience with an intergroup office in my part of the country was perplexing. Those responsible for the operation were negative towards almost everything coming from general service or "New York"! As a new trustee I soon learned there were other central offices in the U.S. and Canada with similar negative attitudes.

Well, it seems to be attitudes are changing. I attended the first-ever Intergroup/Central Office Seminar two years ago. Instead of the G.S.O. "bashing" I expected, I found very positive, dedicated trusted servants representing a good cross-section of our Fellowship, anxious to share with each other and G.S.O. staff their experience, strength and hope to better carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic. I learned that most intergroup/central offices are struggling to be financially solvent. Group support is often sporadic and there appears to be a dependence on

literature sales. One reason for the seminar was to discuss financial problems created by the self-support initiative.

It became apparent to me as I listened to the participants, particularly those representing large cities, that the services provided to local groups paralleled much of the work in our New York General Service Office. I wondered about the impact on the General Service Office if several central offices were forced to close because of inadequate financial resources. It also seemed to me regrettable that many of those involved in central office activities are not well represented in the A.A. General Service Conference structure or operating under Third Legacy procedures.

Now I would like to share a few thoughts about the future. If these thoughts from my experiences appear to you unreal or heresy, just remember I am a still-practicing nonalcoholic . . . a friend! In regard to information and communications: Trusted servants require timely, accurate, factual information in a digestible form. The General Service Office does a superb job in providing us with all the information we need to carry out our responsibilities. There are times, however, when I am overwhelmed with information. How did you feel when Conference materials began to pile up before you left for New York? Did you think you really had enough time to absorb the information before your committee meetings? Many times I have felt uncomfortable because I was unable to assimilate the great mass of information adequately before a meeting. Should we condense or summarize more printed materials? I believe G.S.O.'s use of graphs is a good example of one way to make a great deal of complex information readily understandable. I believe we need to apply our most creative thinking to this problem.

A.A. groups are much larger today: When I found A.A. in 1958 it was uncommon for a group to have more than 50 members. Most groups had fewer than 25. My A.A. friends told me they tried to keep groups small because A.A. worked better that way. Milton Maxwell, my predecessor, often expressed his concern about the trend toward larger groups and the difficulties this created, particularly for new members struggling to achieve sobriety. I share Milton's concern. Moreover, I think in smaller groups many of our present group problems would disappear and more members would have more opportunities to benefit from A.A.'s recovery program.

A word or two about checks and balances: Our service structure — Traditions, Concepts, and Charter — provides a marvelous system of protective checks and balances. Just recently, however, we discovered what appears to be a flaw in one of the checks that caused some distress to the General Service Board. Now, in the particular situation we encountered, the checks and balances appeared quite adequate, but we found a flaw. The procedures we are bound by do not take into account the need for prompt, decisive, corrective action. The delay in taking the necessary action created hardship for some employees and controversy within the Fellowship, as well as a substantial financial loss.

The problem is now resolved and steps have been taken to prevent a recurrence. I am convinced, however, that unless we can "fix" this apparent flaw in the checks and balances in our present structure, we may be faced with a similar situation in the future.

Of course, a proper set of checks and balances is crucial. Let me quote from Bill's introduction to the Concepts: "Well knowing our propensity for power driving, it is natural and even imperative that our service concepts be based on the system of 'checks and balances.' We have to face the fact that we usually try to enlarge our own authority and prestige when we are in the saddle. But

when we are not, we strenuously resist a heavy handed management wherein someone else holds the reins.” (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 4)

I am, of course, referring to problems we experienced with the Grapevine. I share this particular incident only to illustrate what I referred to earlier in my observations about the growing complexity of the General Service Office resulting from growth and change.

Regarding inventories (A.A. style), several weeks ago, a Panel 26 delegate called me to talk about his concerns regarding the increasingly heavy demands now being made on trustees, directors, and the General Service Office staff. This was a positive, constructive discussion with an overriding thought which I would like to share with you. The thought is about inventories. The past delegate talked about surveys or studies to reexamine the entire service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous! (I thought, “What an order! I can’t go through with it.”) I was quickly assured by my caller, however, that he did not expect immediate action, but was only suggesting the beginning of a process which may take years to complete. Each level of our service structure . . . from G.S.R.s through to trustees and staff, reexamine their function in keeping with their mandate within our Traditions, Concepts, and Charter. In other words, “inventory-taking,” but with results fed back to the Conference so that there would be, in effect, a U.S./Canada service structure inventory.

Now there is a thought! I have come to believe that inventory taking is a very important exercise for all sectors of our A.A. Fellowship. My Scottish ancestry has something to do with this belief. Those of you who are Scots will know about the Scottish custom of celebrating Hogmanay . . . the last day of the old year and the first day of the new. For some it is a riotous bash; for others it is a time to pay debts, make amends to enemies, clean house . . . very much like our inventory-taking. I do not suggest that particular time of the year for inventory-taking. There may be merit, however, in developing a traditional time for inventory-taking. This would, of course, be in addition to the inventory necessary as a result of a crisis or distressing situation which requires us to find out where we have strayed from our Traditions or Concepts.

More on the subject of intergroup/central offices: This thought is prompted by conversations with Milton Maxwell and my observation from the Intergroup/Central Office Seminar. When Milton heard about the first seminar, he sent me a note to this effect: “Thank goodness something positive is finally being done about intergroup/central offices!” (Milton continues to keep watch over all A.A. affairs, and I know he will be pleased to hear that this Conference has addressed the subject.)

Is it conceivable at some time in the future for intergroup/central offices to operate within a structural pattern similar to the New York General Service Office and the General Service Board?

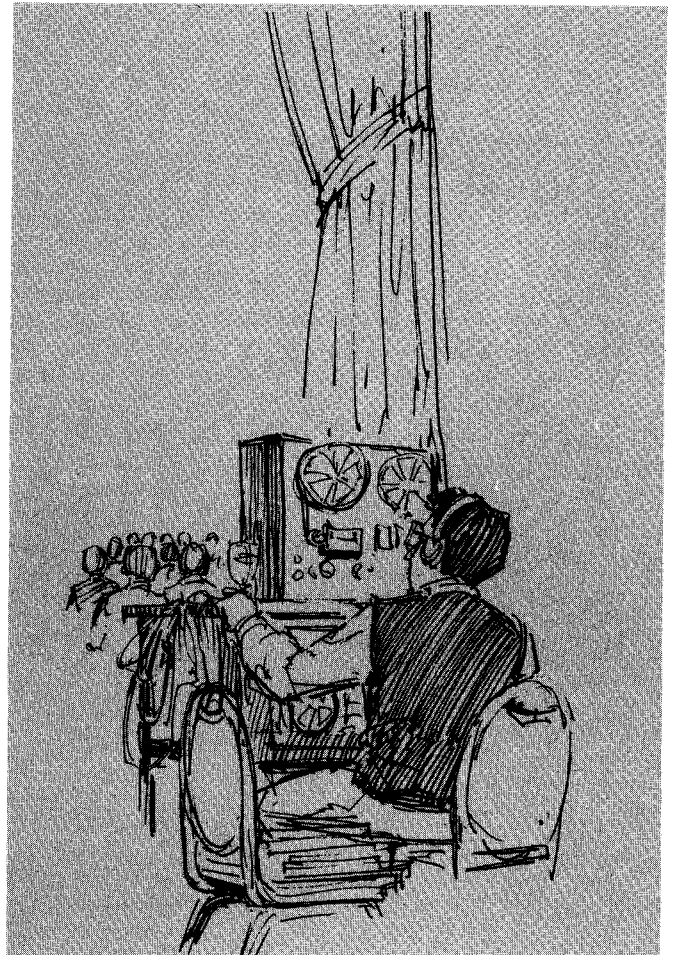
Having shared some of my observations and thoughts as a result of my experiences as a trusted servant, what do I think of A.A.’s future? Will the pressures of rapid changes in our world and the tremendous growth in the Fellowship overwhelm us? I don’t think so. I am convinced by my experiences over the past 13 years that if we retain our singleness of purpose and unity, A.A. will be around for many future generations.

Why am I so sure? Because of the unique talents or gifts every member brings to the Fellowship. (I prefer the word gift because it conveys to me something innate, not earned; unmerited from our Higher Power.) It seems we discover our unique gift when we are willing to serve. This discovery is to me always a wonder

to behold or experience. The revelation of the gift seems to begin to emerge when we are asked to serve, be it washing coffee cups, being a G.S.R., chairing a meeting, speaking, becoming a trustee, or whatever. Everyone in this room has witnessed the process when they heard a member say, “I didn’t know I could do that!”

These unique gifts made readily available by trusted servants at all levels of the service structure ensure A.A.’s future. I have never seen it fail. Our Higher Power provides the person/gift when needed. I have witnessed this miraculous phenomenon many, many times. It is awe-inspiring and serves to convince me that A.A. will survive for my grandchildren’s grandchildren. Bernard Smith, one of the truly great friends of A.A. and an architect with Bill of our service structure, spoke at the 1965 International Convention in Toronto. He expressed then more eloquently than I can my thoughts now as I try to sum up my feelings about this magnificent Fellowship and the sharing power every member has achieved the hard way. Let me quote now in closing from Bern Smith’s remarks to what was then the largest A.A. assembly in history. As 10,000 people listened, Bern said: “You have something great and awesome going for you. Treat it tenderly, respect what it has done for you and what it can do for others. . . . As long as one man dwells in darkness you once knew, you cannot rest; you must try to find him and help him become one of you . . . By the grace of God, may Alcoholics Anonymous last for all time.”

Gordon Patrick, chairperson, General Service Board



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference. Additional topics that each Conference committee discussed (with the exception of C.P.C. and Finance), but took no action on, will be reported in the History and Actions of Conference Committees; available from G.S.O. upon request.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

1 A proposal from the Northern Minnesota area regarding the use of surveys to determine the need for Conference-approved literature be referred to the appropriate committee for consideration at the 1989 General Service Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

2 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the 39th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, two A.A. members rotating from the following (G.S.O. staff, Grapevine staff, Archives or of the Corporate Boards); and that their talks be limited to ten minutes each.

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated as chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the A.A. meeting.

3 The theme of the 39th General Service Conference be "Anonymity — Our Past, Present and Future" or "Anonymity — Living Our Traditions."

4 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1989 Conference:

- a Self-Support
- b G.S.O. Finances
- c Anonymity —
 - 1 How it Developed
 - 2 Its Necessity Today
 - 3 Principles before Personalities
- d Back to Basics
 - 1 The Group in the Structure
 - 2 Sponsorship in Recovery and Service
 - 3 A.A. Literature — Tool or Mandate?

5 A workshop topic be on the Conference theme and a second workshop on "Love and Service" be scheduled if time permits.

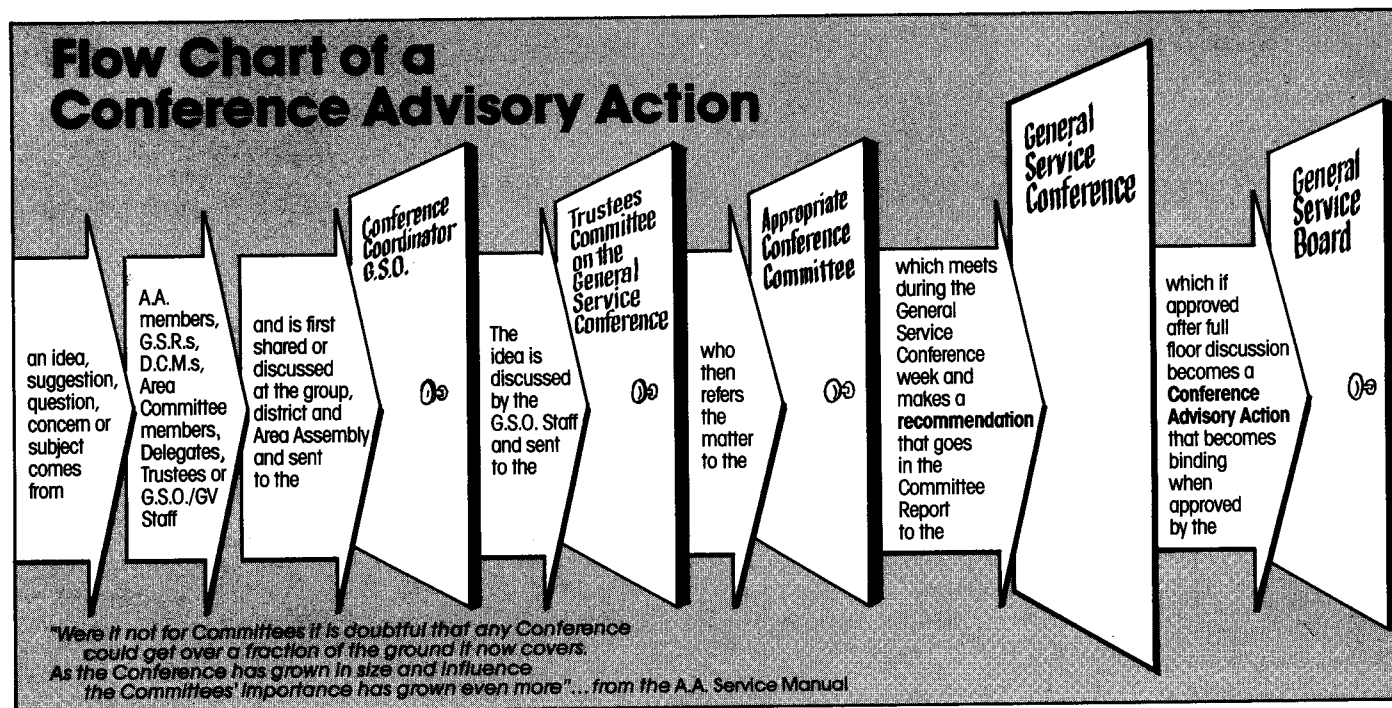
6 A What's on Your Mind? session continue to be scheduled in the beginning of the week.

7 We continue the practice of allowing more time for committee meetings.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

8 The following sentence "Dually or multiply addicted persons are asked to seek A.A. membership only if one of their addictions is to alcohol" be deleted in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" under the section titled "Problems Other Than Alcohol" at the next printing.



9 After discussing in-depth the need for carrying the A.A. message to the black community, the committee decided that the scope of the initiative be broadened to include all minorities with emphasis on the black community and recommended that the C.P.C. secretary and the Public Information secretary consider the suggestions listed in the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*, Fall 1981, and use them as guidelines for carrying the message to all minorities.

10 A letter be sent to all area P.I. and C.P.C. chairpersons with these revised suggestions for carrying the A.A. message to minority group members.

11 In order to follow the progress of this initiative to minorities, the committee requested that the secretary send the committee members a full report of whatever action takes place at the trustees' C.P.C. and P.I. Committees at the July board meeting and that discussion of the initiative be an item on the agenda of the 1989 Conference C.P.C. Committee.

In addition the committee discussed (but took no action) local A.A. experience with court programs and suggested further discussion and updating be an item on the C.P.C. agenda for 1989.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

12 The pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons" be replaced with two separate revisions of the material: (1) An easy-to-read pamphlet for inmates and outside A.A.s interested in starting A.A. groups in correctional facilities which will explain how inside groups are formed and how they function. (2) A brief pamphlet or leaflet to provide information about A.A. to administrators of correctional facilities.

13 The phrase "A.A. contact" be used in place of "prerelease sponsorship" in A.A. literature and communications about inmates who will soon be released in order to encourage more participation on the part of outside A.A.s.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

14 No change in delegates' fees be made at this time.

15 The list of possible demands on the Reserve Fund as presented by the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee be made available as a service piece and this list be attached to the finance presentation and made available to the current members of the Conference.

16 The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee's proposal for handling possible excesses in the Reserve Fund be approved. The proposal would use literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund to the Conference approved limit of one year's operating expenses.

17 The statement of clarification recommended by the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee be approved. The statement says that when the auditor comments in his annual financial statements on the availability, feasibility and adequacy of the Reserve Fund, he is measuring the Reserve Fund as of the calendar year just ended, including transfers from such year's income of the operating entities, against the operating expenses of the consolidated entities (A.A. World Services, Inc., General Service Board of A.A., Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.), for the same year then ended.

18 Subject to editorial review, the Self-support Committee's suggested revisions to the "Supporting the A.A. Support System" pamphlet be approved with the provision that:

- a titles be indicated for the addresses of Districts, Intergroups/ Central Offices, Area Committees, and G.S.O.
- b a list of services provided to the Fellowship be included under the "Why" section.
- c the message of the last panel of the cartoon supplement be incorporated.

And that the committee see the draft reflecting these recommendations.

19 The cartoon supplement of the pamphlet "Supporting the A.A. Support System," be discontinued immediately.

20 The 1988 financial reports be presented as a management report to the Conference, based on broad based allocations. It acknowledges that the more detailed computerized general ledger system will provide more accurate allocation when available.

The committee acknowledged (but no action was taken) the report of the Southern California Area Assembly Ad Hoc Committee on Finance and supports the present policies and actions of the General Service Board. The Committee does not see the need for any actions on the part of this Conference as a result of this report, as those items which might require action are being acted upon. A.A.W.S.'s response to the ad hoc committee has been distributed to all Conference members and the committee feels that these comments adequately address the pertinent issues raised.

The committee also discussed the A.A.W.S. Board action which implemented single pricing (the elimination of two-tier pricing). It is the position of the committee, as a result of the 1987 committee's suggestion on this matter, that it was the 1988 Conference which was to decide on single pricing. The committee feels that the Conference prerogative was preempted by the respective boards. This action, however, is in line with the goals of becoming fully self-supporting through our own contributions and eliminates the dependence on excessive profits resulting from sales to entities outside of the Fellowship.

Clarification — the policy now results in single pricing with quantity discounts available which exists to encourage redistribution at the local level.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

21 The Grapevine not publish a monthly section of daily messages/reflections.

22 The matters of format and editorial policy raised in the "Resolution to the A.A. Grapevine" from Area 70, Vermont, are within the right of decision of the Grapevine editorial staff.

23 The 1987 Conference Advisory Action number 29 be reaffirmed: "The Grapevine staff be responsible for communicating updated information to the delegates at appropriate intervals regarding editorial, circulation/fulfillment, and financial matters."

24 Since the Grapevine Corporate Board has fully complied with 1987 Advisory Action number 30, timely communication from the board to all Conference members regarding resolution of the

management problems is no longer necessary, though the standing practice of sending quarterly Corporate Board minutes to Conference Grapevine Committee members will be continued.

25 The Grapevine proceed with a one time trial distribution of complimentary Grapevines to nonsubscribing groups (selected on a random basis) in order to make them aware of the Grapevine as an effective recovery tool. In order to stay within the Grapevine's 1988 budget, the cost of this trial distribution should not exceed \$2,500. Results of this effort and any further action of the Corporate Board should be reviewed by the 1989 Conference.

26 The Grapevine proceed with publication of Bill W.'s collected Grapevine writings, with brief factual introductory material to be prepared by Grapevine staff and approved by the Grapevine Corporate Board.

27 The 1987 Conference Advisory Action number 27 be reaffirmed: "Delegates focus their efforts on the district service structure as a means of reaching individual groups, in order to make every group aware of the value of the Grapevine as a recovery tool."

28 In order to encourage full participation, the Grapevine consider establishing a Grapevine awareness month and areas continue to hold Grapevine workshops, Grape-a-thons and Grapevine meetings.

29 In response to concerns about the elapsed time between ordering and receiving the Grapevine, that the Grapevine Corporate Board investigate the feasibility of early acknowledgment of new subscription orders.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION SITE-SELECTION COMMITTEE

It was recommended that:

30 Four cities be specified for the 1995 International Convention (in alphabetical order): Atlanta, Georgia; Minneapolis/St. Paul, Minnesota; San Diego, California; Toronto, Ontario, Canada.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

31 Work continue on the "A.A. History Book," and that this be subject to further editing through the coordinating efforts of each regional trustee with each delegate for further updating, corrections, and additional information.

32 The revision of the manuscript of "A.A. in the Armed Services" be accepted with the following changes:

The Marine story from the current pamphlet "A.A. in the Armed Services" be included in the revised pamphlet.

The manuscript be returned for editing of Charles' story, to include consideration of references to "drug addiction."



Southern Minnesota's delegate, Jack Cawkwell, was asked how his wife made out at the Atlantic City casinos. "OK, \$60," he replied. However, he didn't say whether she had won or lost.

33 The copy on the A.A. Group Structure be approved with the following additions:

- a That "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Public Information Representatives" be added to the diagram entitled "Service Structure Inside the A.A. Group."
- b That the term "Institutions Representative" be changed to "Treatment Facilities/Correctional Facilities Representative."
- c That the six point definition of an A.A. group found on page 32 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to the copy of the second paragraph.

34 The copy on the structure of an A.A. group be added as a chapter to the A.A. *Service Manual* pending approval by the Conference Report and Charter Committee.

35 The copy on the structure of an A.A. group be:

- a Produced as a flyer suitable for insertion in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, and also as a continuing piece of literature.
- b Included in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet at the next revision.

36 The copy "The Home Group" be accepted for inclusion in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet with the following stipulations:

- a That the third paragraph, page two be underlined, "Obviously, as with all group conscience matters, each A.A. member has one vote, and this, ideally, would be through their 'Home Group.'"
- b That on page three, paragraph three, line two, ". . . and greeting newcomers at the door" be added.
- c That where repetition of information occurs in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, it be deleted.

37 "Specialized gatherings" found on page 33 of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be changed to "specialized meetings."

38 The article in the April/May issue of *Box 4-5-9* entitled "Service Sponsorship: A Vital Stepping-Stone to Service and Sobriety" be prepared as a service piece with "Kiwanis Club types" on page four, paragraph two, line three, changed to "Club types."

39 The manuscript for the Native North American not be approved as presented, but that this manuscript be returned for editing to include consideration of the references to drug addiction, chemical dependency, "junkie" and "clean" and then upon completion of editing be approved for publication.

40 A more simplified draft of an easy-to-read, illustrated pamphlet of "Is A.A. for You?" be prepared for consideration by the 1989 Conference.

41 "This is A.A." and "44 Questions" as illustrated flyers not be published at this time.

42 A simplified, easy-to-read, illustrated "Twelve Steps" pamphlet be prepared for consideration by the 1989 Conference.

43 Work continue on the Daily Reflections Book and that a request be made for additional manuscripts to be submitted from the Fellowship on any Step, Tradition, or writings by Bill W. coordinated through each delegate with a progress report to be presented at the 1989 Conference.

44 The Primary Purpose Card continue as a service piece.

45 The 1980 Task Force recommendation and Conference Action be reaffirmed.

"Any factual or statistical information may be updated whenever practical without having to go through the process of Conference Action, i.e., whenever inventory runs low, a new survey is completed, etc. In addition, minor copy cuts to make room for new material added to publications may be made when necessary."

And further recommended:

"That any other changes made in the substance of the Conference-approved literature shall be through the Conference process."

46 The revised pamphlet "Young People in A.A." be approved for publication with one following revision, that all personal reference be removed from page 51, line 3.

47 The self-support flyer "Your DCM" be Conference approved.

48 A draft of a pamphlet for the gay/lesbian alcoholic be prepared and reviewed by the 1989 Conference.

POLICY / ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

49 Ron Carr, General Service trustee, Australia, be admitted to the 38th General Service Conference, as an observer.

50 The 40th General Service Conference be scheduled for April 22-28, 1990.

51 The comments under questions one and two in the 38th General Service Conference Questionnaire be used in planning the next Conference, but not included in the final results of the 1988 Conference Evaluation.

52 The Policy/Admissions Committee continue to study geographical representation and distribution of General Service delegates.

53 Ample time for Conference Committees to meet and conduct their business be provided for on the Conference Agenda.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

54 The word "fight" be changed to the words "deal with" in item 6 under "What A.A. Does Not Do" in the pamphlet "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," so that the sentence will read "But A.A. does cooperate with organizations that deal with alcoholism."

55 A discussion outline for the film "Young People and A.A." is not needed at this time.

56 New radio spots be developed to reach specific audiences currently being targeted by radio stations and brought back to the 1989 Conference Public Information Committee for approval.

57 The 1971 General Service Conference Action be reaffirmed:

"A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his death, but in each situation the final decision must rest with the family."

Further, the A.A. Archives continue to protect the anonymity of deceased A.A. members as well as other members.

58 The A.A. Fact File be updated to correct inaccuracies, and that the corrected material be sent to the 1988 Conference Public Information Committee members for their approval prior to publication.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

59 The Conference Charter should appear in its original 1955 form in future editions of *The A.A. Service Manual*, with General Service Conference Advisory Action amendments and editorial changes indicated by footnotes, followed by the current version of the Charter.

60 Article 2, paragraphs 2, 3, and 4 of the Conference Charter be further clarified through a footnote amendment to read as follows:

"Other countries have created autonomous General Service Conferences of their own, which rely on the Steps and Traditions that are protected by the United States/Canada Conference. In addition, these other Conferences often turn to the actions of the United States/Canada Conference for guidance.

"Consultation between Conferences is encouraged, and a World Service Meeting of delegates from the various Conferences is held once every two years. The United States/Canada delegates to the World Service Meeting are chosen from the General Service Board.

"In countries where a General Service Structure exists, the United States/Canada Conference will delegate sole right to publish our Conference-approved literature to the General Service Board of that structure."

61 Section 3 of Concept XI be researched to identify the parts of Section 3 touching on current practices of the General Service Board and A.A. World Services that need footnoting, and that this research be brought back to the 1989 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review and further recommendation.



At the trustees' dinner Tuesday evening Dr. John Harley Smith, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee entertained with an Irish bar song.

62 Footnote 8 to Concept XI, be reworded to reflect current practices of the General Service Board, and A.A. World Services, Inc. to read:

"G.S.O. staff members have voting representation on trustees' committees. Additionally, the staff member serving as staff coordinator has a vote as a director of the A.A.W.S. Board."

63 With minor amendments the proposed revision of the section "How G.S.O. is Supported" in *The A.A. Service Manual* to address enhanced participation in self-support replace the existing section in future editions of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

64 The final copy of the A.A. group structure prepared by the Literature Committee be forwarded to the 1989 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for further consideration as an addition to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

65 A current list of "Literature Published by A.A.W.S.," as well as a separate list of "Literature Published by the A.A. Grapevine" appear in *The A.A. Service Manual* following the chapters on "The General Service Office" and on "The A.A. Grapevine" respectively.

66 The category "alternate D.C.M." be added to the eligibility options outlined in the section "How Do We Elect the D.C.M.?" in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

67 A description of the kit sent to the new D.C.M. be included in the section "How Do We Elect the D.C.M.?" in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

68 The sentence "The G.V.R. is to the Grapevine what the G.S.R. is to the G.S.O." in the section "What Does a Grapevine Representative Do?" in *The A.A. Service Manual* be replaced by a sentence which reads "The G.V.R. is the group's contact with the Grapevine office."

69 The phrase in Concept XI that reads: "Most staff members' assignments are changed yearly" be updated through footnoting to reflect current practices as follows: "Most staff members serve two years on each assignment."

70 The letter "S" be used as a prefix to the first set of page numbers in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts For World Service*, so as to differentiate between the two sets of page numbers.

71 A footnote be added to the byline "Bill W." in the chapter "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" in *The A.A. Service Manual*, stating that Bill wrote these words in 1951 and that the piece, therefore, reflects that period.

72 The 1984 General Service Conference Advisory Action be reaffirmed:

"Meeting addresses and times not be included in the A.A. directories, since not only would this add greatly to the printing and mailing costs of the directories, but also, some groups do not have addresses, and the directories were not intended to be used as a local meeting list."

73 The *Final Conference Report* be sent to all G.S.R.s, with the distribution method and quantity determined by the delegate.

74 The revised new group information form (March 1988) be reproduced in the section "Group Information" in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

75 An audiovisual presentation for Treatment Facilities including three minutes of sample footage be made and brought to the 1989 General Service Conference for further review.

The following topics be included in the film:

- a What A.A. is and is not
- b Anonymity
- c Traditions
- d Steps
- e Meeting Types
- f Sponsorship
- g Home Groups

The film be appropriate for use by all other related committees, A.A. groups, and as an additional tool for our Twelfth Step work.

The cost of the sample footage be in the neighborhood of \$17,000.

76 The newsletter drafted by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities for annual distribution to Treatment Facilities chairpersons be a quarterly newsletter whenever possible and reflect shared experience from other areas on how they are solving problems related to Treatment Facilities.

77 The word "educate" in the introductory statements of the proposed newsletter to Treatment Facilities chairpersons be deleted in favor of the word "inform," in keeping with A.A.'s tradition of sharing rather than educating.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

78 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1988 (see page 38; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee).

79 The following slate of directors for the A.A.W.S. Board be elected (see page 68; slate of directors approved).

80 The following slate of directors for the Grapevine Board be elected (see page 68; slate of directors approved).

81 In regard to the suggestion for a Class A trustee with expertise in the area of finance, no additional specific limitations should be made regarding qualifications for candidates, in order that the board have the greatest latitude in selecting candidates for Class A trustee vacancies.

82 In regard to the suggestion that Corporate Board directors of A.A.W.S., Inc. and Grapevine, Inc. not be past delegates, no additional specific limitations should be made regarding qualifications for candidates, in order that the board have the greatest latitude in selecting candidates for these positions.

When Dan Byrne (West Central regional trustee) was chairing the Wednesday Presentation session he apologized to those lined up at the mikes: "If I don't know all your first names I apologize. But I still don't know all of my children's first names." Dan and his wife are the parents of 13!

Presentations Address Key Issues of the Fellowship

SINGLENES OF PURPOSE — KEY TO UNITY

The first presentation/discussion session of the 1988 Conference took place on Monday afternoon. The topic addressed a vital concern of Conference members in considering A.A.'s future. Tom Hills, Eastern Canada regional trustee, moderated the session.

Groups vs. Meetings

The A.A. group has been called the basic unit of our Fellowship and the foundation upon which Alcoholics Anonymous stands. Perhaps that is why we so zealously guard the definition of a group. Perhaps also it is because there is such a proliferation of different kinds of meetings that we fear our message is being diluted.

This presentation isn't really about groups vs. meetings. It's about "capital G" Groups vs. "small g" groups. Members of Alcoholics Anonymous tend to meet at the drop of a hat. Sometimes they are meeting as what is clearly an A.A. group. Other times it is equally clear they are not meeting as a group; for instance, A.A. members getting together to talk about their investments. No one would say that was an A.A. "capital G" group. So it can be said that while all A.A. groups hold meetings, not all meetings are A.A. groups. What are the essential features that distinguish the A.A. "capital G" group from all others?

It appears that there are three different gatherings being discussed under the terms "groups" or "meetings." The A.A. group as we usually think of it, which agrees in all six points with the definition of a group in the pamphlet "The A.A. Group"; the special-purpose A.A. group, e.g., men's, women's, gays', lesbians', doctors', etc.; and the gathering of A.A. members with those who have some other problem in addition to alcohol (e.g., alcohol and pills), or family groups which include A.A. members and nonalcoholic family members. Perhaps the most important area of distinction is singleness of purpose. The first two categories of groups consist of alcoholics only and, consequently, can profess the one purpose: to help alcoholics recover through the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous as applied to the problem of alcohol. Also, because their membership consists solely of alcoholics, they may contribute to the support of Alcoholics Anonymous service entities

throughout the service structure, including local central offices. The third category of gathering, the meeting, is not wholly focused on the primary purpose because its membership may include nonalcoholics; nor can its contributions, coming in part, as they must from non-A.A. members, be accepted by the various service entities of A.A.

It is also important to realize that not every entity that calls itself Alcoholics Anonymous is in fact A.A. Some treatment centers call their aftercare "A.A.," but their meetings are restricted to alumni of that treatment facility and frequently include nonalcoholic drug addicts, and they do not participate in carrying the message in the way that Alcoholics Anonymous does. This is a clear case of institutional affiliation which disqualifies them from holding group status.

But what about the open speaker meeting, run by members of Alcoholics Anonymous, featuring only A.A. speakers, but attended regularly by people who are not members of A.A.? Is that a meeting or a group? What if that meeting throws in an occasional Al-Anon speaker? Does that disqualify it as an A.A. group?

What about the content of the meeting? If it's a "how was your week?" meeting, attended by A.A. members only, is it an A.A. group or does discussion have to center on some aspect of recovery? (Remember, the idea of having meetings came from the Oxford Groups who held weekly "How was your week?" Team Meetings.) How about "feelings" meetings? If a feelings meeting conforms to the six-point definition in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, is it an A.A. group, or does the subject matter disqualify it?

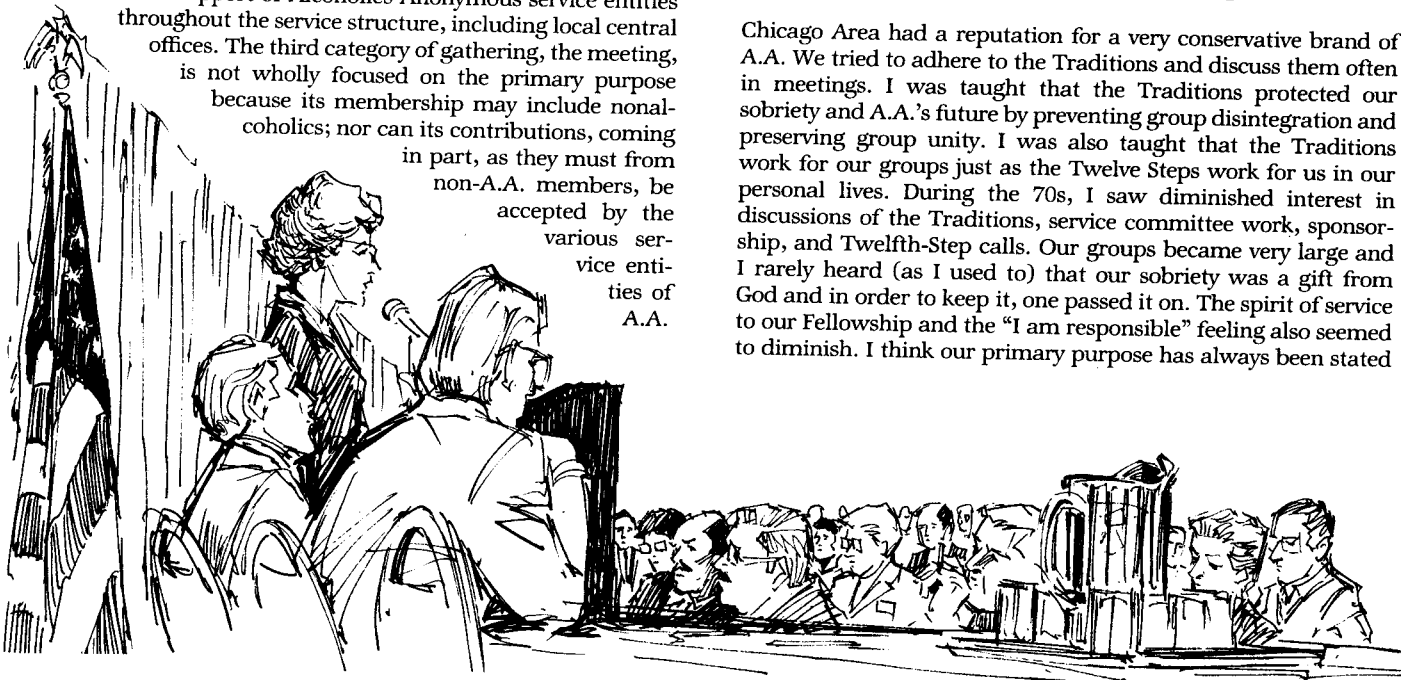
And how about special requirements? Can I, as a man, attend a women-only group, and if so, why is it listed as a women-only group? If not, is it a group? "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

Can A.A. accept contributions from meetings, or only from groups? And how about the problem of listings in our directories? A lot of people think that some of the listings are meetings; not groups. These are just some of the questions which have fueled controversy and which do not lend themselves to clear-cut answers. We don't enforce rules in Alcoholics Anonymous and perhaps in the final analysis the answer to these questions will have to be left to an informed group conscience.

Jack Cawkwell (Southern Minnesota)

Our Primary Purpose — Is Our Message Clear?

Chicago Area had a reputation for a very conservative brand of A.A. We tried to adhere to the Traditions and discuss them often in meetings. I was taught that the Traditions protected our sobriety and A.A.'s future by preventing group disintegration and preserving group unity. I was also taught that the Traditions work for our groups just as the Twelve Steps work for us in our personal lives. During the 70s, I saw diminished interest in discussions of the Traditions, service committee work, sponsorship, and Twelfth-Step calls. Our groups became very large and I rarely heard (as I used to) that our sobriety was a gift from God and in order to keep it, one passed it on. The spirit of service to our Fellowship and the "I am responsible" feeling also seemed to diminish. I think our primary purpose has always been stated



clearly in all our literature, but I don't believe that today we are presenting a clear message to our newcomers. Here are just a few examples of situations which illustrate this point.

At a recent meeting, the lead was given by an alcoholic from a treatment center, sober two years. We could identify with the drinking history, but recovery was about the treatment center and counseling. There was nothing about A.A. sobriety, our Twelve Steps, a Higher Power, or working with others. Many group members did not have treatment center experience and didn't participate in the discussion. The A.A. message was not carried.

Our Wednesday night meeting starts its discussion with whoever wishes to lead. A woman started talking about her new "battered women's group." The next person spoke about sex abuse therapy. I wondered, "is this A.A.?" Then a member acknowledged the suffering that had been expressed, and brought the meeting back to its primary purpose by adding, "but isn't it wonderful that A.A. is here for those who seek sobriety?" She continued by saying that with our A.A. program and restored sanity, we can find help for special problems. The meeting was turned around and the rest of the discussion was about A.A. recovery.

I recently received a phone call about a group meeting. The group was upset because the speaker had talked only about drugs. Many could not identify. No one knew what to do. I suggested including in their format the statement of our primary purpose. I also suggested that the group could decide through a group conscience whether to advise future speakers to talk about their problems as they relate to alcoholism and A.A. recovery.

In an effort to clarify our primary purpose, the Chicago Area is starting to move in a more positive direction. Today I am beginning to see that what appeared to be apathy was really the result of years of not teaching newcomers about our A.A. way of life. We are starting discussion groups for secretaries, workshops for service, beginners and sponsors meetings, and study of the Traditions. We are planning an area workshop for this fall in which all our area service committees will contribute. There has been a lot of enthusiasm and we look forward to good attendance.

A.A. publishes an amazing amount of quality material; books, pamphlets, tapes, films, guidelines, and service pieces that state very clearly what we are about. My observations lead me to believe that a large number of our Fellowship have little exposure to these resources. Let's use this wonderful stuff to better inform our current membership and newcomers so they will be able to pass on A.A. knowledge to the alcoholics yet to come. As each person begins to feel a responsibility to A.A., it is felt at the individual level (through sponsorship), at the group level, and at the district and area levels. The whole Fellowship benefits and we are better able to preserve the clarity of our primary purpose: to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. "I am responsible . . . when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that; I am responsible."

Beth Bowen (Chicago)

Are We Being Too Friendly With Our Friends?

When I first knew I would be making a presentation on the topic, "Are We Being Too Friendly With Our Friends?" I thought of that nasty word, politics! If I answer "Yes, we are too friendly," then I am classified a conservative. If I answer "No, we aren't," then I'm branded a liberal. So after much investigation and

thought, my answer is going to be in the moderate corner. No, we can never be too friendly with our friends, but I believe trouble does occur when we allow our friends to be too friendly with us. That's my position. Now, let me elaborate.

First though, when I speak of our "friends," I am referring to the professional community: treatment centers, court referrals, nonalcoholic addicts, and public information. I think this encompasses most of that gender. Actually, the majority of people coming to A.A. today are directly and indirectly from our friends. No longer is the common "garden variety" alcoholic a majority; rather now a rarity. This, of course, means that in the future, yea, near future, the "friends" type of A.A. member will be charged with the responsibility of administering this Fellowship. I must now, though, ask the questions: Where are the Twelfth-Step alcoholics? Are they coming in the program now? Have we given up that way? Are we letting our "friends" do our work? I hope not.

I believe we need to begin now to educate the Fellowship in a way that suggests we are a single-purpose Fellowship. We do not align ourselves with any other group. We are in competition with no one. We are limited to sharing our own firsthand knowledge of the suffering of an alcoholic because we have been there! We can, though, and must cooperate with others dealing with alcoholism as long as we are guided by our Twelve Traditions.

When I speak of allowing our friends to be too friendly with us, I refer to the seemingly frequent occurrences where our friends show apparent signs of affiliation. For example, courts appear to just dump alcoholic offenders on our doorstep and say take care of them; treatment centers set up programs with A.A. as a nucleus, professionals counsel with A.A. principles, and other self-help programs literally rob us of our name.

But actually in all of this, I believe that our friends are doing right. We must encourage any and all ways to help the suffering alcoholic. We must be grateful for every agency or method that tries to solve the problem of alcoholism. It's just that sometimes overzealous "friends" deliberately, or usually unknowingly, misrepresent our Fellowship. Sometimes for greed but more often out of ignorance. That's when I feel there's conflict and wrongdoing. We must stand up and shout loud and clear: We have Traditions that prevent us from associating with anyone. Outside agencies, though, are under no obligation to abide by our rules so we must seek ways to secure more effective understanding. One way is to continue to stress what A.A. is, and I can find no greater educator as to our purpose than that simple statement read to open practically every meeting — the Preamble. Especially the part that alludes to our not being allied with anyone. Also, many members volunteer in these programs, too, but we are sure to make it clear we do not represent Alcoholics Anonymous.

At the individual group level, we can always help to further understanding with our friends by stressing the importance of group autonomy. When, for example, court programs demand too much or seem to act in an autocratic way, the answer is not to have an area assembly forbid slip signings, but rather to have the separate groups and individuals in them decide how, or even if they wish to cooperate. When treatment centers make our program mandatory as part of their curriculum and then send these 28-day wonders to us, our attitude should not be discriminatory or superior, but one of belief that we have no right to withhold A.A. from anyone, no matter how they arrive. We cannot predict who will recover, nor have we the authority to decide how recovery should be for any other. Professionals sometimes agitate us with inane ideas on how to cure alcoholism, but

we must realize that any effort to hasten recovery of a sufferer is better than doing nothing. Public information is a tremendous tool, but when used to break anonymity and also bolster egos, it's time to inventory and re-establish good relations with the media. Repetition of our primary purpose and Traditions never fails to inform.

Nonalcoholic addicts are a major concern. The phrase, "You don't know 'till you've been there" is indeed a proper way to describe how I feel when I imagine Alcoholics Anonymous being overrun by people who are not like me. I'm selfish. I want this beautiful Fellowship to remain the same. I want the next alcoholic in the door to be as welcome as I was and have the same opportunity for recovery. So educating the nonalcoholic addict to what we are is of paramount importance.

Alcoholics Anonymous saved my life. Not through our friends, but that doesn't matter. I readily see the good these programs do. Cooperation is essential in our ongoing commitment to be there when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help. In conclusion, let's continue our cooperation with our friends. Let's remain friendly. But, as eternal vigilance is the price of our sobriety, let it also be the watchword for cooperation.

David Smoot (District of Columbia)

FINANCE

The Tuesday afternoon session opened when G.S.O.'s director of finance and business administration delivered a presentation on a topic of utmost concern to Conference members.

I had the pleasure of giving an impromptu presentation on finances at the 1987 Conference. At your request, I will again review and explain our financial statements in concept, line by line.

In the Financial section of the 1988 Conference Manual and 1988 *Final Conference Report* are several statements including G.S.O.'s Income Statements for 1986 and 1987, our Budget for 1988, Income Statements for the Grapevine for 1986 and 1987, its Budget for 1988, Combined Balance Sheets for G.S.O. and Grapevine for 1987 and 1986, plus comparison shortfall presentations for 1986, 1987, and budget, 1988.

The 1987 Income Statement will guide us through our review. Income and expenses are allocated in three major categories: (1) Publishing, (2) General Service Board — Office Expense, and (3) General Service Board — Other Expenses of the Board.

Income, by category:

A.A.W.S. Publishing reflects the income from literature sales, discounts taken by purchasers, the cost of production of the literature sold, the royalties paid on literature sales, and interest earned. The net is publishing income.

G.S.B. General Fund — Office reflects the contributions received from A.A. groups and members and interest earned on bank accounts in which contributions are held before paying expenses.

G.S.B. General Fund — Other: there is no income in this category.

Expense: The expenses charged against Publishing and G.S.B. — General Fund are allocated as shown into three cost centers: publishing and two kinds of service expense, separated for historical reasons. This allocation was highly arbitrary in some cases but the totals are reasonable. The note at the bottom of the 1987 income statement addresses this "allocation."

We have been addressing the issue of this "allocation" of expenses, and tested it by applying two separate methods of broad-based allocations and have made progress in a third test in using a computerized general ledger application of functional costing. All three of these tests have supported the overall result of the current method. In fact, they all result in supporting the position that the publishing operation would run at a slightly lesser cost and services would attract more expense. An explanation of each line item of expense under each category follows.

Salaries: The salaries of all positions or departments as allocated to either Publishing or to General Service Board-Office.

Pension: All the costs of our pension plan, including funding costs, audit and administrative expenses for all employees.

Rent and electricity: We currently occupy five floors at 468 and 470 Park Ave. South, representing 39,900 rentable square feet. The Grapevine occupies about 7,800 square feet. The amounts in this report are exclusive of the Grapevine share.

Box 4-5-9: This includes the costs for writing, editing, printing, and mailing this bimonthly periodical. The income from paid subscriptions has been treated as a reduction of these expenses, as the cost of each subscription sold is greater than the income received.

A.A. Directories: Includes the cost of typesetting, printing, binding, and mailing of the directories given away (one to each group and district committee member). These include the Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, and International Directories.

Other service material: Represents the cost of producing hundreds of thousands of service pamphlets and materials which are distributed free of charge. Some of these include "A.A. at a Glance" (600,000 copies), "A Message to Teenagers" (600,000 copies), "Where Do I Go From Here?" and "Circles of Love and Service" (200,000 copies each).



Shipping and mailing: This represents two major areas of cost; about 80% are related to the shipping of A.A. literature from our New York office and the warehouses in the U.S. and Canada. This includes postage, UPS, warehousing charges, and packaging (materials) costs. The balance of the costs are attributable to postage and UPS costs for correspondence and special mailings where the costs have not been charged to the function (such as Box 4-5-9 mailings).

Other office expenses: The expenses charged against Publishing represent furniture and office equipment, loss on bad debts, and selling expenses; the expenses charged against Office Expenses reflect the costs of stationery and office supplies, telephone, furniture and equipment, and office service and expenses (including maintenance contracts).

Insurance and payroll taxes: This represents the costs of office insurance including fire, liability and inventory, employee benefit coverages (hospitalization, major medical, and life), and payroll taxes. This covers all employees.

Professional services: The costs allocated against Publishing represent audit expenses; legal costs for labor matters; trademark, copyright and royalty matters; and general corporate work. The costs allocated to the General Service Board — Other Expenses mostly reflect audit expenses.

Board, committee and staff meetings: Under the Publishing column, the amount primarily represents the expenses associated with the monthly A.A.W.S. board meetings (travel, hotel, meals) as well as the expenses for the second Central Office/Intergroup Seminar (about \$18,000). The expenses under the Office column represent the cost of staff and committee meetings. The costs reflected under the Other column represent the costs of the quarterly meetings of the board of trustees (travel, hotel, meals), as well as expenses related to the travel of regional trustees.

Writers' fees: For projects undertaken each year; some projects overlap years. The projects reflected in 1987 were for: A.A. history book; revisions, such as the "Too Young?" pamphlet; Spanish translations (mainly pamphlets), other foreign translations, such as Kiswahili; and other various projects requiring writers.

P.I., C.P.C., and travel: The costs under the Publishing column represent travel expenses incurred by office personnel connected to office business such as trips by publishing personnel to printers to inspect major printings, to warehouses to inspect inventories and check out prospective warehouse locations, and to new or prospective printers or manufacturers to insure quality standards. The costs under the Other column reflect the expenses associated with two functions: Cooperation With the Professional Community — most of the expenses are associated with the cost of exhibiting at about 24 health fairs and the maintenance of these professional exhibits, and attendance at non-A.A. functions. The costs for the Public Information function vary each year, with the bulk of the costs for 1987 relating to publicity for the new videos, "Young People," and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell."

General Service Conference: Most of the expense represents hotel costs (rooms, meals), with other key items being delegate travel, the Box 4-5-9 Early Bird, and writer and production costs for the *Final Conference Report*. The balance includes items such as delegate portfolios and manuals, presentations, Advisory Actions, and other miscellaneous costs. This is net of delegate area contributions.

EDP systems development: Costs of maintenance, outside programmers, equipment and supplies.

Composite of Average Delegate

The average delegate is 52.2 years old, is sober 13 years and has been involved in service work for 10 years.

To refine that: oldest 73, youngest 32; longest sobriety 28 years, shortest 7 years; longest time in service 27 years, shortest 4.

— Statistics compiled at G.S.O., based on 87 responses

Regional Forums and other: The costs of Regional Forums, Archives, retirement gifts and sundry. Most of this cost was for Regional Forums.

Film projects: The balance of the cost of producing the two films, "Young People" and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell."

EDP system review: The consulting fee to Peat, Marwick & Main Co. who were retained to assist in the research, analysis, evaluation, and eventually the selection of a new computer system for the General Service Office and the Grapevine. This process is in the final stages of selecting a system vendor and associated computer hardware which best fits our needs.

Relocation study: This was the cost of using a consulting firm to provide the necessary information and data from which the respective boards could base their evaluation.

Leasehold improvements and construction: This represents the cost of construction and leasehold improvements incurred during 1987. This was mainly for the construction of an additional floor which was acquired in late 1986, as well as the reconstruction of two other floors, improvements to our remaining floors and painting of all space.

Self-support project: Almost half of the 1987 expenses were for the cost of producing and mailing the new Self-Support Manual for D.C.M.s.

Foreign literature assistance (net): The cost of assistance to other countries to help them to get started printing literature in their own country in their own language. Although these are loans to these countries to be repaid, the accounting treatment is to expense the loans in the year advanced and to treat repayments as reductions to the expense. The credit balance in 1987 represents more repayments than advances, including payments from Norway, Holland, and Japan.

Net income: This reflects the net income or expense by category. The Total column summarizes the three categories and reflects the results of the entire General Service Office operation.

The last page in the financial section highlights the 1988 Budget and illustrates the shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions for 1987. The shortfall for 1987 was only \$177,000, as compared to the shortfall in 1986 of \$924,000. This was mainly due to greater participation and increased contributions in 1987.

If I may leave you with one thought, your General Service Office works hard at preparing the budgets you have before you and monitoring the expenditures during the year. When we prepare the budget, we ask ourselves a question: Is this the best way to spend the A.A. dollar, which starts out in the basket and comes into G.S.O. in trust?

Edward Gordon (G.S.O. director of finance)

SELF-SUPPORT

On Wednesday morning, Conference members shared three presentations on self-support; each addressed a topic of great interest to Conference members. John Sharkey, Northeast U.S. regional trustee, moderated the session.

Spirit of the Seventh Tradition

The first, most obvious meaning or interpretation of our Seventh Tradition is that we don't take donations (either money or in the form of rent, free printing for newsletters, or flyers) from the outside. A.A. is described as a "spiritual program" that is made up of Steps, Traditions, and Concepts; written by borrowing heavily from religion, philosophy and spiritual concepts. If that is so, I need to look beyond the sometimes obvious material definitions of our thirty-six principles for some of the spiritual messages. For example, our Twelfth Step says, in part, "... we tried to carry this message to alcoholics . . ." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 106) The obvious meaning refers to one-to-one Twelfth Step work; talking to a newcomer. Upon further reflection, doesn't "carry the message" also imply more than one-to-one service? Service such as serving as a group secretary, G.S.R., intergroup rep, D.C.M., etc.? Are these not ways to practice these principles and carry the message as well?

When we recover sufficiently to start looking outside ourselves, gratitude for what we have been freely given begins to dawn and we look for ways to repay our gift of sobriety. Money by itself can't do it. There are other ways to repay, to express our gratitude, to ensure our Fellowship's survival, to be sure the hand of A.A. is there and that literature is available at meetings and central offices and G.S.O. are open. In short, to carry the message and to participate at all levels. A.A. suggests two ways for us to pay back our debt of gratitude and carry the message: *time* and *money*; also known as participation at all levels: individual, group, district, intergroup/central office, area, G.S.O., and even worldwide. We in A.A. like to make decisions and elect our servant-officers by two-thirds majorities or substantial unanimity. Is it not, therefore, desirable to have participation in the same proportion at all levels?

In 1987, we saw the Fellowship's response to our need for more group support for group services and less reliance on publishing profits. It was and still is heartwarming to see how we respond when a need is expressed or a request made. Let's express our need for participation to include all levels — group, district, intergroup/central office, areas, and G.S.O. In 1987, there was an increase of 37% in the amount of contribution dollars to G.S.O., and an increase in the percentage number of groups contributing of about 10%. Can we express our need for increased participation (more groups) so that next year these percentages are more nearly equal, or reversed? That is, a 10% increase in contribution dollars and a 37% increase in the number of groups



participating? Yes we can, by clearly communicating our need. In the 50s, Bill spoke of the "buck in the basket for basic A.A. services." Folks, the "buck" of the '50s is worth about twenty-five cents today. Could there be a message about increasing our personal contributions in our home group somewhere in there? Doesn't it all start in the home group?

Fifty-six point six percent of all groups registered with G.S.O. contributed in 1987 — 5% more than in 1986 — a healthy increase; however, not breaking any records, and certainly not the best possible. Our best year previously was 59% in 1973. Even at that level, a substantial minority is not participating, and is not having a voice or a vote in A.A. When I choose to participate, I can be most effective by remembering that I serve not to accomplish a goal, but as a part of a process. I believe the process is even more important to A.A.s than the end result.

As we grow and outside pressures seem to increase for us to provide an answer to all who suffer from anything, is there anyone present who would not want to stand up for, defend, and protect, in a positive way, our Steps, Traditions, and Concepts? What better way to do this than by increasing participation at all levels? What better way than having a larger percentage of our members and groups fully informed of all our principles — including our primary purpose? This wider opportunity to serve, to carry the message, needs the support in terms of both time and money, of every A.A. member and every group possible, at least two-thirds or substantial unanimity. This would make an effective Fellowship conscience. Finally, we would all be better informed by increased participation, and I believe there would be far fewer big or controversial issues such as anonymity breaks, nonalcoholics sent to closed meetings, turf-protecting, lack of trust, etc. Don't you?

Ruth Jagodzinski (Pacific regional trustee)

Participation — How It Works

Aloha! Once the initial shock of receiving my loving invitation subsided (to a level more manageable for one whose life is totally unmanageable), I started to investigate this thing called participation. I found out that participation works really well provided the many tools of communication are utilized. Oddly enough, one of the Webster definitions of communication is to "participate."

In late 1986, the General Service Board developed the self-support project and issued a paper outlining the need to be more fully self-supporting at all levels of general service. As reported at the 1987 General Service Conference, the response from the Fellowship was overwhelming and it has continued through 1987 with the number of groups participating up to 55% over the preceding year's 50%. In Hawaii, Area 17, we felt the same tremendous response from our local area Fellowship. In 1986, 68% of the groups were participating and in 1987, it increased to 79 percent. We in Hawaii attribute our increase and our high level of participation to the self-support project, which brought an increase in discussion, debate, and loving communication (participation) within the Fellowship. We've identified four communication tools that we feel contributed to our increased group participation.

First, our area committee took its inventory and out of the inventory process came the need for a wider range of communication within the local service structure. It was also suggested that the districts and groups take their inventories. Our of these inventories, the Fellowship became more aware of the benefits derived from participating in the general service structure.

Each morning Bob Watts, Panel 37, Central New York, lead the more athletically-inclined delegates in a half-hour run (6:45-7:15) around the lower loop of Central Park.

Secondly, we did two area group updates during the year. Several of the district committee members reported that they believe this to be the main reason for the increase in group participation. The district committees went to the groups twice during the year for the specific task of updating the group information. During these visits, the committee thanked those groups that were presently participating and explained to those groups that were not participating the benefits derived from being actively involved in the general service structure. During this process, we were also able to sort out those groups that were no longer in existence.

Thirdly, at our monthly area committee meetings and quarterly assemblies, we have discussed the progress of the self-support project. This has kept in the forefront of our focus the five-year plan to become self-supporting. We also borrowed from several different delegate areas, ways in which they had been utilizing communication tools to increase their participation. We borrowed from the San Diego/Imperial Area their group information flyer showing the addresses of the local central office, district, area committee, and the General Service Office. Included on the flyer were suggested ways that groups might split their funds after group expenses are paid. These flyers were mailed to each district committee member who in turn distributed them to the groups in the district. This was done twice during the year. We continue to make monthly mailings to all district committee members and quarterly mailings to the general service representatives to keep them fully informed of the progress of the self-support project and the benefits of participation in Alcoholics Anonymous. Fourth, a communication tool was used, one that I believe contributed the most to our increase in participation. Prior to each monthly area committee meeting and quarterly area assembly, the district committee members caucused for at least one hour. During this sharing time they exchanged ideas on how they might better fulfill their service commitments to keep the groups informed of A.A. services.

As I reported last year at the 1987 General Service Conference, the state of Hawaii is geographically separated by water, a condition which creates financial difficulties for the districts and groups on the outside islands regarding participation in our area service structure. I'm very happy to report that because of the increased awareness of self-support as communicated through the self-support project, all of the district committees now have their own treasuries and are paying their own expenses, fully supported by the groups. The district committee members and even some of the general service representatives from the outside islands have their travel expenses paid by the groups in order to attend area assemblies and committee meetings. In fact, this year we had two district committee members' expenses paid in full so that they might attend the Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly in Utah. This is a first for us in Hawaii. In conclusion, once an A.A. need is expressed (communicated with all pertinent information), the group conscience can start its process of loving discussion and debate and, if the need is truly for the best of A.A. as a whole, the A.A. need is fulfilled. I believe that participation in the general service structure can continue to grow as the level of open and honest communication continues to grow throughout our Fellowship. Mahalo Nui Loa.

Greg Muth (Hawaii)

Self-Support at All Levels

When I arrived at the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous, I had no job, very little money, and a life that was rapidly turning into a shambles. Even so, I contributed twenty-five cents at each meeting I attended. This was my first step back to regaining my self-respect and responsibility. Where the money went, I had no idea. Nor did I care. My whole being was geared to staying away from the first drink and recovering from alcoholism. In addition, my thinking apparatus was malfunctioning. In time, I learned what the A.A. Preamble so aptly states — that we are self-supporting through our own contributions. I also learned that carrying the A.A. message costs money; from the individual making a Twelfth Step call to the General Service Office; and that it all begins with the A.A. member contributing at the group level. It is not very often mentioned, but the General Service Office, area committees, district committees, and intergroup and central offices do not have any money. It all belongs to the members of A.A. We, as trusted servants, should be aware of this at all times and be very careful as to how monies are spent. According to Tradition Five, "Each group has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 150.) It is, therefore, a group's responsibility to see that funds are provided at all levels of service to enable them to do their part in carrying that message. In the British Columbia/Yukon Area, as in many areas, a minority of groups are taking their responsibility seriously and are providing 100% of group contributions.

In view of the fact that virtually all groups are self-supporting in that they pay their rent and other expenses, I will concentrate on the other levels that depend on group contributions, and since I have experience only with the British Columbia/Yukon Area, anything I say will refer only to that area. The largest intergroup or central office in my area is the Vancouver/Lower Mainland Intergroup which services approximately two-thirds of our groups. During my involvement with intergroup over the past sixteen years, I can recall only one year that group contributions matched the expenses. They, as many intergroups do, have had to rely on profit from sales of A.A. literature to cover the deficit. These offices are the lifeline for the groups in a district. They are, on many occasions, the first line of communication between A.A. and the active alcoholic who is asking for help. It is essential that the phone service is maintained. A.A. is not self-supporting at this level!

The BC/Yukon Area is the second largest delegate area on the continent and as such, the area service committee has vast distances to travel in order to maintain personal contact with the districts. Although the travel is expensive, it is essential to service the area and to have remote, outlying districts feel a part of the whole. Approximately 45% of the groups contribute to the area. Donations from roundups, rallies, and conventions amount to around 40% of our area income each year. Obviously, a proportion of these contributions is from outside sources. This, too, cannot be considered self-supporting! And although the percentage of our groups who contribute to the General Service Office has increased from 44% to 53% in 1987, we are still well below even 50% of our groups accepting their responsibility.

The subject of money in A.A. seems to be on a par with that of religion or politics in general conversation. Most members prefer to avoid it. It is not, however, a subject that gives me any trouble, for how else can you inform members that everything costs money in this world? In A.A. it is no different. Through the years, I have found that, in A.A., money is not really a problem. Just

tell the membership that you need money, include why you need it and they provide it. We are now entering our second year of the five-year plan established in 1987 and although the response from groups has been excellent, we cannot sit back and allow apathy to creep back in or allow the membership to think that 1987 was a one-time only appeal for funds. During the past year I have on many occasions had to correct the misconception that "New York is going broke."

Communication in A.A. is as vital to the well-being of the Fellowship as repetition is to education. We, at this level of service, can only lead. Our district committee members and general service representatives are the people who must reinforce, at group level, the importance of self-support. The emphasis should be on groups who are not presently financially participating. Although 100% group participation may be unrealistic, it is the goal toward which we should be aiming. I feel very positive that our area will realize that contributions to each level of service will make them more cognizant of the fact that there is life in A.A. beyond the walls of their own meeting room. It could also mean increased involvement at district general service representative meetings and larger attendance at assemblies. Tradition Seven reads, "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 160.) It is very explicit about group responsibility and subsequent benefits to the Fellowship. I learned a long time ago that what is good for A.A. is good for Ches Norton! This may be a selfish attitude and we probably don't all agree on what is good for A.A., but I think I can safely say that we agree that adhering to the Traditions on the individual, group and service level is of primary importance. In conjunction with Tradition Seven is the second Warranty: "Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample Reserve should be its prudent financial principles." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 64.) For this we rely on our members through their groups.

In conclusion, I wish to leave you with the following thought which is quoted from page 140 of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*: "Regarding any particular service, we need to ask only one question: 'Is this or that service *really* needed?' If it is not, then let it be eliminated. But if it is needed, then maintain it we must or fail in our mission to those who want and seek A.A."

Chester Norton (British Columbia/Yukon)



AREA STRUCTURE

Wednesday afternoon's session began with three presentations illuminating three integral facets of the area structure. Dan Byrne, West Central U.S. regional trustee, moderated the session.

It All Begins in the Home Group

My home group is the Oildale Wednesday Candlelight Group. It may not be the best group in the world, but it's the best home group for me today. I attend the meeting of that group whenever I'm in town, and I'm proud to identify myself with that group.

When I received my loving invitation from Helen, I was pleased but not surprised. I've been making a lot of noise about the "home group concept" for the last year or so, and I guess it was only fitting that I be chosen to make this presentation. What no one realized is that I know next to nothing about the subject. I came to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous a little over nine years ago. It was suggested that I do certain simple things if I wanted what you had. I was told to go to meetings, to not drink, to read the Big Book, to get a sponsor, to take the Steps. No one ever suggested that I join a group! I have since learned that this situation is not unique to my hometown. In many parts of Southern California and elsewhere in the Fellowship, recovering alcoholics just "go to lots of meetings," and never join a group. The title of my presentation is "It All Begins in the Home Group." In preparing for it, I began to wonder just what "it" was. What begins in the home group? Why is it important to belong to a group. I know I don't have the answers, but I do have some thoughts on the subject.

The service structure in my hometown is not strong, and it seems that it never has been. Few of us ever identify with a particular group. By contrast, I have had the pleasure and privilege of meeting a lot of fellow alcoholics who come from very active service areas and who each identify with a home group. Is it possible that service begins in the home group? And what about unity? Is it possible that it, too, begins in a home group? How can I be "unified" with something unless I am willing to spend some time getting to know it and allowing it to get to know me? What better way to really get acquainted than to join a group? Perhaps, too, real recovery begins in a home group. I would not suggest that you cannot recover if you don't belong to a group. Our Loners and Internationalists are proof that we can recover regardless of circumstances. But I would suggest that recovery is enhanced and perhaps accelerated by membership in a group.

Let's look for a moment at the three sets of principles by which we, individually and collectively, must live: the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, and the Twelve Concepts. Even a casual reading of our Twelve Steps shows us that we are not alone. Step One begins with the word "we." In each succeeding Step, the word "we" is implied. Obviously, the road to recovery is not a lonely road. As we participate in our recovery, we become a part of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. I believe that we as individuals and collectively as a Fellowship, benefit greatly if each of us becomes part of the basic building block in A.A., the home group. The Twelve Traditions offer a structure that allows recovery to happen. That structure is the group which is mentioned seven times in the short form of the Traditions. I question whether any one of us can add to the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous if we choose to separate ourselves from a group. And now for the Twelve Concepts: Concept One states "The final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship."

(*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 1986-87 ed., p. 6.) How can our conscience speak if not through our groups? Concept Two tells us that “. . . the A.A. groups confirmed the permanent Charter for their General Service Conference . . .” (*Ibid.* p. 10.) Once again, all indications are that we must express ourselves as groups if our Fellowship is to survive and prosper. I belong to Alcoholics Anonymous everywhere in the world. I feel at home in an A.A. meeting wherever I am. But for the sake of my own recovery; for the sake of the *unity* of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; and for the sake of the *service* I’m allowed to perform for A.A., I must also belong to my home group. My home group is the Oildale Wednesday Candlelight Group, and I’m proud to be a member.

Allen Hendricks (Southern California)

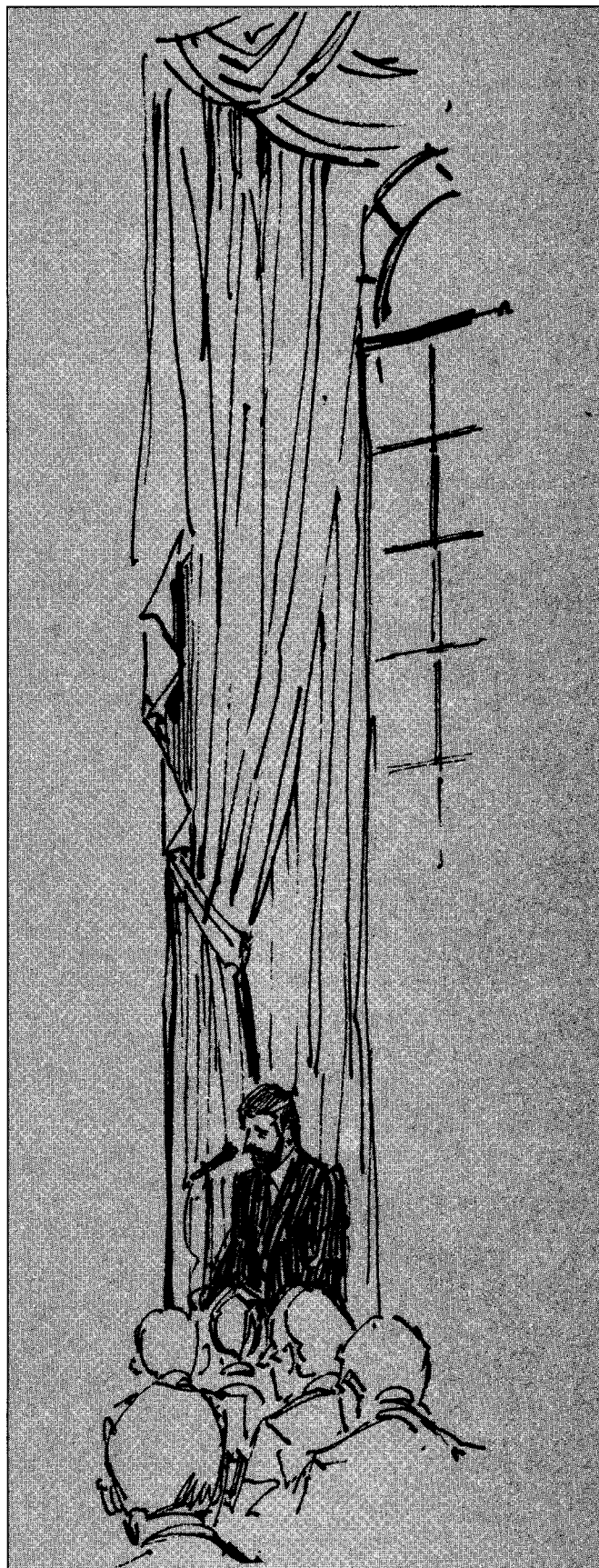
Considerations re Participation of Intergroups / Central Offices in the General Service Structure

Anything that affects A.A. unity by directing us away from our primary purpose of carrying our message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic is an issue for A.A. and must be addressed by the General Service Conference. The General Service Conference “. . . cannot be an A.A. authority, but it can bring into free discussion problems and trends and dangers that seem to affect fellowship harmony, purpose, and effectiveness.” (*The A.A. Service Manual*, 1986-87 ed., p. 69.) Is A.A. unity affected in some areas by the intergroups/central offices not being part of that area’s general service structure? If it does create disunity, how can we carry out our primary purpose?

Let us look at some of the feelings and attitudes that exist in areas where this problem exists. This can be expressed by the following statements: (1) General service — boy, they have their nerve inviting us into the structure. We were around long before you got here; (2) If general service comes in, we’re going to lose our identity and they’ll take over. Bill says that there should be a separate intergroup; (3) We have enough trouble getting the money to support our answering service and central office. Now they tell us we can’t sell the non-A.A. literature that helps support our Twelfth Step work; and (4) Those delegates who go to the Ivory Tower every year and make those decisions for us don’t tell us what those decisions were but they do manage to tell us we are doing things wrong.

Lack of communication? These statements represent real problems between intergroups/central offices and the general service structure in some areas. The intergroups/central offices provide essential services to A.A. members and A.A. groups. They are the primary points of contact for anybody to reach A.A. locally, the major sources of A.A. literature distribution, and the guide to A.A. meetings through the A.A. meeting books. Most have to struggle to make ends meet to carry out these services. One important point should be made: we are all A.A. members and as such, are members of intergroups/central offices and the general service structure. The moment we say we have a desire to stop drinking we become members in the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous with all its entities. If these entities exist in any area, it has to be the group conscience of at least some members of that area or it would not get the support to exist.

One of the most interesting experiences I have had was attending the intergroup/central office get-together in Los Angeles. A lot of honest sharing helped me understand some of the problems. The experience in our area showed all of us the importance of getting



together. To begin with, our area put history aside with its arguments and disunity. We looked at what's best for A.A. in our area. We started joint meetings between the Intergroup Committees and our General Service Committees. From these meetings, things began to develop. The area delegate attends the Intergroup Advisory Meetings quarterly. The general service liaison to intergroup attends the monthly advisory intergroup meetings. The general service liaison also gives a general service report to the intergroup monthly delegates meeting. The area delegate gives a pre-Conference and post-Conference report to the intergroup delegates meeting. Our G.S.R. workshop has a presentation by an intergroup representative. This is to give our new G.S.R.s a picture of our area and the entities that provide the A.A. services in our area and for our groups to support both. The liaisons of both entities have a voice and a vote at all of the meetings they attend.

Over the years, different committees have been formed in our area. We are now working together to see what our General Service Committees and Intergroup Committees are doing to find out if, by combining these committees, we could carry out more effectively the purposes for which they were formed. For example, intergroup had a Public Relations Committee and our area structure had a Public Information Committee. These committees are now combined and working very effectively. An example of working with other areas was when the delegate from Southern New Jersey, the delegate from Northern New Jersey and our intergroup chairperson met with an intergroup that provides services for both areas to help them with some changes in their intergroup.

There are many lively discussions at our joint meetings about Traditions, general service, guidelines, and committee workbooks. The bottom line can be expressed by a newcomer coming into A.A. What are this person's chances of gaining the gift of sobriety if he or she hears, "I'm from intergroup and we will show you how to stay sober" and then from another A.A. member, "I saw you talking to that other member and I'm from general service and we will show you the way to stay sober!"

For our area to get where it is took mutual respect and a lot of hard work by many A.A. members. We still have a long way to go. Our area feels that participation is the key; that participation is the way to solve our problems and the best means of helping us to carry our message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic. The experience of participating in the intergroup/central office get-together in Los Angeles leads me to believe that they should continue the way they are going. It seems that they feel the same way because they are having another get-together this year. They are sharing their common problems and, hopefully they will arrive at common solutions. We do not need a new area or Conference structure. All we need to do is use the one we already have. It is stated in the *A.A. Service Manual* 1986-87 ed., p. 88, "So these two separate but vital service structures coexist in many areas in mutual cooperation and harmony, to the benefit of the entire Fellowship." The only thing needed to start or continue mutual cooperation and harmony is communication — sharing the language of the heart which is the most effective way of staying sober and keeping us united.

Tom Lichwa (Northern New Jersey)

It was the sense of the Conference that communication and cooperation at all levels between General Service and Intergroup/Central Offices is vitally important, and that General Service people should reflect the interest of Intergroups/Central Offices at the Conference and area levels; however that Intergroups/Central Offices not be formally included in the General Service structure at this time.

Growth, Diversity and Maintaining Unity at the Area Level

Please be tolerant . . . English is *not* my mother tongue! Imagine how you would feel in Paris asking "S'il vous plait, garçon, un sandwich au jambon avec fromage, sans moutarde, mais avec du ketchup?" But I am a proud young lady with a true A.A. willpower and I will go through this presentation being grateful to God or to Helen for scheduling me at this time of the Conference. The majority of the audience is already tired and may not even hear what I have to say on the topic of growth, diversity, and maintaining unity at the area level.

A.A. taught me that the key to promoting diversity while maintaining unity at the area level is communication. The more often we meet and share, the better we feel. This afternoon I will share with you my area's experience and that of the Province of Quebec to show how important communication is right now. Our membership is growing and we must improve communication. In the Province of Quebec, we deal with this on two levels: the area level and the provincial level. Our area committee officers meet once a month, the area committee meets every three months, and we hold two annual assemblies. The assemblies are much smoother and peaceful when all the area officers are well informed. I think that it is partly the delegate's job to help inform the area officers. Seminars are organized on subjects like Traditions, Concepts, and the G.S.R.s' responsibilities. Public Information, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities, Finance, and Twelve Steps Committees meet on special service days. We make a special effort to deal in a most loving way with the Seventh Tradition by explaining the importance of group contributions. Our districts send their contributions to the area who sends it to G.S.O.; each D.C.M. is thus aware of the effort of every group and is in a good position to encourage the groups to participate in the Self-Support Plan. We also publish a newsletter five times a year.

Communication extends from the area to the provincial level. The four delegates from the Province of Quebec meet four times a year with the French Literature Committee to oversee their operation. The delegates also meet three times a year with the alternates, area chairpersons, chairperson of *La Vigne* (the equivalent of the Grapevine), and the chairperson of the French Literature Committee. No matter how often we meet, there is still room for improvement. Our everyday problems are caused by a lack of communication. Every problem can be solved by a clear and honest communication. Let me tell you what happened on a Saturday afternoon at the end of a long area assembly. A G.S.R. asked why his family name appeared on a report. We answered rather quickly that we usually use the full name in a closed assembly. He was hurt. Two weeks later, I heard that he was still angry about the way we dealt with his problem. So I decided to meet him in his group and at the coffee break I tried to explain the Eleventh Tradition to him. That settled the matter and we now have a G.S.R. who is no longer resentful and who serves and communicates.

At this point I must stress that the growth and unity of the four French-speaking areas of the Province of Quebec are helped by the fact that our trustee is always present at the Provincial meetings, seven times a year. His dedication to our areas is really appreciated. Growth and unity is a matter of communication. We stay in touch and handle our problems through meetings and assemblies, letters and newsletters, and long-distance telephone calls. By doing so, we remain united as we grow and that process begins here — at the Conference.

Micheline Duberger (Northeast Quebec)

RELOCATION STUDY REPORT

Following the regional trustees election Wednesday afternoon, general manager John Bragg gave a summary of the outcome of studies by the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine boards and management on the question of location of those offices when the current G.S.O. lease expires in 1991.

An outside consulting firm, the Fantus company, was retained during the past year to draw on their long experience and comprehensive databases to advise A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine on the objective factors involved in the cost of operating G.S.O. and the Grapevine in the New York area as compared to alternative locations in the United States. Their full report was distributed to Conference members before the Conference, together with a report of the position reached by A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine on the basis of the Fantus findings.

An overall calculation by Fantus of the present value of costs of operation in various locations, including both recurring and nonrecurring costs, indicated a significant difference between New York and prototype medium-sized cities, but a much smaller difference between New York and other large-sized cities.

On the other hand, examination of data on availability of professionals in publishing and communications indicated that large cities could much better support the needs of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine operations, particularly for large numbers of A.A. members who are professionals in literature, publishing and communications.

Faced with the problem of reconciling these two critical decision elements, and also considering a large number of other objective factors compiled by the Fantus organization, the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine boards recommended that the operations remain in the New York area, but that an intensive study be made of ways to reduce current operating costs when the present lease expires in 1991.

FOCUS ON THE POSITIVE

The Friday afternoon session continued with three spirited presentations on how the Fellowship continues to meet the challenge of focusing on the positive. Ralph Rosenberg, Jr., general service trustee, was the moderator.

Communications — Challenges

Communication has been, is, and will be the essence of A.A. Our accepted task, our primary purpose, is to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic; to communicate with him about what we were like, what happened, and what we are like now; to communicate our experience, strength and hope to him constantly throughout his travels on the road to recovery; to communicate with him in such a way that we can work together on the problems which slow either or both of us on our journeys; to communicate with him about his obligation, in turn, to carry the message further; and to communicate to him the knowledge of how to do it and the tools to do it with.

On the face of it, this looks like a straightforward process — one person communicating with another, passing on the message of how it works until a vast safety net for alcoholics is woven which covers the globe. But it isn't that simple or that straightforward. Therein lie the challenges to us in this 53rd year of our existence, the tests which will decide whether we are made of the same stuff as those who made it possible for us to get here, whether we can meet today's pressures on us as they met the pressures of their days.

If we look at A.A. in 1988 in the context of our history, we are made aware that those who came before us built what we now have, a block at a time, as they faced problems which arose as they tried to carry the message effectively. They have left us with codifications of their shared experiences about dealing with such problems, their pooled information and their shared conclusions about what worked best, what got us into trouble, and what was plain useless up to that point in time. But they, and Bill who recorded their experiences and conclusions masterfully, saw A.A. as always being in a state of becoming, never completed. In so many places in his writings, Bill is very explicit about their fears that we become rigid and thereby unable to realistically assess and meet new challenges, about their — and Bill's — firm belief that as long as we were able to think about past solutions only as past solutions, rather than as sacred and binding rules, we would survive and function well. This was one more time our predecessors stressed the importance of willingness to change.

And what has this to do with challenges, communications, and 1988? In my view this is a basic and crucial communication challenge — the challenge to communicate to those who follow us in A.A. an historically accurate sense of what A.A. is and how it works. Gradually our past is becoming distorted and endowed with a halo effect as those who made our beginnings are no longer around to correct our views of them and of what they did and said. We have the obligation to help those who came into A.A. after us to understand that A.A. is an ongoing process, not an end point, so that these new members can continue to meet challenges in the spirit of A.A. — looking at new problems from a wide variety of perspectives, trying out all kinds of solutions (including traditional ones), keeping an open mind to the problem and open ears to each other, and finally choosing the solutions which are best for that particular problem at that particular place and at that particular time. Only with this kind of understanding of our history will A.A. continue as the vital and effective carrier of the message which it is in 1988.

Over the past 53 years, we have gained a great deal of experience in carrying the message. From the outset the most effective passing of the message was through the words of one alcoholic to another. But almost from the beginning we learned that nonalcoholics could also spread the message and transmit our program. Our history tells of many groups being started by concerned relatives or professionals. The written word has also served us well. The press wrote glowingly about us and thousands upon thousands knocked on our doors. Suffering alcoholics wrote to what is now G.S.O. and were told how to find a group, or, if there was no group, were supported in their efforts to form one or to work the program by themselves. The Big Book was often the only source of hope, shared experience, and information about the program. By now the Fellowship has developed an extensive body of literature to serve the still-suffering alcoholic as well as those who seek to reach him and help him. We have made superb use of new media as they develop — tapes, videos, films, and lately, computer networking. We still use most of these methods which we used in the past but we have honed them

In the midst of a discussion of the literature committee report, which was replete with lettered and numbered items, general manager John Bragg referred to "item 3 a-a" rather than "3a." Catching himself he quipped: "If I'm going to make a Freudian slip, let it be that!"

and extended them. You would think we could rest on our laurels. But that is not the A.A. way. There are still alcoholics out there whom we are not reaching. We are asking why not? Sometimes it seems to be due to a language barrier and we have undertaken making translations of our basic literature. Sometimes it is because we have not yet made it possible for some alcoholics to identify with us. We have created pamphlets to reach them — for the young, women, and lately, for Native Americans. Each time we have met such needs, A.A. has experienced a surge of new members. But there are still others whom we do not reach as effectively as we should. Challenges we have worked on almost since we began remain challenges; for example, finding ways to help more black, Hispanic, Native American, handicapped, aged, and lately, Russian alcoholics to use our program.

Some of our challenges to communicate arise out of our great success. We are sent large numbers of suffering people, in such numbers that they threaten to overwhelm us. Some are alcoholics who want our help; many are alcoholics who are not ready or willing to come to us; and others have problems other than alcohol. We are faced with communicating to the courts, to treatment centers, and to hospitals what we can and cannot do. We are faced with communicating to courts and treatment facilities who would make us an arm of their programs, what the boundaries of our help must be. We are faced with somehow meeting the needs of those who do not, or do not yet belong to us, who prove disruptive to our meetings and our ability to help each other and those who *do* want what we have to offer.

We have made constructive beginnings. C.P.C., P.I., Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees, armed with workbooks which provide them with our pooled experiences, are seeking to open up communications, to use tried and true A.A. methods for resolving misunderstandings, meeting with those who do not understand, trying to hear their problems and work out solutions for their problems with us and ours with them. We are experimenting with ways of orienting those they send to us so that we can serve them and yet continue to serve our own members and others who are ready for us. We are working on such concepts as bridge sponsorship to connect their clients to us one by one instead of en masse. These ways keep communication channels open so that we can work together to meet the challenges. Some of our experimental solutions, however, tend to close communication down. One hears of groups which have opted out of the challenge and withdrawn in upon themselves. Some have resorted to classifying, judging who is a candidate to belong, making rules. All these cut them off from hearing and responding to the pain of people who come to them. One hears that we cannot help nonalcoholic sufferers. Yet it is obvious that this is untrue. Twelve Step programs in myriad variety have followed our lead and have proved helpful to people with problems other than alcohol. Some groups have been hostile to such people. Some have heard the pain, understood the search for help, and guided them to the Twelve Step programs which are right for them.

These are only a few of the challenges to effective communicating we face today. We need to think of more ways and we need to try them out. We need more communicating with each other so that our pooled experiences can yield the best solutions. And it will take every one of us. Thus, there is another major communication problem to be solved. What kind of communicating is necessary to persuade those groups who do not now contribute to the overall search for solutions to join the service structure and do their part? What kind of communicating is necessary to ensure that we will all — each member of A.A. — be a part of carrying the message to those who have not yet heard it, and of

supporting those who have heard the message and are taking their early steps towards recovery?

These are only a few of the challenges of 1988. Our predecessors met the challenges which, in their day, seemed equally overwhelming. Now, to you, the Conference of 1988, who go back to what is Alcoholics Anonymous in 1988, the challenge is thrown. Can we continue the processes of communicating which have come down to us, can we work out solutions in the A.A. way to the problems we have now? To the problems still to come?

Joan Jackson, Ph.D. (Class A trustee)

What Are We Doing Right?

I guess the first question to ask is, “so what is *right*?” Some of the definitions of the word “right” are as follows: straight, not crooked; upright, erect from a base; well in body, mind, spirit, or the like; in good condition; normal mentally; sane; to bring or restore to the proper or natural position; to adjust. Interestingly enough, in the dictionary, after all the definitions for the word “right,” the next word to be found is “rigid”: not pliant, stiff, unyielding, firm, inflexibly fixed or set in opinion or conduct; uncompromising inflexibility; undeviating conformity to rules, standards, requirements, etc. I sometimes wonder about why those two words in the dictionary were put so close together. Was it done by reason or by coincidence? Doesn’t the word “right” sound like the principle? And doesn’t the word “rigid” sound like how that principle is being carried out or interpreted? If I asked each one of you in this room on an individual basis, what are we doing right, wouldn’t your answers be closely tied to the principles of A.A.? Conversely, if I asked each of you in this room what are we doing wrong, wouldn’t your answers be tied to the interpretations of those principles? For instance, too rigid vs. too flexible?

Aren’t many of the questions and topics posed for the Conference dealing with the interpretations of the principles? For example, are we being too friendly with our friends? Limiting my discussion just to the Conference level, how do we know if what we are doing as the General Service Conference is right for A.A. as a whole? To this alcoholic, the checklist is the Twelfth Concept, the Warranties, or should I say Article 12 of the Conference Charter — all one and the same. Article 12 of the Conference Charter, adopted in 1955, was so important to Bill W. that he also made it Concept Twelve in 1962. The first eleven articles of the Conference Charter can be amended by the Conference itself.

But alas, Article 12, which contains the Warranties, can only be amended or changed by a written vote of three-quarters of all directory-listed groups, and only after a six-month deliberation. (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 62.) Should this not then be the checklist for considering what we are doing right at the Conference level?

The Conference is named the “guardian of the Traditions,” and those Traditions express the principles and attitudes for harmony within our Fellowship that we, as the General Service Conference, are expected to exemplify to the highest possible degree. (*Ibid*, p. 63.) Isn’t *that* what we are doing right? That at the Conference level we practice these principles so we don’t have to go and *tell* A.A. as a whole what to do but rather *show* them what worked for us? Somewhere in our literature is a statement to this effect: “(Our leaders) do not drive us by mandate; they lead by example.” (*Ibid*, p. 64.) Do we show them that we keep the spirit of principles over personalities? After several years of service work,

Celebrating A.A. birthdays (or anniversaries — depending on what part of the country you're from) during Conference week: Jack Whitehouse, East Central regional trustee and G.S.O. Conference coordinator Helen Turnquest — each with 14 years of sobriety.

are “personalities” just a little more developed? Do we show them that a loving God expresses Himself through our group conscience? And do we show them that we trust the process of reaching an informed group conscience by way of the committee system, substantial unanimity and the minority right to be heard? And that we took no actions in anger, haste, or recklessness? Do we show A.A. as a whole that when the Conference comes together, it acts for their benefit, not for a special interest group, promoters, or for a particular area or region? Did we show them that when truly necessary, we stuck to an issue until settled, without compromising? Did we also show them that “we must never lose sight of the fact that progress is nearly always characterized by a series of improving compromises?” Did we listen to all? Sometimes “very prideful or angry people can sometimes be dead right, when the calm and the more humble are quite mistaken.” (*Ibid*, p. 40.)

Did we vote thoughtfully, without emotionalism? Did we have real reasons and were they for the good of A.A. as a whole? Did we ponder carefully what its effect will be? “The temptation will almost always be to seize the nearby benefits and quite forget about the harmful precedents or consequences that we may be setting in motion.” (*Ibid*, p. 41.) Were the attributes of the Conference tolerance, responsibility, flexibility, and vision? Above all, did we act with prudence? The Warranties are counsels of prudence — prudence in personal relatedness, prudence in our relations with the world about us. For us, prudence is a workable middle ground; a channel of clear sailing between the obstacles of fear on one side and recklessness on the other. Prudence in practice creates a definite climate; the only climate in which harmony, effectiveness and consistent spiritual progress can be achieved. The Warranties of Article 12 express the wisdom of taking forethought for the future based on the lessons of the past. They are the sum of our protection against the very human temptations of wealth, prestige, power and the like.

One of the greatest sayings I've heard in this Fellowship is that A.A. is a “self-adjusting society.” Remember that one of my earlier definitions for the word “right” was “to adjust.” Wouldn't it then be appropriate to say that we are a self-righting Fellowship rather than a self-righteous one? That, to me, is what we are doing right; forever protecting this process so that we become “right” and not “rigid.”

Judith Whitehouse (Central Michigan)

Spirit of Rotation

First of all, I want to thank Helen (I think) and whoever else is responsible for the loving invitation that put me here. It seems that some of my first service jobs were not begun with great enthusiasm. In fact, there was some pushing and prodding to become a responsible and active member of Alcoholics Anonymous and to do whatever job I was given to the very best of my ability. When one takes a service job, one takes on a responsibility to one's self, one's group, one's area, and to Alcoholics Anonymous

as a whole. As Bill states in the Ninth Tradition, “Just as the aim of each A.A. member is personal sobriety, the aim of our service is to bring sobriety within reach of all who want it.” (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 175.)

Any service job has much to teach us if we stay open-minded and willing to do our best. First of all, it gets us involved, *really* involved, in Alcoholics Anonymous and what our beautiful Fellowship really is all about; how it came to be, and how a loving God, as He speaks through our group conscience, keeps us going “one day at a time.” Also, we learn that whatever service jobs we are doing, we are doing them as trusted servants. Bill tells us that “All . . . representatives are to be guided in the spirit of service, for true leaders in A.A. are but trusted and experienced servants on the whole. They derive no real authority from their titles; they do not govern.” (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 191-192.) Also, as trusted servants, we have a responsibility to uphold that trust by being informed leaders. When one rotates out of a service job, why is this beneficial not only to the person rotating out but to Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole? As Bernard Smith stated in one of his talks at the General Service Conference, “. . . it is in keeping with the expanding unwritten body of tested tradition that is being accepted throughout A.A.: that while A.A. is important to the existence of the individual, no individual must be vital to the existence of A.A.” (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 282.)

The debt I owe to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous will never be repaid in my lifetime and the person who rotates into the job I had now too has the right to begin to repay his or her debt to Alcoholics Anonymous. He or she now gets the opportunity to have a whole new world unfold. That person too will learn the responsibilities attached to being involved in A.A. and will be responsible to see that I never violate the principle of rotation. He or she will learn that one person's control is not the “group conscience” and that one person's control is not “principles before personalities.” The principle of rotation which guides all service functions will continue to save Alcoholics Anonymous from the only people who can destroy it — us! Rotation also, and perhaps most importantly, helps me to grow in humility. There is a rule, number 62, which tells me not to take myself too seriously. As Bill tells us in the Twelve and Twelve, humility “is an all-pervading spiritual quality which today keynotes A.A. life everywhere . . . We try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members . . . As we lay aside these very human aspirations, we believe that each of us takes part in the weaving of the protective mantle which covers our whole Society and under which we may grow and work in unity.” (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 187.)

Our goal must be to become, when we rotate out of our service jobs, a “true elder statesman,” one that leads by example; not driving others by mandate. The true spirit of service, as Bill states in the closing paragraphs of the Twelfth Concept, is as follows: “Freedom under God to grow in His likeness and image will ever be the quest of Alcoholics Anonymous. May our General Service Conference be always seen as a chief symbol of this cherished liberty. To a man, we of A.A. believe that our freedom to serve is truly the freedom by which we live — the freedom in which we have our being.” (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 1986-87 ed., p. 75.) And so I thank you all for the honor of serving you and the trust and love you've given me. When I rotate off, I will do so with love for each of you and with the trust and knowledge that you will always do what's best for Alcoholics Anonymous — God's Fellowship.

Ann Bruning (Arkansas)

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference — via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: In recent times I have found myself, each year, reporting on the previous year as being particularly eventful; 1987 was also an eventful year. It is clear that as the Fellowship grows and becomes a more important factor in the societies of the United States and Canada we will continue to live in eventful times.

As I report on 1987 I will, since this is my last year as chairperson, also indulge myself with a few remarks on the state of the Fellowship and on what I see ahead. We have a strong and vital Fellowship, served by a strong and vital Conference. However, some the challenges of the day are new or of greater dimension than in the past. And sometimes we may be at a loss to respond to them. There has been a great deal of interest in our prudent reserve; curiously not whether it is "an ample reserve" as required by our Warranties, but rather whether it is *too* big. We need to remind ourselves that when Bill W. introduced the phrase "corporate poverty" he was enunciating an alternative to accepting outside contributions (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 165). Thankfully we are moving *closer* to rather than *farther* from that status today.

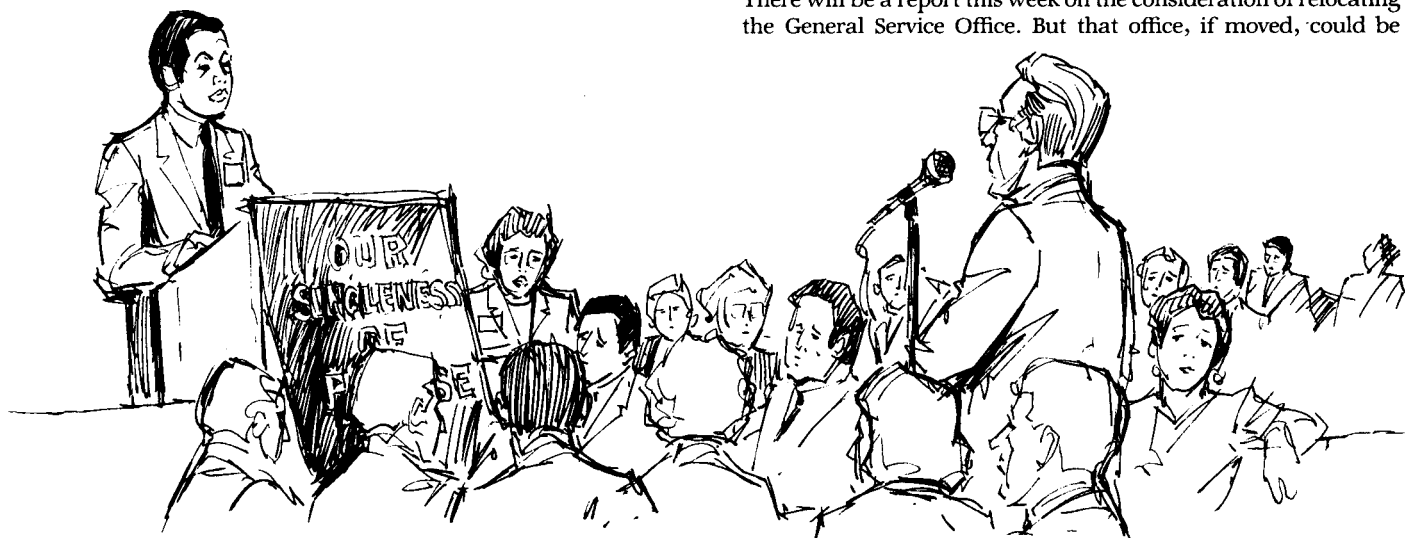
In particular, our move to a single price schedule for our literature, although it may cause temporary pain to some, is a giant step away from dependence on outside income. Actually the amount of the prudent reserve today, per registered member of our Fellowship, is about eight dollars. In the judgment of our finance committee it is large enough to protect A.A. in emergencies. So we are trying to reach *zero* net income for G.S.O. operations, and the A.A. groups and the service structure are making that possible through the response to the self-support initiative. Our self-support initiative has been solidly supported and we have been able to reduce literature prices in several steps totaling about twenty-five percent. This is something the membership has done in response to our communicating the need.

Our glorious past was necessarily full of catch-as-catch-can management (witness the loss of the Big Book copyright in 1967), but that should not be a model for careless management today. It is our responsibility to have the Fellowship on as sound a footing as our resources and our growing membership can provide. We have another recent example of how the willingness to take responsibility has benefited the Fellowship. The Regional Forums were instituted in 1977 to improve communications between the board, the office and the Fellowship. I attended four Regional Forums this year and was impressed, even more than before, with how fully that has been realized.

We now have a new challenge, one of the largest of recent years, presented by the beginnings of A.A. in eastern European countries. They have suffering alcoholics in numbers rivaling ours; how will we respond in the face of apparent conflicts between their society and our Traditions? Are their conflicts any more serious than the differences between *our* society and our Traditions? Conflict in our society has been dramatized recently by anonymity breaks in the media and in published books. Our most cherished and fundamental Tradition is perhaps in greater jeopardy than ever before. Can we revitalize this Tradition; extend its understanding throughout the Fellowship; ensure that newcomers from treatment facilities understand it; reach every A.A. member with Bill's last message? We have to remember that the understanding and practice of anonymity is *our* responsibility. If we don't preserve and emphasize it, nobody will.

This brings to mind the overall problem of *participation* in every aspect of our Fellowship. Amid the success of the self-support effort in 1987 one somber note remains. Only 55% of A.A. groups registered in New York participated. And we know that about 20% of all groups in the U.S. and Canada are not even registered at G.S.O. I believe that a lack of interest is also manifested in group participation at the area level. How can we enhance knowledge, understanding, responsibility and participation in all aspects of our Fellowship? Let's think particularly of an understanding of anonymity as a spiritual principle!

An interesting related experiment is under way on our operating boards. To enhance communication, a director of the Grapevine Board is being proposed at this Conference from Washington state. A consultant to the A.A.W.S. Board has been appointed from Georgia. Search for G.S.O. staff members is always extended throughout the United States and Canada. We hope that these experiments will succeed and that we can expand the practice. There will be a report this week on the consideration of relocating the General Service Office. But that office, if moved, could be



moved to only *one* other place. On the other hand, Regional Forums can go everywhere, and have done much to improve communications. Now we are emphasizing representation on our staff from everywhere (not to exclude New York, of course) and are experimenting with inviting committee members and board members from throughout the United States and Canada. This is going to be an expensive experiment, and those board and committee members are going to have an arduous experience, but if it works we will have taken another step toward making our boards and office more nearly representative of the whole Fellowship.

We have assisted the intergroups and central offices in holding their second seminar. You will recall that the first seminar was initiated by G.S.O. with the idea of discussing literature pricing and distribution, and the second was requested by the intergroups and central offices. The second seminar resulted in more general sharing, and a request that we help them with a third seminar. I know that there is an uneasy relationship in some areas between intergroup/central offices and general service. One of the concerns of the intergroups seems to be that their interests are not represented at this Conference. I hope that delegates will have some ideas about how the concerns of trusted servants responsible for intergroup/central offices can be considered at future Conferences. One of their concerns has to do with funding their activities. Perhaps we can find a way of emphasizing to the Fellowship that intergroup/central offices have self-support problems similar to the General Service Office.

As you know, the Grapevine has been discussed and analyzed a great deal in the recent past. I believe the board's activities in this regard have paid off; excellent work on the parts of the Grapevine Board and Grapevine staff has brought about a recovery in finance and in spirit that will be reported to you by the chairperson of the Grapevine Board.

This is my last General Service Conference report. It is now rotation time for me. After seven years as a Class A trustee and six years as chairperson of the board I will relinquish my responsibility to the new chairperson at my final board meeting on Saturday. I will have an opportunity later in the week to share some thoughts about my experience over these past thirteen years.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc. is, in effect, a wholly owned subsidiary of the General Service Board with the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office. We meet monthly; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; approve or disapprove requests from outsiders and A.A. members to reprint our copyrighted literature; discuss matters of G.S.O. administration and publishing operations; etc.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Four are trustees, including two regional trustees; one is the general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending our meetings, but not voting, are the other staff members, the director of finance, the controller, the services director, the secretary, and the recording secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The operating departments (Publishing, Finance, and Support Services) report to the director of finance/business administration, as does the director of human resources. The A.A. staff, Stenographic/Clerical Department, and Archives report to the services director.

The A.A.W.S. Board met 12 times during 1987. The following significant items are noted:

- Recommended the 1987 budget to the trustees' Finance Committee for approval.
- With board authorization, A.A.W.S., Inc. transferred \$887,900 to the General Service Board to cover operating deficits for the year ended December 31, 1986. Surplus cash in excess of basic operating requirements amounting to \$500,000, was transferred to the General Service Board Reserve Fund on March 23, 1987.
- Recommended to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee the proposed budget revisions amounting to \$277,500 additional income and \$287,900 additional expense. Major expense items are \$97,000 for a computer study, \$26,000 for a relocation study and a \$62,400 correction on the original construction budget.
- Due to the dedication and hard work of the D.C.M.s and others, contributions have increased more than 37% over the previous year and the percentage of groups registered with us that have contributed increased to about 55% at year end. As a result, the following actions were taken during the year. We approved a 4% discount on literature sales to all purchasers effective April 1, 1987 on orders of \$25.00 or more. We approved an additional 8% reduction on prices of all literature we sell effective August 1, 1987 (these actions did not apply to Spanish, French and foreign literature). We budgeted an additional price decrease of about 12% effective March 1, 1988. We budgeted a reduction of non-A.A. prices to the revised A.A. price. This last action results in a single schedule of prices to all purchasers. Other items such as Spanish and French language literature will reflect similar price reductions. The budgetary impact of the changes in 1988 will be a reduction of net income by \$815,000, made possible by projected group contributions 15% higher than 1987.
- A meeting was held in Washington, DC, between persons active in the alcoholism field in the United States and three leaders of the Temperance Promotion Society of the Soviet Union. John Bragg attended and described Alcoholics Anonymous. The Soviets toured various facilities in the United States. As a result of this meeting, A.A. was invited to participate in an upcoming exchange in Russia, which we accepted, subject to observance of our Traditions. John Bragg attended with other Americans representing various segments of the alcoholism field. John represented this office with the purpose of providing information on A.A. to government and professional Soviets.
- Granted the request from the Denmark Literature Committee for financial assistance in the amount of \$6,000 to reprint the *Twelve Steps* and *Twelve Traditions*. This help is given under the usual terms, i.e., the inventory is to remain the property of A.A.W.S., Inc., until such time as the total amount has been repaid.
- Granted or had no objection to 98 requests to reprint from A.A. literature and six requests to tape. We denied or objected to 12 requests to reprint and two requests to tape.
- Established a policy stating that requests within A.A. for permission to reproduce audiovisuals not be granted.
- Authorized John Bragg, as president of A.A.W.S., Inc., to execute a new pension fund agreement between A.A.W.S. and the Bank of New York.

John Bragg on Friday afternoon: "I keep saying resignation instead of recommendation . . ."

- Welcomed Ruth Jagodzinski as a trustee director to replace Jack Ford.

- Hired a new staff member, John Grant, to replace Maureen Costello.

- Helen Turnquest attended the Fourth European Service Meeting held in Frankfurt, West Germany, March 6-8, 1987, where she delivered the keynote address.

- The second Central Office/Intergroup Seminar held in Los Angeles, September 18-20, 1987, had 137 in attendance and proved very successful.

- The October 1987 stock market crash had no serious impact on this office. The Reserve Fund is entirely in government securities, and the Retirement Trust Fund is slightly more than half in fixed income, slightly less than half in equity. The fund had benefitted from a good deal of appreciation and the overall effect of about 12% reduction in the principal was simply to retrace some of the appreciation realized earlier in 1987.

- Our copyright attorneys sent a letter to the publisher and Nan Robertson, the author, regarding her book *A.A. — Inside Alcoholics Anonymous*, which contains excerpts from A.A. literature, the use of A.A.'s trademark, and a violation of the Twelfth Tradition. Due to lack of cooperation on the part of the author and the publisher, we were advised by legal counsel to expeditiously take all appropriate action with respect to trademark violation, including litigation if necessary, regarding the book, which gives the impression it is allied with A.A. and also threatens to be harmful to A.A. interests. As a result some, but not all, objectionable features have been removed.

- The study of our new computer system reached the solicitation of proposals from vendors. They will be evaluated in March by Peat-Marwick, G.S.O. employees and our external committee.

- Agreed to renegotiate the renewal rights to *As Bill Sees It* once these rights mature, and to discontinue negotiations with Lois Wilson's attorney.

- Approved the following prices: *It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell* (film), 16mm film and video cassette, \$100; weekly rental, \$35; cassette \$15; *Young People* (film), 16mm film and video cassette, \$150; weekly rental, \$35; cassette, \$15; "A Newcomer Asks" (Spanish), 15¢; "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" (Spanish), 10¢; "A.A. for the Woman" (Spanish), 20¢; "Do You Think You're Different?" (Spanish), 20¢; "This is A.A." (Chinese and Russian), 55¢; "A Newcomer Asks" (Chinese and Russian), 45¢; "44 Questions" (Chinese and Russian), 85¢; *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (Polish), \$3.60; "Too Young?" (revised), 15¢; A.A. Guidelines on Finance (first ten free), 10¢.

- Ruth Jagodzinski, Don Pritts and Sarah Price met in San Francisco with members of Creating a Sober World on January 12, 1988 to discuss their request to translate the Big Book into Russian. CASW has decided not to translate the Big Book but it will be done by individual A.A. members, who do not plan to publish it, although they will be taking the manuscript into the Soviet Union on future visits. Their target date is April 1988, and they will send us a copy of the translation when it is completed.

- Referred to the Report and Charter Committee the request from the trustees' Conference Committee that we send complimentary copies of the *Final Conference Report* to G.S.R.s, and if desirable, to do so through direct mailing or through the Service Structure.

Joe Phelan, chairperson

Trustees' committee: We met three times since the 1987 Conference. Our summer meeting was held at the Archives of the General Service Office to allow our members a "hands on" opportunity to become acquainted with new acquisitions and familiar with the arrangement of the collection.

A paper entitled "A.A.'s Roots in the Oxford Group" was approved for distribution to interested members of the Fellowship. Willard Hunter, longtime friend of A.A. and an Oxford Grouper, worked with Mel Barger, an A.A. historian, to prepare this material.

Many members throughout the U.S. & Canada have begun gathering material for a series of *Markings* articles on the history of A.A.'s growth within the black community. The project is moving ahead swiftly under the tutelage of Harold Greene and Garrett Taylor. In addition to uncovering many previously unknown aspects of this subject, much more experience is being amassed on how to undertake efforts of this nature.

Our *Handbook For Setting Up An Alcoholics Anonymous Archival Repository* was revised to incorporate new material received from archival centers.

It has come to our attention that much original A.A. archival material is currently collected elsewhere. These include early drafts of our literature as well as A.A. Publishing, Works Publishing, and Alcoholic Foundation correspondence of which we have, at most, carbon copies. Our committee urged the archivist to make every effort to obtain originals of this material.

The background sheet that accompanies the pre-publication manuscript of *Alcoholics Anonymous* was revised to underscore that this is distributed as a historical document and it is not Conference-approved material.

Some confusion existed with respect to the Conference-approved limit of \$1,000 on contributions by members, and the value of donations to the Archives of important historical items. The committee unanimously agreed that these donations are historical in character and not financial. Therefore, no monetary value should be placed on them by the Archives Committee, as we have no intention of selling or carrying them as capital items. Contributors might have independent appraisers place valuations on these for their needs.

Thomas G. Hills, chairperson



Archivist's report: Virtually every day of the past year saw at least one visitor in the Archives researcher's room. These were Bob Pearson's helpers gathering raw material for the preparation of the first draft of the forthcoming history of our Fellowship, 1955-85. These welcomed intruders poured over state and area records, corporate minutes of the General Service Board, the Alcoholic Foundation, A.A. World Services and the Grapevine. They dug deeply into the transcripts of the oral histories and group, intergroup and central office records. They may well have enough material for a five-volume history!

We find we still have large gaps in area histories that require the aid of our delegates and trustees to fill. Many of these servants are on the road tracking the missing material. Thus, the collective undertaking is expected to contribute importantly to the quantitative and qualitative expansion of our entire collection.

Most recently, we have completed a number of indexing projects in anticipation of our conversion to a computer-assisted retrieval system. Almost all of Bill's correspondence and our newspaper clippings through 1961 have been indexed by subject. This will greatly enhance our ability to assist researchers.

Our collection also grew as a result of many donations received during the year. For protection against total loss, we had long ago hoped to store a duplicate set of important books, including a complete set of 16 printings each of the first and second editions of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, at an offsite archival storage facility. Because of the generosity of our members, particularly Carl B. who contributed some 17 first and second edition printings alone, we will soon be able to achieve this goal.

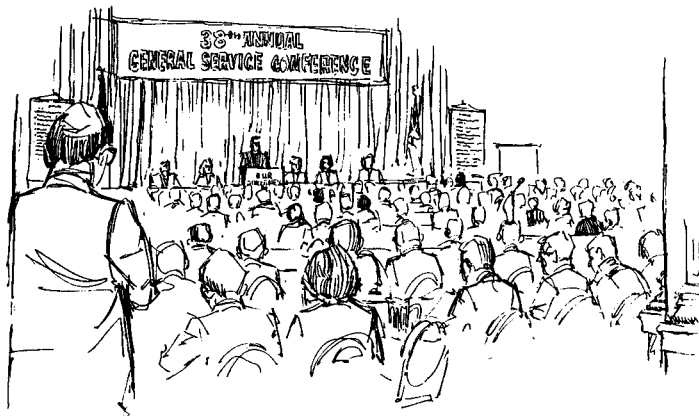
Vigorous gathering of oral histories and memorabilia of early-timers have been undertaken with the result of the publication of local histories during the past year: *Our Stories Disclose*, a History of the Washington Area of Alcoholics Anonymous 1941-85; *Alcoholics Anonymous Goes West*; a History of A.A. Coming to the West Country (England); and *Twenty-second District (Southern California) History*. So, the study of our past does have a meaningful relevancy to many of us history buffs. And according to reports, more of us seem to be forming study groups of our history and Traditions.

Frank Mauser, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: We reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, post Conference Sharing Session and letters from the Fellowship and suggested the following:

- Make Ed Gordon's presentation on Finance a scheduled item earlier in the day and allow time for questions.
- Inform delegates, in advance, of the voting procedures (including Robert's Rules) used at the Conference.
- Change the orientation of the Sunday afternoon Sharing Session to a more general, informal gathering.
- Allow more time for Conference Committee meetings and for committee reports.
- Provide A.A. meetings Tuesday through Friday from 7:30-8:30 a.m.
- Schedule two meeting for the Site-selection Committee that hears bids for the 1995 International Convention.



- Refer the suggestion that next year's Conference theme be from Dr. Bob's philosophy, e.g., "Keep It Simple," or "Love and Service," to the Conference Agenda Committee for consideration.

- Recommend that trustee chairpersons give only highlights of their reports on Monday afternoon instead of reading the entire report.

The committee discussed all other items sent for the Conference Agenda and suggested the secretary of the committee communicate the committee's decisions regarding each item not chosen and why. Such reasons were: previously covered in submitted workshop questions; has to do with group or area autonomy; or has been discussed in a very recent General Service Conference. Most items were forwarded to an appropriate Conference committee. Workshop questions were approved for distribution to Conference members in January.

The committee suggested that G.S.R.s receive a complimentary copy of the *Final Conference Report* and, with agreement from A.A.W.S. Inc., referred this questions to the Conference Report and Charter Committee for consideration.

The committee reviewed and accepted the final Conference Agenda and the list of participants selected for the various Conference sessions.

Ruth Jagodzinski, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is a contact for all Conference members and all those serving on the General Service Committees in the 91 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

All A.A. members are encouraged to submit suggestions for the General Service Conference Agenda. This is usually accomplished through the delegates. The suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval. Following that, they are shared with the Fellowship via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda (mailed to the delegates in January).

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Collecting ideas for the Conference theme and Conference agenda.
- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Sending monthly letters and advance correspondence to all delegates in preparation for the Conference.

- Working with the general manager, office manager, and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating the Conference.
- Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Final Conference Report*.
- Reviewing minutes, reports, and all communications received from General Service Area Committees and district committee members.
- Coordinating the Annual Open House.

Growth of the Fellowship has led to an increase in the number of districts, now listed at the General Service Office. Districts have been innovative in dividing into smaller units when necessary, and many now have slates of officers similar to area committees. Contact is maintained with all these current trusted servants, and also with past delegates.

On November 14, 1987, 766 A.A.s from many states, primarily the Northeast region, toured the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. The enthusiasm and spirit of volunteers and visitors was uplifting and contagious.

Helen Turnquest

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: In August 1987 the committee discussed the proposal that a literature holder be produced for pamphlets distributed at the Professional Exhibit booth and recommended that a holder be designed and submitted to the committee for its approval at the October meeting. It was suggested that the design include the address of the General Service Office and space for local information. It was also suggested that cost estimates be brought to the October meeting.

At the October meeting the committee reviewed the samples of the proposed literature holder and authorized the production of 15,000 double holders in beige with the A.A. logo placed halfway down the front cover. After reviewing the small response from areas to a letter sent to them on September 4 regarding a portable professional exhibit, the committee deleted this project from the 1988 budget. The committee also discussed the proposal to send a videotape player and monitor to show A.A. videos; specifically "Young People in A.A."; "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell"; and "A.A. — An Inside View" at selected meetings on the Professional Exhibit schedule. In view of the potential for misunderstanding intent, the committee requested the committee secretary make arrangements to have this proposal tested at the Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse (SECAD/12) in Atlanta in December and to report the results to the committee at its January meeting.

The results of this showing were reviewed in January and the committee requested the secretary schedule videos to be shown at future professional meetings and to report reactions to the committee at the July meeting. The committee also approved the additional expense of this project.

The committee reviewed the condition of the Professional Exhibit and learned that extensive restoration and refurbishing of the six units had been completed, as had the updating of the statistics reflected by the latest A.A. survey.

The committee had a wide-ranging discussion on recommendations that some special initiatives for reaching out to black alcoholics need to be considered. The possibility of a special forum or workshop was mentioned. It was decided to share this with the Conference C.P.C. Committee as part of a further exploration of this topic.

William E. Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: We have six Professional Exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1987 our exhibits were shown at 23 meetings, resulting in more than 1,200 requests for additional information. These exhibits also help increase the *About A.A.* mailing list, which is now over 23,000.

The C.P.C. staff person responds to all mail and telephone inquiries from organizations outside the Fellowship. In 1987 there were approximately 1,650 mail inquiries. The staff member also attends annual meetings of some of the national organizations dealing with alcoholism and serves as a representative of A.A., in a liaison capacity, on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism.

Some of the meetings that staff or board members have attended or participated in are: National Council on Alcoholism Forum, Cleveland, Ohio; Congress of Correction of the American Correctional Association, New Orleans, Louisiana; Alcohol and Drug Problems Association Conference, St. Louis, Missouri; Conference of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism (ALMACA), Chicago, Illinois; Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse (SECAD), Atlanta, Georgia.

The staff member also maintains communication with A.A. members involved in C.P.C. service. C.P.C. committees have increased significantly over the past year, with 579 now listed at G.S.O. New district, intergroup and area C.P.C. committee chairpersons receive the C.P.C. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary C.P.C. literature and service material is sent to new C.P.C. committee members, and discount packages are also available. They also receive *About A.A.* and *Box 4-5-9*, which has a section devoted to P.I. and C.P.C. activities.

Cheryl Burke-Hughes

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The committee secretary was authorized to visit the Texas Department of Corrections in an effort to gain information about specific methods which might be used to develop A.A. literature and audiovisual materials. A member of the committee who also serves on the trustees' Literature Committee acts as liaison, keeping everyone informed of the literature committees' progress in preparing easy-to-read material.

The committee reviewed the finished videotape of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and also reviewed an open-captions version for the hearing impaired. Both were approved for distribution. A letter to correctional facilities and institutions committees announcing the availability of the new video and film was recommended. Since correctional facilities committees were sent complimentary copies of the video, a follow-up letter sharing the positive responses to the video and the various ways it is being used was also recommended. The committee recommended

proceeding with a Spanish translation of the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee also agreed to cover the cost of translation into French if the French Literature Committee determines such a translation would be worthwhile. Because of its value as a tool in carrying the message to judges, prison administrators, and others in the professional community, the committee suggested that the Public Information Committee should send a press release announcing the availability of the film and video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" as soon as possible. It was also suggested that the film or video be shown at regular A.A. meetings to inform the Fellowship about this form of Twelfth Step work.

A possible decentralization of the Institutions Correspondence Service at G.S.O. to the delegate areas was discussed. It was agreed to continue the Correspondence Service from G.S.O. and delegate as much activity as possible to local committees.

The ongoing need for outside correspondents for the Institutions Correspondence Service were considered resulting in the following suggestions:

- All trustees, directors, appointed committee members and staff be encouraged to emphasize the importance and need for this type of Twelfth Step work when speaking at Regional Forums, conventions, assemblies, roundups and other A.A. gatherings.
- Letters from disappointed inmates waiting for outside correspondence can be shared in the correctional facilities section of *Box 4-5-9* and the Grapevine as part of an article or story about the Institutions Correspondence Service.
- Consider updating the list of inmates wanting correspondence more often to ensure accurate addresses.
- Review all procedures and letters for the Institutions Correspondence Service emphasizing that outside correspondents may use their group P.O. Box for the return address.

The 1988 projected budget in the amount of \$38,500 was accepted.

The committee recommended replacing the pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons" with two documents — a brief flyer with information about A.A. for prison officials and a simplified guide for inside and outside people who want to start A.A. groups or meetings in correctional facilities.

It was recommended that a letter be sent to area and local correctional facilities committees and institutions committees encouraging them to establish interim sponsorship programs in areas where there currently are none.

Ways in which area, district, and intergroup committees dealing with institutions and correctional facilities may become self-supporting should be discussed by the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities with emphasis on the need for good communication among the various service entities.

Amos E. Reed, chairperson

Staff report: As of the end of February, there were 1,372 active A.A. groups comprising approximately 40,000 A.A.s in correctional facilities (U.S. and Canada) listed in our records at G.S.O. There are also 495 correctional facilities groups in the "unknown" category because we currently have no active contacts listed for the groups. These groups are presently served by approximately 500 correctional facilities committees and institutions committees at the area, district and local level. Four hundred and seventy A.A.s are serving as sponsors for prison groups.

A.A. groups in correctional facilities are each sent a group handbook which contains Conference-approved pamphlets directed to members who are confined, and the Correctional Facilities Directory. In addition, each prison group receives a copy of the Big Book, other complimentary literature, and *Box 4-5-9*. Discount packages of A.A. literature, in English, Spanish, and French, are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees. The Grapevine donates back issues, and 75 copies of the current issue, which we pass along to groups and individuals who ask for more complimentary literature. Literature is also sent, at no charge, to committees which lack funds. A Correctional Facilities Workbook and Guidelines and pamphlets are available for A.A. members interested in institutions work. The workbooks are sent at no charge to new chairpersons and kits are sent to committee members. Their names are added to the mailing list for *Box 4-5-9*, which contains a Correctional Facilities section.

In addition, Conference-approved films and videocassettes are available at no charge to groups in correctional facilities. Last fall, complimentary copies of the new videocassette "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" were sent to the chairpersons of correctional facilities and institutions committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. In 1987, 800 copies of the videocassettes were distributed; 650 at no charge. In accordance with the 1987 Conference recommendations, a Spanish translation of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" has been produced on videocassette. The French Literature Committee plans to translate the video in Quebec.

When an inmate is preparing for release the staff member works in concert with the institutions committees, central offices, local A.A. groups, and prison sponsors to obtain a prerelease contact to help the confined A.A. member make the initial transition into a "regular" A.A. group. Frequently, A.A. inmates contact the staff member on the Correctional Facilities assignment for help in bringing "outside" A.A. members to share at prison meetings and, again, local contacts are found to answer these requests.

The Institutions Correspondence Service provides a vital link between "inside" A.A.s and members in the "free world." Through this service, an A.A. member on the "outside" shares the A.A. program of recovery with a confined alcoholic. There are approximately 1,780 "outside" A.A.s and inmates writing to one another. An ongoing need exists for outside A.A.s interested in participating in the Institutions Correspondence Service to respond to a continual list of 20-25 inmates waiting for correspondents.

Lois Fisher



FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: Last year we reported that 1987 projections reflected the Fellowship's confidence in meeting the challenge of the Seventh Tradition. This confidence was well-placed. The G.S.O. (A.A. World Service Inc., Board of Directors) reduced literature prices in April of 1987. In anticipation of continuing support from the Fellowship, it reduced prices *again* in August 1987. The A.A.W.S. Board continued to monitor participation during the balance of 1987, and proposed and then constructed a 1988 budget with yet another price reduction effective March 1, 1988. The March price reduction comes close to eliminating profits from literature sales. In the near future the service work of your General Service Office is likely to be entirely supported by group contributions.

The results of 1987 operations reflect strong contributions which were 37% over 1986. They include first year sales for over 300,000 copies of the portable Big Book, \$1,148,000. Together with the hardcover Big Book, sales exceeded 1,000,000 copies. The effect of these two income items, along with the fact that total expenses were under budget, was that the extraordinary expense items for construction (\$914,000) and a system study (\$94,000) did not create a deficit, as had been budgeted; therefore monies from the Reserve Fund to pay for these items did not need to be drawn down.

The Grapevine completed a successful year, with revenue \$207,000 higher than 1986, and \$29,000 higher than budgeted in 1987. This result was attributed to higher subscription rates (1/1/86), rather than higher average circulation. Total expenses for 1987 were \$61,000 below budget. Grapevine's 1987 net income, including interest earned, was \$106,500, which compares favorably with a 1986 loss of \$97,700 and a 1987 budgeted net income of \$26,300.

The Reserve Fund stands close to the limit established by the 1987 Conference. Its balance at year end was \$6,961,000. With the transfer in March 1988 of \$450,000, the fund balance will equal about 11.7 months of operating expense. The committee will monitor this relationship and use literature price reductions as the primary mechanism to limit further growth. The Prudent Reserve Fund provided a great deal of comfort while a transition to full self-support accompanied by substantial price reductions in literature was being undertaken.

It has been a remarkable year. Your G.S.O. has reduced prices and the Fellowship has increased its participation — at all levels of A.A. service.

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: In-depth reports were presented by the following board committees: Public Information, Literature, Nominating, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Correctional Facilities. The reports encompassed the scope of the committees and highlighted their history. In addition to detailed accounts of activities and projects in progress, areas of concern were addressed, along with plans for the future and issues of specific interest to the board. In August, the topic for discussion was central offices/intergroups.

In November, attention was focused on an updated report from the Self-support Committee of the A.A.W.S. Board. Also, a topic for discussion was the general manager's "Trip to Russia." He



represented the General Service Office on a trip made by Americans in alcoholism treatment to the Soviet Union, with the objective of carrying information about A.A. to the medical profession, the government and to professionals who work with alcoholics in Russia.

The most recent General Sharing Session (January 1988) included a continuation of the discussion of A.A. and the Soviet Union. Report were heard on the history of publishing A.A. literature in other countries; on the trustees' International Committee involvement; on a visit with Creating A Sober World group; and on A.A.W.S. considerations regarding the possibility of publishing the Big Book in Russian. There was a great deal of discussion on this topic. The question was asked whether A.A.W.S. should publish the Big Book in Russian and the answer was "Yes, if we were asked." The conclusion and sense of the sharing session was not to deviate from the usual A.A. process.

Dan Byrne, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES COORDINATOR

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervise the production of all service material, update the 15 A.A. Guidelines, and produce new Group Handbooks (English, Spanish, French, Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities).

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, and a complimentary supply of literature. In addition, groups receive *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. G.S.O. continues to work toward providing all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada service structure with services as nearly identical as possible. We list approximately 1,300 French- and more than 700 Spanish-speaking groups; and the Group Handbook, G.S.R. Kit, and *Box 4-5-9* are available in both Spanish and French.

G.S.O. keeps a storehouse of material available to A.A.s on request. Most service material is complimentary and is not listed on the literature order form. Service material does not carry the Conference-approved seal because it is not subjected to the lengthy and painstaking committee processes involved at every stage of production of Conference-approved books and pamphlets. Rather, service material is dictated by shared group experience and expressed need for timely, helpful pieces, and is frequently re-evaluated.

The staff member on the group services assignment is also responsible for updating various lists and literature kits used throughout the Fellowship. Other responsibilities of the group services coordinator include overseeing the preparation and production of the five A.A. directories; acting as a liaison with central office/intergroups, and organizing the Central Office/Intergroup Seminars (1988 will mark the third such seminar).

Eileen Gatz

INTERNATIONAL / WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: We are responsible for suggesting to the trustees policies and actions which will carry the message to the alcoholic overseas, especially in countries where there is no established service structure. We are also a contact point for overseas A.A. groups whose members are primarily from the United States and Canada and who wish to communicate with our Conference structure. We also serve as a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board of Trustees.

The committee surveyed central offices in the U.S./Canada to determine their most requested pamphlets. After reviewing the survey results, the committee recommended that "Is A.A. For You?," "A Newcomer Asks," and "44 Questions" be translated into Arabic. The next language for translation will be Laotian. The translations will help carry the message to immigrants in the U.S. and Canada, and indirectly help overseas countries as well.

Last September John Bragg represented the General Service Office on a trip to the Soviet Union that included members of the alcoholism treatment field from the United States. The trip was part of an exchange on alcoholism and drug abuse conducted under the auspices of the Soviet and United States governments. The participation of Alcoholics Anonymous was specifically requested by the Soviets. John had an opportunity to share some information about A.A. Primarily however, the Soviets shared their methods of alcoholism treatment. The Soviets will be visiting the United States this spring to learn about alcoholism treatment in the United States. We will have the opportunity of hosting them for one day. For the benefit of our visitors, most of whom speak only Russian, the committee recommended that "If You Are a Professional" and "A.A. in Your Community" be translated into Russian as a special public information effort. The committee also suggested that some of the following topics be covered on their visit:

- Brief history of how A.A. started.
- Brief tour of the office.
- Describe A.A. at treatment and correctional facilities and the "sponsor your doctor" program.
- Show one of the filmstrips, either "Your G.S.O. Today" or "A.A. — An Inside View"; to make the film more beneficial, a Russian version of the film's cassette could be made in advance.
- Take them to an A.A. meeting.

The committee has also been reviewing plans for the Tenth World Service Meeting to be held in New York in October 1988.

Don I. Pritts, chairperson

Staff report:

Overseas — The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 35 G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers, outside the U.S. and Canada, in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, Ecuador, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, India, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland (French-speaking), Switzerland (German-speaking), Trinidad/Tobago, Uruguay, Venezuela and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing

of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada. For non-English-speaking countries with their own G.S.O.s, we list English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information.

Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.s in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. When correspondence comes to us in a foreign language, it is translated and a response sent in the same language. We have a list of translators, primarily A.A. volunteers, for over 30 languages.

To protect A.A.'s copyrights, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature in the language of the country. A request to print should come from the board, and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S.

Interim Zonal Meetings — The overseas staff member attended the Fourth European Service Meeting held in West Germany in March 1987 and the Fifth Ibero-American Service Meeting held in El Salvador in August 1987.

Zonal meetings are held every other year; alternating with World Service Meetings. Their primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Also, they help countries without service structures by sponsoring these countries into service and contribute to the growth of A.A. worldwide.

World Service Meeting — The World Service Meeting meets biennially at locations alternating between the United States and overseas. The Tenth World Service Meeting will be held October 23-27, 1988, in New York City. The theme will be "A.A. and Its Responsibilities."

Sarah Price

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION / A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention — Our theme for A.A.'s 55th Anniversary Party to be held in Seattle, Washington, July 5 through 8, 1990, is "55 Years — One Day At A Time." At present, A.A. has over 15,000 hotel rooms committed to the Convention. Seattle Center, a 74-acre urban park with a variety of buildings, located on the northern edge of downtown Seattle, will be the site for most of the A.A. events. It is 1.2 miles from the new Washington State Convention and Trade Center, the site for the Al-Anon Convention, and 2.4 miles from the Kingdome, which will highlight the evening meetings and the Spiritual Meeting on Sunday morning. All activities for the International Convention can be concentrated within these three facilities — all within close proximity of the other in the heart of Seattle's downtown hotel/retail/restaurant/business core.

We expect to provide shuttle service for our attendees, but we also expect close cooperation with the King County-Wide Metro transit system. We are being very careful to ensure that all hotels housing A.A. attendees will be within walking distance of a Metro bus stop which offers direct service to downtown Seattle.

In September 1987, invitations to bid on the 60th Anniversary International Convention (1995) were sent to all delegates in the



U.S. and Canada. Eleven metropolitan areas indicated interest. Anaheim, Atlanta, Chicago, Denver, Detroit, Houston, New Orleans, Minneapolis/St. Paul, San Diego, Toronto and Vancouver have returned completed bid questionnaires. The committee reviewed the bids and all cities either met or say they will meet the requirements of our 1995 Convention. The committee recommended that, at the General Service Conference, each delegate and accompanying convention and visitors center personnel be limited to 15 minutes for presentation and 15 minutes for questions. Therefore, a total of 30 minutes is allotted to each bidding area.

Regional Forums — To date, fifty-one Regional Forums have been held. Five regions have hosted Forums within the past year. Our committee discussed and provided input for planning of these Forums, each of which was well-received by attendees. Attendance at the five Forums ranged from 322 to 550 registrants, and in all cases, more than half of the participants were attending their first Forum. Workshop and presentation topics on the "Twelve Concepts" and "Self-Support" have generated lively responses, and the highlights of Regional Forum reports are appreciated. The committee has recommended, based on requests from the Fellowship, that taping not be done by anyone at Forums.

Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed regarding upcoming Regional Forums. Currently, the schedule is as follows:

1988		
June 17-19	Pacific	Anchorage, AK
Sept. 23-25	Eastern Canada	Quebec City, PQ
Oct. 14-16	Western Canada	Alberta, CA
Dec. 2-4	Southeast	Hollywood, FL
1989		
May 12-14	East Central	Ann Arbor, MI
June 2-4	Northeast	Portland, ME
Aug. 4-6	West Central	Billings, MT
Dec. 1-3	Southwest	Wichita, KS

John Ford, chairperson

Staff report:

Regional Forums — The responsibilities of this assignment involve coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for Regional Forums. These sharing weekends help provide

better communication between A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, the General Service Office and the Grapevine. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years — four Regional Forums usually take place annually.

Working in conjunction with the regional trustee, area delegates and host city contact, the Regional Forum coordinator handles mailings to the region's delegates requesting agenda topics and suggestions, invitations to intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The coordinator is responsible for putting together the weekend agenda and following through each stage of planning with the hotel to ensure that myriad details are taken care of. She or he is also responsible for producing literature displays and having service material available at each Forum. Following a Forum, highlights of the weekend's sharing are produced by the coordinator and sent to all registrants.

General Service Board personnel attendees usually include the chair of the board, trustees (from among nonalcoholic, regional, general service and trustee-at-large), directors of A.A.W.S. as well as representatives of the Grapevine Corporate Board and staff and G.S.O. staff members. Plans for a Regional Forum begin at least one year in advance and great care is taken to ensure that each Forum creates an environment and program conducive to lively sharing in a comfortable setting.

Eileen Gatz

LITERATURE

Projects Completed — Following Conference approval, the following items have become available: the Primary Purpose statement for a closed meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous; the Primary Purpose statement for an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous; the updated manuscript for "Too Young?"; the updated "A.A. Group" pamphlet; and an updated "44 Questions."

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee — revised "A.A. and the Armed Services"; revised "Young People in A.A."; a progress report on the development of a daily reflections book; a first draft manuscript of the A.A. history book; a first draft manuscript of a Native North American pamphlet.

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee — Easy-to-read literature: The trustees' committee recommended a sample of an illustrated and simplified "Is A.A. For You?" be prepared for Conference approval. The committee also recommended that the need for "44 Questions," "This Is A.A." and "Twelve Steps Illustrated" be considered for future illustrated, easy-to-read literature. The subcommittee on the revised "A.A. Group" pamphlet recommended that a section on the structure of an A.A. group be developed for inclusion in the *A.A. Service Manual*, and that this copy be the basis for the revision of the "A.A. Group" pamphlet. Additionally, it was noted that this recommendation be referred to the Conference Report and Charter Committee which is responsible for any changes in the *Service Manual*. In order to gather helpful information on service sponsorship for inclusion in the "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlet, the committee recommended that there be an article published in the February/March issue of *Box 4-5-9* requesting shared experience on service sponsorship from the Fellowship. It was recommended that this be referred to the Conference Literature Committee for further discussion.

John E. King, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator works very closely with the publications department on the preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, displays, leaflets, service material and audio-visuals. The literature coordinator is responsible for content. The publications department carries out the projects which have been recommended by the General Service Conference and facilitated (in part) through the literature coordinator's desk.

In addition to recovery literature, the literature coordinator serves as the editor of *Box 4-5-9*, our bimonthly newsletter. This newsletter of the Fellowship carries news from around the world with special sections on public information, cooperation with the professional community, treatment facilities, correctional facilities and archives. *Box 4-5-9* is also available in Spanish and French. The circulation is as follows:

	Issue	Mailing List
English	Feb./Mar.	88,890 ¹
French	Feb./Mar.	4,085 ²
Spanish	Feb./Mar.	12,741 ³

The literature coordinator's desk also serves as a clearing house of literature information in response to correspondence from A.A.s across the country. A letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, literature chairpersons and literature distribution centers to inform them of new developments in A.A. literature and other service materials.

Lyla Bonney

- 1 This figure includes 1,900 copies sent to English-speaking G.S.O.s at no charge, and 14,557 paid subscriptions.
- 2 This figure includes 885 copies sent to French-speaking G.S.O.s at no charge, and 157 paid subscriptions.
- 3 This figure includes 9,255 copies sent to Spanish-speaking G.S.O.s at no charge, and 346 paid subscriptions.

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: Loners are A.A.s who live in isolated areas where there are no A.A. groups or contacts. They stay sober by reading A.A. literature and sharing experience, strength and hope with other A.A. members around the world through letters and tapes. There are over 526 Loners in 90 countries. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability; 136 Homers participate in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists, of whom there are now 536 participating in the Loners/Internationalists correspondence service. In addition, there are 60 Internationalist groups meeting aboard ships and in ports, as well as 57 Port Contacts.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer and Internationalist. They also receive directories of Loners, Homers and Internationalists, the bimonthly bulletins *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, a discussion meeting in print which shares excerpts from letters received at G.S.O.

About 3,336 A.A.s participate in the *Loners/Internationalists* meeting-by-mail correspondence service — it might be called the largest A.A. group in the world. We now have Loners in Africa, Australia, Bolivia, Greece, Indonesia, Turkey, and even tiny, isolated islands. Many Loners live in remote areas of the United States and Canada. Loner Sponsors now number about 2,020.

Curtis Monahan

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: We reviewed and approved for mailing in August the letter, procedures, and resumé form for election of candidates for regional trustees of Western Canada and the West Central Regions.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Michael Alexander succeed Gordon Patrick as chairperson of the General Service Board, to take effect at the close of the General Service Conference in April 1988.

The committee established a timetable for the selection of a new general manager to replace John Bragg in 1989. Letters announcing this opening were sent to all past and present trustees and delegates in August 1987 and again in February 1988. All applications for the position should be received by May 15, 1988, and the committee will begin interviews in July 1988. We hope to complete the process by November 1988. We expect that the person selected will be on hand for the Conference in 1989 and will fully succeed John Bragg by the end of 1989.

We reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1988 General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Robert P. Morse
William E. Flynn, M.D.	Amos E. Reed
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.	John H. Smith, M.D.
John E. King	

Class B

William H. Croke	Shepherd Raimi
Thomas G. Hills	James Shannon
Ruth C. Jagodzinski	John A. Sharkey
W.F. (Webb) Johnson	John R. Whitehouse
Joe Phelan	Jan Kelly Williamson
Don I. Pritts	

(To be selected 4/22/88)

Two regional trustees — West Central U.S., Western Canada
One general service trustee

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Michael Alexander
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	William E. Flynn, M.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
<i>Secretary</i>	John R. Whitehouse
<i>Treasurer</i>	Robert P. Morse
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Edward H. Gordon
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Susan Ulseth



The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. be presented to the 1988 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

John Bragg	Joseph E. Rhoads
William Croke	Jean Smith
Hugh Freyer	Susan Ulseth
Ruth C. Jagodzinski	Jan Kelly Williamson
Shepherd Raimi	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc. be presented to the 1988 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Norman Adams	James Shannon
Laurance Allen	Ames Sweet
Thomas G. Hills	Desmond Towey
John E. King	Ann Warner
Fran Polek	John R. Whitehouse

The committee has commenced a search for Class A nominees in view of Bill Flynn's rotation off the board in 1989.

Shepherd Raimi, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with helping the membership carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. We try to create a better understanding of A.A. among the general public and equally as important, we try to prevent misinformation. We try to maintain some awareness of the composition and growth of A.A. as a whole, and among specific groups such as young people and women. This is done through our triennial membership survey which plays an important role in helping us formulate our P.I. communications. We create and produce films as well as radio and TV announcements, write press releases and press feature stories, maintain the Public Information Workbook and help produce the P.I. section in *Box 4-5-9*.

In 1987 the committee:

- Completed "The A.A. Member" pamphlet, which became "A.A. Membership Survey."
- Completed the film "Young People and A.A."
- Developed two press releases and a storyboard on the film and sent them to major media and local P.I. workers.
- Produced the Spanish version of "Young People and A.A." in response to the 1987 Conference recommendation that we consider this project.
- Developed a press release to announce the film "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and sent it to segments of the membership list of the American Corrections Association.
- Trustees' P.I. Committee members served on a subcommittee developing a long-term, multi-faceted campaign to elevate the consciousness of members of the Fellowship on the importance of anonymity.
- Appointed a subcommittee to develop new radio PSAs.

The committee hears reports of P.I. activities in the areas through staff reports and the input of regional trustees.

William H. Croke, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic and potential alcoholic through the media. The staff member, assisted by a nonalcoholic employee, responds to an average of 12,000 written and telephoned inquiries that come in annually from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member also handles interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what we can and cannot do, providing accurate information. A partial list of interviews includes those by *Time*, *Good Housekeeping*, *Success*, ABC Television News, *Rolling Stone* and *Guideposts*.

Literature has been provided for approximately 240 health and community fairs. We also read and processed 14,800 newspaper, magazine and television feature stories; wrote approximately 10 letters of gratitude each month to publications printing accurate articles about our Fellowship; followed up on a monthly average of 15 to 20 anonymity breaks; and sent a letter of thanks to all 1,800 local P.I. committees and P.I. contacts.

New public information chairpersons are automatically sent the Public Information Workbook, and all P.I. committee members and contacts receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as any new public service materials. (Additional Public Information Workbooks are available for \$7.) Two discount packages are also made available to Public Information committees at \$20 and \$70, respectively. (Local committees may also order half-quantities of each package.)

Radio and television public service announcements have been widely aired on major networks and local stations — as have the films "Alcoholics Anonymous — An Inside View" and "Young People and A.A." Requests for help in planning programs including references to Alcoholics Anonymous have also abounded. We have ongoing contact with major networks, as well as the PBS and cable channels.

The results of the Seventh Triennial Membership Survey were published in the pamphlet "A.A. Membership Survey" and are also available in a table-top display and a poster.

Betty Liddle

SPANISH SERVICES COORDINATOR

Staff report: Our G.S.O. serves 718 Spanish-speaking groups in the United States and Canada, including Puerto Rico. The Spanish services coordinator, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish has a section entitled Spanish Services that gives information on general service activities. Each of those groups receives *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving and the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our publishing department.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the

Ibero-American Commission for translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, the Spanish services coordinator attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, and Regional Forums and assists at G.S.O.'s Annual Open House, the World Service Meeting and the International A.A. Convention. The Spanish services coordinator greets Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Vicente Mejía

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services provided by G.S.O. to A.A. groups and members are divided at present into 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility such as Public Information, Regional Forums, or Literature, most staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, or with A.A.s in overseas countries where there is no national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. Staff assignments are organized by the staff coordinator. Currently, the work is apportioned as follows:

Conference	Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; <i>Early Bird Box 4-5-9; Final Conference Report</i>
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.; Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant on C.P.C. page); assistant coordinator, 1990 International Convention; coordinator, Native North American Initiative
Correctional Facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page)
Group Services Coordinator	Supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; coordinator, Self-Support Committee; liaison with intergroups/central offices and coordinator of Intergroup/Central Office seminars.
Literature Coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, and audio-visual materials; updating of recovery pamphlets and books; editor, <i>Box 4-5-9</i>
Loners, Internationalists, Homers	<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i> ; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees; Coordinator 1990 International Convention.

Overseas, World Service Meeting

Public Information

Spanish Services

Treatment Facilities

Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, Tenth World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report*

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for P.I. page)

Consultant on any committee providing services to the Hispanic community; Spanish language correspondence; editor, Spanish *Box 4-5-9*

Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page)

During 1987, the G.S.O. staff handled almost 21,000 pieces of mail. The staff coordinator ensures that mail is answered during vacations, sickness, or a staff member's involvement with a special project. Training new staff members is another segment of the staff coordinator's service assignment. When there is a staff opening, a letter is sent out to the trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in *Box 4-5-9*. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, good communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are some of the criteria used in the selection process.

Weekly staff meetings are scheduled to provide a forum for discussion of problems that require direction from the group conscience. From time to time, a service meeting is scheduled to give the staff an opportunity to become better informed about a particular assignment. The purpose of all staff meetings is to seek more and better ways of providing the most useful services to A.A. groups and members.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips in order to ensure that the office is covered at all times. She also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments as a member of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee.

An exciting aspect of staff service is responding to invitations to A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and get-togethers. This provides the staff with opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.s all over the U.S. and Canada, to inform them about G.S.O. services and, most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

During the past year, approximately 1,070 visitors from all over the world visited G.S.O., and an additional 766 A.A.s attended the Annual Open House.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, preparing and distributing the minutes of the General Service Board meeting, and serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is a director and vice-president of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Susan Ulseth

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: We recommended two major additions to the Treatment Facilities Workbook:

1 A twenty-two page Temporary Contact report was added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook in the Temporary Contact section and is available, for anyone interested, as service material in the G.S.O. services files. The Temporary Contact report describes A.A. experience with contact sponsorship, primarily for patients completing three- to four-week inpatient programs.

2 An introductory statement was also included in the beginning of the workbook, after the table of contents. The statement points out that the guidelines set forth in the workbook are easily adapted to many different kinds and lengths of treatment programs. It also invites the reader to share treatment facility service experience with the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities. The workbook is dedicated to the A.A. members who carry the message into treatment facilities.

The committee discussed suggestions from the staff on how to make the Treatment Facilities Workbook more accessible to A.A.s doing service work in treatment facilities. The committee accepted the following suggestions:

1 Include a blurb about the workbook in the welcoming letter to outside sponsors of treatment facilities meetings.

2 Run articles in *Box 4-5-9* that include portions of the workbook.

3 Accept the Grapevine offer to include information about all the workbooks in the "Around A.A." section.

4 Continue to draw attention to the workbook at Regional Forums.

We discussed and recommended to the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for their information, approval, and input, the idea of sending an annual letter to treatment facilities chairpersons. The letter includes relevant shared experience to pass on to local treatment facilities. A subcommittee of the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee prepared this material.

The committee discussed the possibility of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities developing a film to orient patients in treatment facilities to A.A.; in effect, to contain the information which is now given by a treatment facilities committee member speaking to new A.A. members who are patients in a treatment facility. Of course, this film would never take the place of an A.A. member carrying the message into a facility but would be an adjunct to what is already being done. The idea for this film arose from A.A. members employed in the alcoholism treatment field. The committee recommended the idea of the treatment facilities film be referred to the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee to request its input.

The trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities is soliciting candidates for the committee and a letter has gone out to that effect. Further, it was suggested that it might be possible to form a panel of consultants (people who work in treatment facilities, whether alcoholic or not) with whom we could discuss trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities projects as they develop.

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic in treatment facilities. Staff activities include being secretary to the trustees' and Conference Committees, responding to their mail, as well as mail from all treatment facilities and treatment facilities chairpersons throughout the U.S. and Canada. There are 221 Treatment Facilities Committees and 240 Institutions Committees.

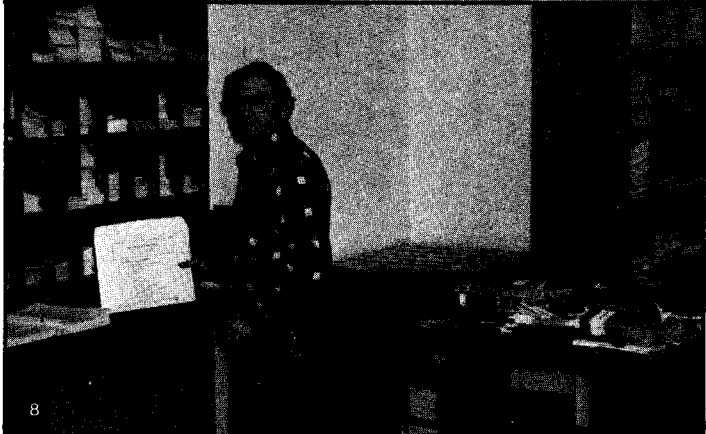
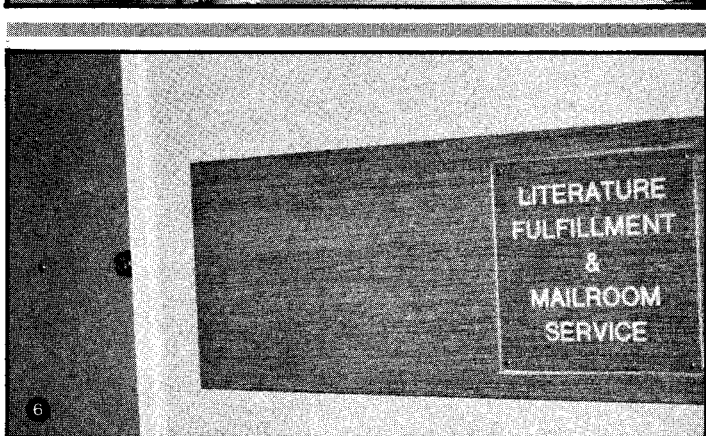
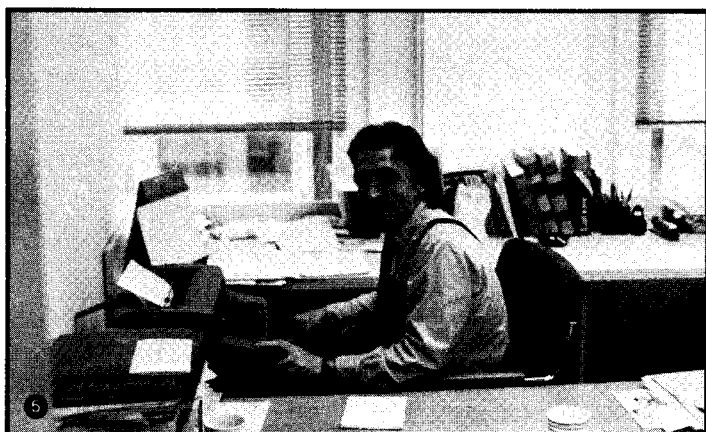
Highlights of the past year are as follows:

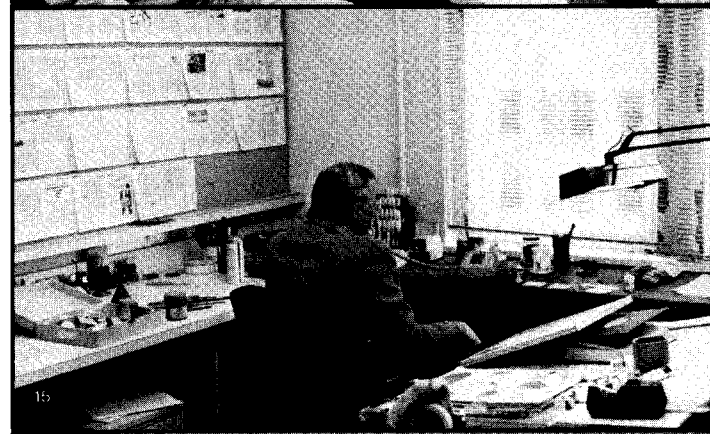
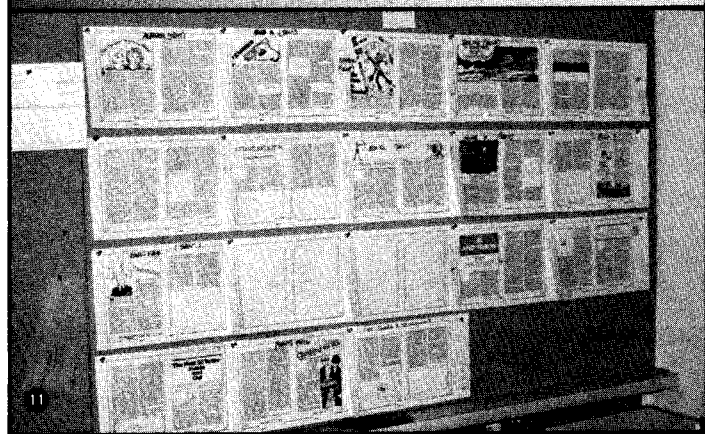
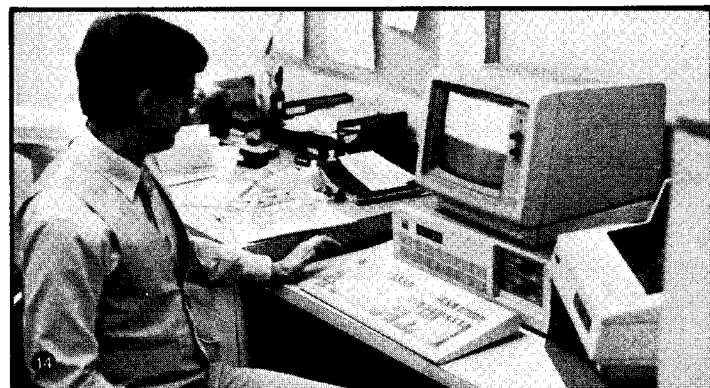
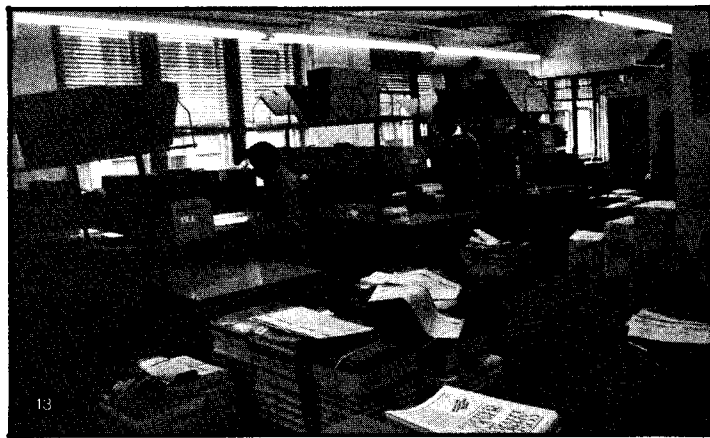
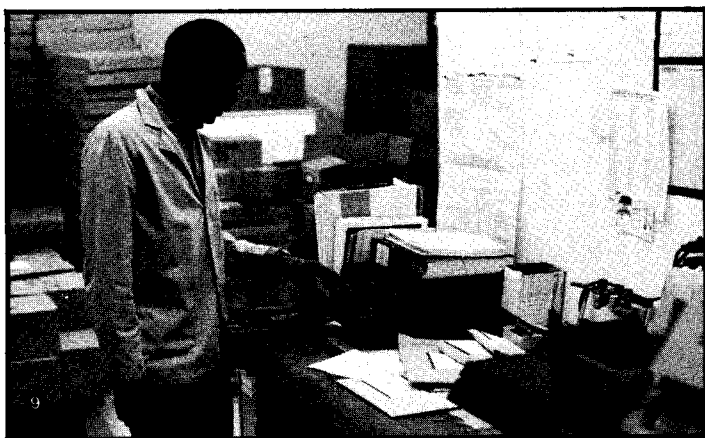
- Material was solicited from the Fellowship for an article about A.A. members employed in the alcoholism field. The results will appear in the May 1988 edition of the Grapevine under "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends."
- The report of shared experience on Temporary Contacts has been added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook, and is available as a separate service piece.
- The trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee has developed a newsletter describing A.A.'s singleness of purpose and is awaiting further input from the Conference and an appointed subcommittee before sending the newsletter to treatment facilities chairpersons. The newsletter in turn, can be shared with local treatment facilities.
- A film, proposed by A.A.s working in the field of alcoholism, has been discussed at length by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee. The film would address what A.A. is and is not. The film would be aimed at patients and personnel in treatment centers as well as members of A.A. who work with treatment facilities. The committee recommended the idea of a film be referred to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for their input.

Requests keep pouring in for the Treatment Facilities Workbook which has been well received and continues to be an invaluable tool. The workbook is now two years old. This assignment continues to gather information for *Box 4-5-9* articles in the Treatment Facilities section. The mail from members of the Fellowship continues to reflect concern about nonalcoholics attending meetings and the influx of patients from treatment facilities to regular A.A. groups. The assignment in the past year has focused on all these projects, with the still-suffering alcoholic in mind.

John Grant







1. & 2. Entrance to publications department; 3. Lynda Ernst, publications department secretary, receiving mail from Darryl Johnson; 4. inventory control division; 5. John de Stefano, Spanish-language editor; 6. window for literature order pickups; 7. Mike Berg, assistant print purchaser; 8. Joe Moglia, assembling discount packages; 9. Frank Smith, weighing the background material sent to Conference Literature Committee (7½ lbs.); 10. entrance to Grapevine offices; 11. rough layout for a future issue of the Grapevine; 12. Grapevine mailroom; 13. getting the orders out in the 6th floor mailroom; 14. Dale Fuqua, Grapevine's editorial secretary; 15. John Nayduch, Grapevine's part-time art director.

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The year since the 1987 Conference has been full of challenges, hard work, and decision-making for the Grapevine Corporate Board. It is my happy task to report to the 1988 Conference that the most urgent challenges have been met, the hard work is still going on, and the decisions reached to date are in the view of the Grapevine Board the right ones for the magazine, the corporation, and the Fellowship.

As the year has unfolded, delegates and readers have told us that the magazine itself is on the right track — allowing for the basic reality that we can't please all the people all the time. A number of topical sections have been well received, as has the revival of the occasional "Around A.A." feature with news of the Fellowship. The institution of an occasional "Your Move" section, which publishes responses to articles that have prompted widespread interest, has proven successful. Both these features, like any changes in the Grapevine, have been established on the basis of reader requests, and we continue to seek new ways of increasing membership participation in *our* magazine.

Much of the board's time has been concentrated on developing the Grapevine's credibility within the Fellowship in two primary ways: by establishing clearer communication with A.A. as a whole, and by improving delivery of the magazine to subscribers. We are confident that as communication spreads and any lingering delivery problems are resolved, the Grapevine will increasingly take its rightful place as an integral part of A.A.

In response to the 1987 Conference Advisory Actions requesting the board and staff to keep all Conference members informed of actions taken to resolve the management situation, all activities of the board, the planning committee, and the staff have been reported regularly. One happy result has been greater unity between the Grapevine and the Conference as a whole. The board and the staff have benefited enormously from the feedback and support so generously given by all the delegates — and especially from the close relationship that has developed with the Conference Grapevine Committee and its chairperson, Dean Rinehart. We are grateful, too, for the work of the trustees' ad hoc committee, whose chairperson, Bill Croke, has attended all board and planning committee meetings in order to facilitate communication between the Grapevine Corporate Board and the General Service Board.

Following are the significant actions and accomplishments for 1987: In January 1987, the board accepted the recommendation of the trustees' Nominating Committee that the chairmanship of the Grapevine Corporate Board (like that of the A.A.W.S. Board) rotate in alternate years between a regional trustee and a general service trustee. Last year was the first year in which a regional trustee served as chairperson, and all has gone smoothly.

In July, the board voted not to produce a special Native American issue, as suggested by a 1987 Conference Literature Committee recommendation, but rather to solicit articles by and about Native Americans for use either in a special section or in various issues throughout the year. At this time, there is a supply of articles in-house and they will be published in future issues.

At its October 1987 meeting, the board voted to confirm the management team that had been working effectively on an interim basis since November 1986. Ann Warner was appointed executive editor, reporting to the Grapevine Corporate Board and the General Service Board. The management team is completed by the appointments of Don Meurer as controller/business administrator and Ames Sweet as managing editor. The board also nominated Desmond Towey as general service trustee candidate, to fill the vacancy created by the rotation of Ralph Rosenberg, Jr.

Early in the year the board instituted a search for a new director. In line with the 1987 Conference Advisory Action, the search was extended beyond the immediate New York City commuting area, and at its January 1988 meeting the board voted to nominate a director candidate who lives in the Pacific region; the candidate's name will come before the 1988 Conference. This is the first time a director has been elected from outside the New York metropolitan area, and on the basis of its experience with a regional trustee as chairperson, the board feels confident that an out-of-town director can be a full participant in all corporate business.

The board considered at several meetings the ongoing Bill W. book project and: (1) reconsidered the use of the context-setting introductory material and; (2) recommended that if it is produced, the publication schedule should not conflict with the forthcoming in-depth history of A.A. The board approved publication of a special 64-page international issue (January 1988), with a substantial print overrun to make single-copy sales possible. Since the issue came off press, about 6,600 single copies have been ordered, and reader response has been overwhelmingly enthusiastic.

And last, but gratifyingly not least, financial results at the end of December 1987 showed a net income of \$106,520. This net income changed the net worth of the company from a \$77,000 deficit to a positive \$30,000. This encouraging picture is primarily the result of advance planning, tight budget controls, and increased sales of special items rather than an increase in circulation. Total circulation, in fact, was slightly down compared to 1986, though the downturn was somewhat offset by an increase in month-to-month sales.

The 1988 budget approved by the board at its January meeting targeted a break-even point for this year. For the first time, the Grapevine budget includes provision for a job and salary evaluation by Hay Associates, the company that has been evaluating A.A.W.S. jobs for a number of years. The study is particularly timely in view of the restructuring of management, and it will bring Grapevine practice in line with that of G.S.O. A representative from Hay will be reporting the results to the Grapevine Board at its quarterly meeting. Other significant budget components are the provision for three new employees already in place in the circulation department, and the production of revised and consolidated materials for the GvR program. These changes, along with those that have taken place over the past year, should further our objectives of improving subscriber services and communication with the Fellowship, and should put the magazine into the hands of more people who want the A.A. message.

Just as one month does not make a year, one year does not constitute unqualified credibility. But I believe I can — with honesty, open-mindedness, and willingness — assure you that the Grapevine family, together with your uncompromising support, will continue to respond and to maintain its rightful role within our beloved Society.

Jack Whitehouse, chairperson

Staff report: Communication and service have been the watchwords for the Grapevine staff over the past year — in relation to the Fellowship as a whole and, as a sort of ripple effect, within the office. While the Grapevine Corporate Board has been successfully establishing effective lines of communication with Conference members, the staff has been working toward equally effective communication among all Grapevine employees. The result has been a growing ability to respond to the Fellowship by

producing a magazine that accurately reflects A.A. as a whole and by getting that magazine to subscribers faster and more smoothly.

Perhaps the best way to describe "how it works" in the Grapevine office is simply to say: "We talk a lot." When an interim management team was appointed in November 1986, the office operation was in a state of flux. So we talked about it, and we took care of business, and in the time-tested A.A. fashion, it got better. When the already-operating management team was given formal authority and responsibility, we just kept talking. And it continues to work.

Within a three-pronged management team, specific areas of responsibility were established by the Grapevine Corporate Board in October 1987. An executive editor (Ann Warner), reporting to the Grapevine Corporate Board and the General Service Board, has responsibility for the operation as a whole. A controller/business administrator (nonalcoholic Don Meurer) directs the corporation's financial and business affairs, and a managing editor (Ames Sweet) implements editorial plans, makes sure the magazine gets off press, and supervises the GvR program. Both Ann and Ames serve as directors of the corporation, with Ann as chief executive holding the title of president. Don continues to serve as assistant treasurer. Making the management team "official" was less an end result than a pause for reflection in the continuing process of consolidation within the office. A major priority has been strengthening the circulation department, and to that end a circulation supervisor was put in place in August. We followed up by hiring new personnel, clarifying procedures, and reallocating some responsibilities, and are confident that this vital department is now up to strength and more than ready to resolve any problems of subscription fulfillment.

Along with people, machines are making a greater contribution to the operation as a whole. Both editors now have — and even use — PCs, and the editorial staff assistant is investigating some new programs that will enhance our ability to serve the needs of the magazine and its readers. The Grapevine and A.A.W.S. have been involved in an overall reevaluation of both corporations' computer needs, including the selection of a new system, and much of Don Meurer's time has been spent in that effort.

The GvR (Grapevine representative) program, the primary means of communication between the office and the service structure, is evolving as an ever-more-effective means of sharing group, district, and area GvR experience. Under the supervision of Ames Sweet, new informational materials for GvRs have been produced, the *GvR News* is passing on the experience of active GvRs, and mailing procedures are being clarified.

Because the Grapevine is a small office (with a total of about 20 employees), we had never established the position of office manager. As part of the effort to make the office work more smoothly, and thus more effectively, the responsibility for internal office services has recently been incorporated in the job of administrative assistant.

More changes, no doubt, are still to come. We have begun a series of all-employee workshops, in which we talk over office problems and work out solutions together. Hay Associates are in the process of evaluating all job functions and responsibilities, and the results of the study may well make much of this report outdated in very short order. If so . . . we'll talk about it.

Ann Warner, editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1987	APRIL 1988	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,077	1,211	134
Alaska	506	473	- 33
Arizona	1,420	1,445	25
Arkansas	806	741	- 65
California	12,462	13,203	741
Colorado	1,530	1,505	- 25
Connecticut	1,925	2,085	160
Delaware	399	383	- 16
District of Columbia	353	338	- 15
Florida	5,528	6,230	702
Georgia	2,386	2,470	84
Hawaii	354	374	20
Idaho	526	628	102
Illinois	5,376	5,217	- 159
Indiana	1,816	1,730	- 86
Iowa	1,616	1,584	- 32
Kansas	1,528	1,551	23
Kentucky	1,047	1,167	120
Louisiana	1,416	1,317	- 99
Maine	737	793	56
Maryland	2,179	2,080	- 99
Massachusetts	4,555	4,760	205
Michigan	3,513	3,393	- 120
Minnesota	4,055	3,934	- 121
Mississippi	833	771	- 62
Missouri	2,160	2,038	- 122
Montana	834	772	- 62
Nebraska	1,580	1,647	67
Nevada	609	598	- 11
New Hampshire	763	782	19
New Jersey	3,543	3,550	7
New Mexico	702	654	- 48
New York	7,997	7,860	- 137
North Carolina	3,085	3,166	81
North Dakota	661	649	- 12
Ohio	3,500	3,527	27
Oklahoma	1,691	1,708	17
Oregon	1,059	1,102	43
Pennsylvania	3,668	3,806	138
Rhode Island	733	745	12
South Carolina	1,591	1,691	100
South Dakota	628	673	45
Tennessee	1,400	1,473	73
Texas	5,288	5,242	- 46
Utah	334	380	46
Vermont	509	522	13
Virginia	2,863	3,154	291
Washington	2,720	2,955	235
West Virginia	527	577	50
Wisconsin	2,901	2,675	- 226
Wyoming	389	368	- 21
Puerto Rico	127	125	- 2
U.S. Possessions	—	—	—
Total	109,805	111,822	2,017
CANADA			
Alberta	1,297	1,227	- 70
British Columbia/Yukon	1,219	1,360	141
Manitoba	716	576	- 140
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	403	423	20
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	717	638	- 79
Ontario	4,425	4,842	417
Quebec	373	360	- 13
Saskatchewan	962	852	- 110
Total	10,112	10,278	166
FOREIGN			
	1,344	1,264	- 80
Grand Total	121,261	123,364	2,103

Literature Distributed – 1987

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	684,600
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft-cover)	317,300
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	466,000
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	92,600
A.A. Comes of Age	22,300
As Bill Sees It	86,600
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	22,400
"Pass It On"	29,800
Total	1,721,600

Booklets

Living Sober	224,600
Came to Believe	99,900
Total	324,500

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	43,600
A.A. and the Armed Services	30,400
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	72,200
A.A. for the Woman	256,000
The A.A. Group	155,500
A.A. in Your Community	160,700
A.A. in Prisons	48,200
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	82,700
The A.A. Member	136,700
A.A. Membership Survey (new)	1,500
The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs	227,100
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	33,800
A.A. Tradition—How It Developed	85,800
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	32,900
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	285,800
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	59,800
The Co-founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	58,600
Do You Think You're Different?	292,700
44 Questions	543,300
G.S.R.	68,400
How A.A. Members Cooperate	43,500
How It Works	163,200
If You Are a Professional	97,600
Inside A.A.	117,300
Is A.A. For You?	632,100
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	235,500
It Happened to Alice	103,400
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	166,300
The Jack Alexander Article	87,400
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	33,700
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	178,500
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	184,200
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	73,400
A Newcomer Asks	452,800
Problems Other Than Alcohol	207,000
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	415,300
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	48,900
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	85,700
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	100,300
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	14,900
This Is A.A.	606,600
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	52,100
Time to Start Living	135,200
Time to Start Living (large print)	16,700
Too Young?	215,000
Understanding Anonymity	143,600
What Happened to Joe	119,000
Young People and A.A.	288,500
Total	7,693,400

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards—two-fold	1,058,000
Wallet cards—I Am Responsible	144,000
Wallet cards—Anonymity	80,100
Parchment—scrolls	8,600
Placards	900
C.P.C. Workbook	900
Correctional Facilities Workbook	800
P.I. Workbook	1,300
Treatment Facilities Workbook	800
A.A. Guidelines	179,000
Group Handbook	6,400
Wire Racks	3,300
Cassettes	4,900
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	5,500
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,600
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	500
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	700
Twelve Steps (shade display)	2,000
Twelve Traditions (shade display)	1,700
Fact Files	3,900
Total	1,505,900

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	14,800
Como Lo Ve Bill	2,700
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad	2,200
Total	19,700

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio	5,400
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos	2,100
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	8,500
Llegamos a Creer (new)	2,200
Total	18,200

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	6,200
44 Preguntas	20,800
Esto es A.A.	27,400
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	44,200
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	6,700
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (new)	700
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	4,800
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	4,100
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	3,000
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	1,700
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	2,800
Un Principiante Pregunta (new)	1,800
Como Trabaja	10,400
Lo que le Sucedió a Jose y su Problema con la Bebida	8,700
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	2,700
El Grupo de A.A.	5,400
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre Apadrinamiento	5,900
El Miembro de A.A. — Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	8,900
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	3,000
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento	1,900
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	8,100
Las Tradiciones de A.A.—Cómo se Desarrollaron	2,500
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	6,500
A.A. en Prisiones	4,300
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	5,400
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda	2,700
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	2,400
Dentro de A.A.	2,600
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	3,800
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	1,300
R.S.G.	2,800
Total	213,500

Miscellaneous

Guides	11,000
Tarjeta Tamaño Billetera	12,200
Los Doce Pasos Album de Cassettes (new)	300
Total	23,500

FRENCH

Books

Gros Livre Alcooliques anonymes (First edition)	150
Gros Livre Alcooliques anonymes	9,345
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient adulte	1,130
Réflexions de Bill	3,495
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	7,680
Total	21,800

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire	2,500
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	3,135
Album Souvenir	580
Total	6,215

Pamphlets

Voici les A.A.	12,280
Les A.A.: 44 Questions et réponses	6,325
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	32,085
Les A.A. pour la femme	1,455
Coopération des membres des A.A.	875
Les A.A. et le monde du travail	1,395
Le membre des A.A. face aux méd. et à la drogue	2,740
Les A.A.—Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	590
Collaborons avec nos amis	840
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	3,225
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	1,710
Les A.A. et la profession médicale (discontinued)	530
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	845
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	1,840
Alice l'a trouvée	945
Jos levait le coude	1,175
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	2,125
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	2,670
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	1,180
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	2,150
Notre méthode	15,635
Les A.A. dans les prisons	720
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	655
Petit guide pratique des Alcooliques anonymes	9,715
Un ecclésiastique s'interroge sur les A.A.	1,390
Biographies des cofondateurs	720
Lettre à un détenu	840
Le groupe des A.A.	2,730
Le manuel de services/Douze Concepts	2,435
Douze Etapes/Douze Traditions (Carte)	2,465
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	580
Les Douze Concepts illustrés	1,795
Le sens de l'anonymat	1,815
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales	1,775
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,700
Si vous exercez des activités professionnel	925
Le R.S.G.	2,405
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	1,250
Suggestions pour réunions de débutants	465
Les meilleurs articles de Bill	11,930
Trop jeune?	2,420
Structure de l'Ass. des A.A.	2,295
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	455
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,890
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,825
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	1,040
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais)	360
Le membre des A.A.	4,225

Les jeunes et les A.A.	2,760
Votre B.S.G.	1,835
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,480
Un nouveau venu veut savoir	9,755
Total	169,265

Guidelines

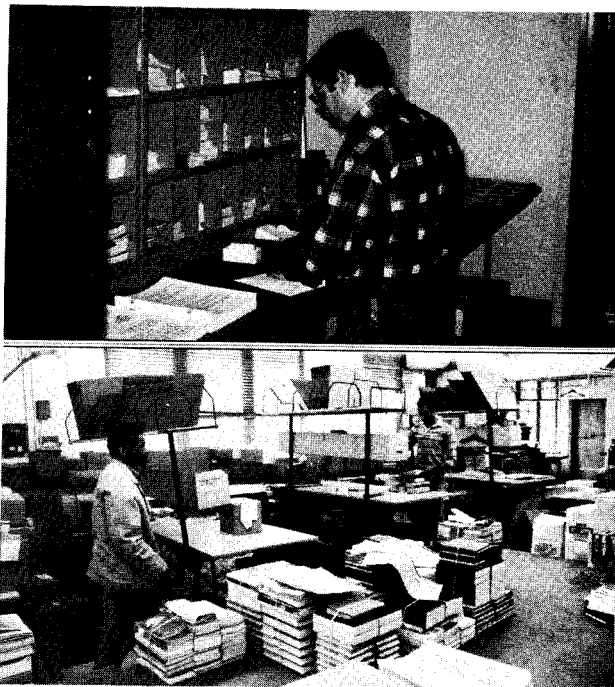
Miscellaneous

Prière Sérénité (Carte)	48,220
Prière Sérénité (5 × 7)	2,480
Prière Sérénité (12 × 16)	445
Prière Sérénité (23 × 34)	170
Slogans (série de 5)	335
Littérature . . . une aide essentielle	900
La Vigne A.A.	1,140
Etiquettes Allô!	2,300
Listes de réunions—Intergroupe de Mtl.	7,625
Médailles rhodium français	1,465
Médailles rhodium anglais	235
Jetons aluminium "appelle avant"	8,250
Jetons 3 mois aluminium	2,375
Jetons 6 mois aluminium	1,460
Jetons 9 mois aluminium	1,355
Jetons 12 mois aluminium	885
Pochette re: kit nouveau membre	1,790
Total	81,430

Service literature

Kits nouveaux groupes	80
Assortiments pour centres correctionnels	15
Assortiments Information publique	45
Cahier Information publique	10
Cahier de la C.M.P.	25
Aperçu sur A.A.	71,500
La transmission du message dans les prisons	2,300
Message aux adolescents	24,810
Et maintenant, que vais-je faire?	6,800
Renseignements sur les A.A.	6,350
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (citations)	8,000
Total	119,935

Getting the orders out.



Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alaska: Our area has one D.C.M. for each of the 12 districts and each D.C.M. holds monthly business meetings with the G.S.R.s in their district. Each district has been very active this past year in bringing the A.A. message to the bush and rural areas. We have many villages without highway or road access and many islands. We've come a long way from when two Eskimos took the Big Book to their village and were told by their village chieftain to destroy the book because it was evil. (The chieftains said that white men cannot put alcohol in their bodies and then take it out with a book.) After much education A.A. members have been invited by many village council fathers to hold A.A. meetings. Alcoholism is the number one disease among our Alaskan Native Americans and we are dedicated to carrying the A.A. message to our rural areas.—*Simonne Clutts*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Attendance is increasing at our assemblies, indicating more interest in service work, but there remains a continuing reluctance about bringing the message to penal institutions. An interim sponsorship program has been put into place with 17 active short-term treatment facilities. C.P.C. presentations throughout the area continue to attract interested professionals. With a land mass of 1.5 million square miles and a membership of 6,000 limited funds and vast traveling distances pose an awesome challenge. The Native American members are highly dedicated to their sobriety and the program but there is difficulty in getting other A.A. members to travel to the reservations.—*Red Walker*

Arizona: After four years, our "new" area structure is running smoothly. We've recently developed a program of General Service Information Workshops to be conducted throughout the area by teams of four A.A. members. A workshop includes four major segments: general service; Arizona area structure; finances; and dealing with problems. A fifth segment is devoted to discussion or Q. & A. As a result of developing these workshops, several changes in our service structure were proposed. These include splitting our H & I committee into separate Corrections and Treatment committees.—*John Dunn*

California (Mid-Southern): Our area purchased a computer to help store and process information on our 1,500 or so groups. Three districts have reactivated and a new district in the desert as well as another Spanish district have been formed. The C.P.C. committee gives court packets to first offenders who must attend A.A. meetings and makes other presentations. The P.I. committee has become active and we have three districts registered.—*Maxine Cramer*

California (Northern Interior): We have redistricted and split districts for growth and location purposes. General service is moving forward in all departments. Area attendance is generally 24 out of 25 districts. There is interest in all types of workshops. Sponsorship, study conferences and seminars are growing by leaps and bounds. We hear quite often "By the book — not hearsay." We are developing a future project, the "Learn to Sponsor Panel — Not How to — But Why." Our first experience with computers will take place next week. The secretary will start with the mailing list.—*Tim Martin*

California (San Diego/Imperial): Our 1987 contributions were 46% over 1985. Each quarter, all funds in excess of \$4,000.00 are contributed to G.S.O. As a result of our "corporate poverty" we have greater enthusiasm and unity in our area committee and nearly 100% district participation at each assembly. Revised guidelines in September 1987 created a true committee system.

At our January assembly 70 members were chosen by lottery to fill standing committee vacancies. Our area secretary was elected from Spanish-speaking district 15, which participates at every service level. Our Committee on Carrying the Message to the Native American continues its support of a successful A.A. meeting on the Rincon Indian Reservation.—*Larry Nelson*

Delaware: We now have 123 groups and have created another district, bringing the total number of districts to thirteen. Three intergroups carry meetings into our detoxes and prisons. They are also responsible for our three answering services and are involved in P.I. and C.P.C. work with group chairpersons. Our state assembly meets four times a year and is responsible for our annual state convention. Workshops held at all of our assembly meetings have brought good response from our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Our Grapevine committee is starting to get a response from our groups and is now working in our annual convention.—*Jim Magee*

Georgia: We have 580 groups and approximately 12,380 members. Our State Assembly is held three times a year in one central location; there are 35 districts and all participate. We hold workshops and meetings for G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and secretary/treasurers. We hold an open meeting in which a D.C.M. shares, followed by P.I., C.P.C., Institutions and Grapevine committee workshops. Sunday morning we hold our business meeting, which includes one delegate's report. Our prepaid convention is financed by group donations and attendance is open to every area. Cluster workshops are held throughout the state. We actively support the 7th Tradition Challenge. Georgia has adopted the 1988 Conference theme throughout our workshops and state activities.—*Gay Garner*

Idaho: Our area has approximately 150 active groups, including eight groups from Area #58 Oregon and two groups from Area #76, Wyoming. We have 11 districts. Most D.C.M.s hold monthly meetings. Our area committee holds two assembly business meetings, and two quarterly meetings. Area C.P.C., H & I, P.I. and Grapevine committees are all active in carrying the A.A. message. Idaho prisons, several jails, and most treatment centers have regular A.A. meetings, conducted by A.A. members. Our area archives person is active in gathering the history of A.A. in Idaho. We have many calls to speak at schools, colleges and churches.—*Irv Hanson*

Illinois (Northern): Our area has 20 districts and over 700 groups. We have been blessed with growth. The birthday plan and the self-support system have stimulated tremendous participation. Our area newsletter, *Concepts*, and numerous workshops on everything from the new member through the Concepts, have been enthusiastically received. Our computer is helping us organize the vast amounts of information resulting from our recent growth and we plan to discuss the accuracy of information between the district, area, and G.S.O. at our Delegates-Only meeting.—*Dennis Daley*

Indiana (Southern): Our area has 19 districts, 296 groups and approximately 5,000 members. In 1988 we adopted a separate service structure to replace the former state-wide service structure. We will continue to meet annually with Area 22 and will work together on our state convention. We have adopted an area assembly and a central location for all area meetings. Committee officers have been elected and permanent committees are now in place. Our area will host the 1988 East Central Region Delegate Conference in Indianapolis in February.—*Bobby Hobson*

Kansas: We have expanded our service budgets for the area newsletter (1,800 circulation), P.I., C.P.C., treatment, institutions, and archives. As a result, greater numbers of G.S.R.s attend our quarterly assemblies. Past delegates conduct workshops on Concepts, Traditions, unity, the role of the D.C.M. and G.S.R., and self-support. We have asked D.C.M.s to hold workshops in their districts on the General Service Conference agenda topics. District workshops and surveys sent to groups in our area have meant increased participation and a better-informed group conscience.—*Tom Heidler*

Kentucky: Our area grew to 422 groups and 25 districts. Thanks to hard work and dedication on the part of the area committee group contributions have increased to 81%. We have an area structure that still needs a lot of work and we have some very capable people working on this. The structure will be in good working order soon. We have good representation at our area meetings and much enthusiasm. We have four area meetings and one convention each year. All are well-attended.—*Paul Hart*

Maine: We now have 375 groups, 575 meetings; the number of districts has doubled to sixteen. All D.C.M.s are included on the area committee, which meets four times a year. The first Maine area two-day assembly was held last October. We hold assemblies twice a year in different locations. Geographic dispersion and diversity continue to be a problem. Redistricting continues and an area restructure manual is being developed. Wider distribution of the area newsletter, more frequent visits by area officers and encouragement of intra-district communications are planned.—*Jake Ham*

Manitoba: Our area has 14 districts and 154 groups. Each district has an average of 11 groups. We have P.I., C.P.C., and H&I (east and west) committees. The area assembly liaisons with our intergroup committees to avoid duplicating service efforts. There are many ongoing activities in our schools, hospitals and with our friends; always mindful of our Traditions. Travel distances between districts in remote parts of the province can be extensive. This challenges us to improve and maintain effective communications. One of our purposes has always been to work toward better understanding of each other in the Fellowship and we are always mindful of the need for individual and group participation.—*Vern Bryce*

Maryland: We have a total of 46 districts and 760 groups. We now hold five committee meetings and five assemblies each year. This past July we held our first weekend assembly and because of its success, we are planning our second one this summer. Many of our new members in Maryland are coming to us through treatment centers and have preconceived ideas of what A.A. is and is not. Unfortunately, many of these are inaccurate. Our area is holding special workshops in cooperation with the nine intergroups in the state in the hopes that we might overcome many of the problems. The percentage of groups supporting A.A. as a whole in Maryland rose from 49.4% in 1986 to 59.7% in 1987. We view this as a very positive sign of increasing health, growth and support for A.A. in Maryland.—*Dick Rowell*

Massachusetts (Western): Our area has about 150 groups serviced by separate institutions, intergroup and area committees. Our institutions committee services health and correctional facilities. Our area committee has representation from five districts. The area also has a P.I., C.P.C., and archives committee. The area committee sponsors an assembly in the spring and fall

of each year. The intergroup committee operates a business office five and a half days a week. Intergroup has a 24-hour hotline staffed by volunteers from 21 groups and a paid operator, prints and distributes meeting schedules and calendars of monthly intergroup visits. The delegate and the three chairpersons of our service committees attend and report on each service committee meeting.—*Gerry Ouelette*

Michigan (Western): We have 16 districts and 326 groups in our area. We started our first C.P.C. committee in 1987 and P.I. has been busy with radio tapes, TV spots, and school speakers. We are also putting the Big Book in our area libraries. Our institutions committee has been busy arranging meetings in prisons and obtaining literature and Grapevines for inmates. They have also worked hard on temporary contact for released inmates. In our area the outgoing delegate becomes the Grapevine chairperson. Our main concern is for G.S.R.s to report to their groups what is happening in our area assembly meetings.—*Roger Mansfield, Sr.*

Minnesota (Northern): Our area has 500 groups and 20 districts. We hold seven area meetings per year. This includes two area assemblies; one in the spring, and one in October. Four area committee meetings are held every other month. We hold an area workshop in February. The workshop and spring and fall assemblies are rotated. We have fair participation in our P.I. and C.P.C. committees. The people on our very active Institutions committee are discussing branching into separate corrections and treatment facilities committees. We are currently developing a state-wide service conference, and have a committee working closely with Area 36 (Southern Minnesota); our aim is to develop better A.A. unity in our state.—*Laurel "Scott" Johnson*

"Golden Mike Award"

Late Friday afternoon, Dick Rowell (Maryland) approached the floor mike with an important announcement:

"As a senior vice-president of Smoot-Rowell & Associates, Inc., it is my duty to report that our firm has been retained by one of the Conference committees (which wishes to remain anonymous) to perform a survey of which Conference member would be eligible to receive 'The Golden Mike Award' or, as it is sometimes referred to in some regions, 'The Mike-Hog Award.'"

"We are prepared to certify the accuracy of our findings and would like to quote a statistic prior to announcing the winner. All the listed Panel 37 delegates had 15 or more visits to the mike. Those individuals in a strong position for receiving this award are: Al Hendricks (Southern California), Greg Muth (Hawaii), Michael Goldsmith (California, Northern Coastal), Dick Pickens (Northern Florida), Denis Foster (Washington), Hal Carty (South Florida/Bahamas)."

"One additional aspect of the service we provide is to give the Conference some idea in advance of possible contenders for this award next year: Larry Nelson (California, San Diego/Imperial), Leo Gregory (Western New York), Dave Allen (Tennessee). And now, the president of our firm, David Smoot, will announce the results."

With that, David Smoot (District of Columbia) approached the mike with a small "golden mike" to announce — "And the winner is, DICK PICKENS!"

Mississippi: Our area has 200 groups and 26 districts. We hold four assembly meetings each year and each district holds a meeting prior to the assembly. We publish a newsletter containing the reports of area committee members. Most of the groups in our area are experiencing growth. The service pieces "This is a Closed Meeting of A.A." and "This is an Open Meeting of A.A." have been a tremendous help to many groups, particularly those located near treatment facilities. Major concerns in our area are how to stimulate interest, participation, and support from groups who don't participate in our assemblies, and how to rekindle interest of some of our oldtimers in service work.

—Carl McDonald

Montana: Our area has 11 districts and about 320 groups. Intergroups are active in a few of our larger cities. Attendance at district meetings has grown and our state assemblies, held twice yearly, have become very well attended despite difficult travel conditions. A large percent of state assembly participants are young people who are familiar with the A.A. service structure and who are eager to serve our area, districts, and groups. Over all, the future of A.A. in Montana is in the hands of beautiful, concerned, and caring members. We are in good shape and look forward to continued growth.—Ed Minarik

Nebraska: Area 41 now has a total of 27 districts and has 13 committees serving the area. We hold four two-day meetings each year; a Saturday afternoon workshop followed by special committee meetings and an open A.A. meeting. On Sunday the G.S.R. meeting is followed by committee meetings and the area business meeting. District newsletters are growing and they have created better communication among the groups. These newsletters have been a big plus for our area. We are now striving to bridge the gap between our treatment centers and A.A.

—Bill Smeal

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Our area has 240 groups served by 13 districts. Some districts have elected local committees to help the D.C.M.s keep in touch with groups in outlying regions. Our delegate and alternate delegate reside in adjacent provinces. Our area holds spring and fall assemblies annually, in conjunction with a social round-up; all districts have an opportunity to bid for hosting these events. Area officers and D.C.M.s meet twice yearly in Moncton, New Brunswick, prior to assemblies. Area workshops have proven to be learning experiences, and many D.C.M.s hold workshops at district levels. Most districts have well-functioning P.I., treatment facilities and correctional facilities committees. A good number of members have made service commitments at group and district levels.

—George Reid

New Hampshire: We now have 441 groups and an area service office with one employed office manager; and staffed by volunteers. All A.A. literature is sold through the office, and sale of literature and group donations are the main sources of revenue. Area committee meetings are held monthly, with all committee chairpersons and D.C.M.s present. Quarterly area assemblies are attended by committee chairpersons, D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s and all A.A.s who wish to attend. A.A. is healthy in New Hampshire.

—Lou Gifford

New Jersey (Southern): Our area has three intergroup offices, 19 districts and 15 D.C.M.s. We now have P.I. and C.P.C. chairpersons in our assembly. Our new Grapevine chairperson is very active. At our 24th Annual S.N.J. General Service Assembly Con-

vention we'll have signers for the hearing impaired. We now have four area "section leaders" who help the delegate and alternate and streamline our area committee and assembly meetings. Service sponsorship and the Traditions continue to concern us. There are some problems with newcomers from treatment facilities who discuss therapy in meetings and from nonalcohol-related "addicts" who are sent to us instead of to N.A.

—Bonita Anselmo

New Mexico: Our area has 15 districts and 266 groups, and the number of meetings in the city of Albuquerque has grown to 272 a week. There are several large districts with problems resulting from large distances between cities and towns. The area service structure has been strengthened by rotating our three assemblies and convention around the state. Our young people will hold their first conference in August. It is hoped that when requested, more can be done for the still-suffering Native American alcoholics in our pueblos and reservations. Cultural and language differences are downplayed; and assimilation and unification are stressed.—Ernie Truax

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Our area has 541 groups and 12 districts. Each district comprises from 30 to 60 groups and has one D.C.M. and one alternate D.C.M. Most of the districts now send out newsletters in an effort to reach all G.S.R.s and the concept of service sponsorship is being emphasized. The Grapevine committee has increased awareness of the importance of the Grapevine to sobriety and service. The Treatment facilities committee will soon have a contact program; C.P.C. will receive increased emphasis and support beginning with a C.P.C. workshop held in March. All of our committees are supported and stimulated by the N.Y.S. Informational Workshop, which rotates annually through the four delegate areas in New York state.

—Elizabeth Currier

New York (Western): Our area has undertaken a redistricting. We have 229 groups listed; 209 are active and 20 are unknown. Overall, we have approximately 340 meetings. Currently we have only 12 district committee representatives to cover these groups and meetings. As part of the redistricting, we would like to limit the number of groups or meetings in each district to ten. By reducing the number of groups each D.C.M. is responsible for we hope to increase the service and group participation. A committee of area representatives has been formed to redistrict our area.—Leo A. Gregory

"Significant Others" were there too . . .

Delegates often bring spouses, friends and/or children to New York, and a Host Committee — headed by Dorothy Conley, Margaret Dawson, Zetelle Guerra and other New York A.A.s and Al-Anons — planned activities and accompanied visitors who wished to participate. After morning coffee and pastry in the Hospitality Suite, daily activities included a Circle Line trip around Manhattan, tours of Chinatown, the Bronx Zoo, matinees on Wednesday, museums and shopping. Many among the 46 "significant others" were, of course, A.A. and Al-Anon members, who went to local A.A. and Al-Anon meetings in the evening.

North Dakota: Our area has elected to redistrict; there are now 13 districts in Area 52, each with about 12 groups. Most of our districts now have P.I. chairpersons who encourage groups to participate. P.I. meetings are held in schools, churches, hospitals, and treatment centers. We were privileged to host the 1987 West Central Regional Forum, in Fargo. This worthwhile event was an opportunity for us to learn more about the General Service Office and A.A.W.S.—*Bob Stenberg*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeast): Our area has 225 groups and 14 districts. The district committee members meet monthly to assist with redistricting. They also distribute the annual anonymity statement to newspapers and radio and TV stations in our area. The Archives committee is beginning to audiotape area histories and collect old literature. The Shut-In committee writes a monthly newsletter, reminding us to call or visit members unable to attend meetings. The New Group committee explains the service structure, and offers assistance to new groups. Grapevine displays are included in area service and intergroup meetings. We have added the two new A.A. World Services films to our library. G.S.R.s received a list of audiovisual materials and encourage their groups to use these tools.—*Rebekah Hathaway*

Ohio (Southwest): Our area has had a 16% increase in registered groups. Our redistricting increased the number of districts from 24 to 31 and about one-third of the districts hold regular monthly meetings. We have noticed an increase in participation from the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Three of our districts have held successful Traditions workshops, and one is sponsoring a workshop on the Three Legacies. Our area hosted the 1987 Ohio State Conference in Cincinnati. Approximately 850 guests were registered and there were 1,000 attendees at the Saturday night meeting. Our major problems are supporting the A.A. support system, the influx of new people from the court system, and communication with the members in the two intergroup structures within our area.—*Ken Gray*

Ontario (Western): Our area has 21 districts and 432 groups. We have a very active Grapevine Committee that attends conventions, and workshops where they set up Grapevine displays and present Grapevine-related information. As a result of recent Conference actions, we have instituted an intergroup liaison subcommittee. We would like the seven intergroup committees in the area to work more closely with the general service committees in their respective districts. Great strides have been made in coordinating the efforts of both committees. We are also committed to becoming more self-supporting at the area level.—*Frank Shea*

Oregon: Big Book study groups and meetings continue to increase, as does a continuation of many service workshops throughout the area. These workshops were encouraged by our past delegate. Former service workers (including past delegates) participate in workshops and assemblies. We have 33 districts and 529 registered groups. This is not an increase, but many of these groups have become much larger and a good number of our groups have multiple meetings. Most of the districts are very active in local service work and meet frequently. Alcoholics Anonymous is growing in Oregon.—*Ray Lynch*

Puerto Rico: Our area has 5 districts and 115 groups. We continuously receive letters and calls requesting information and talks from hospitals, medical doctors, psychiatrists, public schools and correctional and treatment facilities. Our groups individually carry the message to schools. We are using radio spots and TV spots to carry the message. Young people and women constitute more than 75% of our newcomers. An effort to make our A.A. members aware of the importance of our self-support Tradition is being stressed in groups, district and area meetings. As far as I know there is no deviation in our area from our singleness of purpose. No other consideration, no other dream is prevalent.—*Victor Rosario*

Quebec (Northwest): Our area has expanded from 11 to 17 districts. Our 308 groups are mostly French-speaking and are spread over a large territory. Our area executive committee meets each month with our five area committee coordinators. The executive committee meets with D.C.M.s and coordinators every other month. The four areas in Quebec meet with our trustee three times a year to share our experiences and to learn the status of our A.A. French publication and "La Vigne" Committees. Because we translate and print all A.A. publications, we depend on our French Publication Committee to exert a prudent budget. The large effort spent by our P.I. committee has had tremendous results. We have more demands from schools, industries and the health department than we ever expected.—*Richard Gadoury*

Quebec (Southwest): Our area has 32 districts and 548 groups and covers most of the Island of Montreal. We have the English language meetings that are geographically located in Areas 88 and 90. We have 25 French, 6 English and 1 Spanish district. In addition, we have Lithuanian, Italian and Greek language groups. Our bilingual newsletter, *Box 460*, shares service experience and information and is sent to all groups, districts and subcommittees. We meet monthly with our Area Committee and we have recently added D.C.M. schools and G.S.R. schools. The Province of Quebec (Areas 87–90), has approximately 27,000 members.—*John MacDonald*

Rhode Island: Our area holds quarterly assemblies and workshops and our five committees and seven districts meet monthly. Alternate D.C.M.s serve as coordinators for structure schools. C.P.C. and P.I. handle our answering service and books speakers for schools, colleges, and hospitals. C.P.C. guides medical students to open A.A. meetings; P.I. organizes health fairs, handles media interviews, and displays literature in libraries. Our correctional and treatment facilities committee sponsors 20 weekly meetings. Archives has a display of Rhode Island history, tapes of interviews with oldtimers, and copies of *Conference Reports*. Our structure remains strong.—*Mary Beaudry*

Saskatchewan: Our area has 320 groups and 16 districts, ranging from a low of about five groups in sparsely populated areas up north, to just over 50 groups in the cities. Two years ago a dedicated group of oldtimers wrote a book on the history of A.A. in Saskatchewan. Last names were used throughout the book and this created controversy. At first the assembly voted to accept the book "as is" with the understanding that it was for use within the Fellowship only. But there were dissenting votes. The highlight of that assembly was watching Concept V gradually sway the entire group. The final decision was to recall distributed copies of the book, destroy existing copies, and set up an ad hoc committee to draft a set of guidelines for the preparation of a new publication.—*Gerry Flegel*

*"Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern."
— Tradition Two*

South Carolina: Our area assembly meets three times a year; the format includes committee meetings, workshops, an open A.A. meeting, and a business meeting. During the February area assembly we adopted the largest budget in our history. We are attempting to support our service structure so that we may more effectively carry the A.A. message. We now have 10 districts and 230 groups registered in South Carolina. Our biggest challenge is to encourage and obtain 100% participation of our groups.
—James Kenna

South Dakota: Our area has 130 groups and 15 districts. One district, on the Native American reservation, is now inactive. In January and July we hold two-day workshops on service, and also have a business meeting to decide which motions will be on the agenda at the spring and fall assemblies. The G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s can bring this information back to the groups to determine the group conscience and then vote accordingly at the state assemblies. This year all approved motions were printed in booklet form. These will be handed out to all D.C.M.s at district meetings for use as guidelines, similar to the General Service Conference Advisory Actions.—Arv Straatmeyer

Tennessee: We now have approximately 354 groups. Nashville, Chattanooga and Memphis are creating new districts; new districts are formed when a district comprises more than 15 groups. The International Conference of Young People in A.A. is holding its conference at Opryland, Nashville, Tennessee, on Labor Day weekend this year. A growing number of A.A. members are coming from treatment facilities and we are working to improve our relationship with treatment facilities. Districts in eastern Tennessee are interested in the Conference's consideration of incorporating intergroups and central offices into the A.A. service structure.—Dave Allen

Texas (Northwest): Service activity in Northwest Texas has grown to four quarterly assemblies rotated around our vast 71-county area. We have 14 districts, 215 groups and P.I./C.P.C., treatment facilities, institutions, and Grapevine committees. We recently held a weekend workshop on the Twelve Concepts, led by past delegates, and our "Not Quite Serene Players of District 3" performed the *Twelve Traditions Play*. We now have 24-hour A.A. "hotlines" in Amarillo, Hereford, Lubbock, El Paso and Midland/Odessa. Our first Spanish-speaking intergroup has recently been activated in El Paso. We encourage attention to the Traditions and service participation. All districts now have district GvRs.—Herb Wales

Texas (Southwest): Our area has 426 groups in 26 districts, with 22 D.C.M.s. We have six intergroups and five monthly newsletters. There are seven standing committees. We currently hold two area workshops; in January and July. These workshops move throughout the area in an effort to increase participation in service work. Our April and October area assemblies are held in rotating locations. Our goals for the next two years are: have active D.C.M.s in all districts; publish a quarterly area newsletter; increase group awareness of area activities; and increase group participation, both financially and in attendance.
—Larry Yarrington

Vermont: We created a new district and split a large district into two subdistricts; each with their own D.C.M. We also structured a previously unstructured district and structured a new district from one that comprised groups from Vermont and New Hampshire. The Vermont groups stayed with Area 70 and the

New Hampshire groups joined Area 43 respectively. We now have 9 districts and 185 groups. All districts were represented by D.C.M.s at a 1987 area committee meeting for the first time in our history. One of our larger southern districts is discussing the pros and cons of splitting their district. All in all, the benefits of the service structure in carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic is evident in all active districts.—Bill Miller

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Group donations have increased, pulling us out of what looked like a serious financial problem two years ago. We now have a small surplus. We have also gone back to our old system of having our most recent delegate serve as area Grapevine chairperson. Our present alternate delegate as area chairperson. There are now seven district monthly newsletters printed. The area P.I. committee seems to be moving slowly but steadily, and archives activity has tapered off. For the past year we have been preparing for the 12th Annual East Central Regional Conference to be held July 22-24 in Green Bay, Wisconsin.—Jim Schneck

Wyoming: We are growing at a slow but steady pace. We have 114 groups with approximately 1,767 members. Some of the groups in smaller rural towns close up in the winter because of travel hardship, but return to the roster every spring. Our area is trying to become self-supporting by paying at least part of the area committees' expenses. Young People's second conference was held in Cheyenne and the third one is scheduled for July. We go into the state penitentiary twice a month and there is a lot of interest in P.I. work.—Sandra Fox

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1988

	Groups	Members
United States	38,276	775,040
Canada	4,654	78,057
Overseas	31,387 ¹	707,130 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,867 ²	56,010
Internationalists		533
Lone members		526
	76,184	1,617,296

1. At the end of 1987, we had reported members from 67 of the 118 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 26,187 groups and 595,443 members. To establish an estimate for the 51 countries not yet responding, we excluded the eight largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 51 and the overall estimate emerged.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Financial Overview

FINANCE: As a result of strong contributions and strong portable Big Book sales, G.S.O.'s net income for 1987 was \$331,000 (after paying extraordinary expenses of \$914,000 for construction and \$93,900 for a computer system study). It was therefore possible to pay these expenses from operating income and transfer a net of \$250,000 from the General Service Office to the Reserve Fund in 1988.

The positive G.S.O. net contrasted with the negative \$599,400 that had been budgeted. In large part this positive net resulted from the unprecedented response of A.A. groups to the concerns of the General Service and A.A.W.S. Boards over the increasing percentage of service expense that had to be supported by publishing income. The referenced sales of the portable Big Book also contributed to the positive G.S.O. net.

A 1987 management challenge that extends into 1988 and beyond is to accurately anticipate increased contribution income in order to reduce literature prices as a means of returning income to the Fellowship and to the suffering alcoholic.

SERVICES: Contributions for 1987 were \$3,652,200, up 37% over 1986 contributions of \$2,665,600, the result of the self-support effort. A shortfall of \$172,000 in ordinary expenses of Services and other expenses of the General Service Board remained. However, in comparison to the 1986 shortfall of \$857,500, the 1987 figure is most encouraging and supports the feasibility of altogether eliminating this shortfall.

The cost of these services in 1987 (exclusive of extraordinary items) increased 6.7% over 1986. Contributing to the increase were the growth of the Fellowship and inflation, both of which were slight in 1987.

PUBLISHING: Literature sales for 1987 were \$8,354,900, up 11.5% over 1986. A major cause of this increase was the introduction of the soft-cover Big Book, whose sales were strong and, surprisingly, largely not at the expense of the hard-cover edition. Other out-of-the-ordinary occurrences were reduction in sales of "Pass It On" (an expected second-year phenomenon for a new title) and reduced sales income due to price decreases during the year.

Expenses charged to publishing increased by 16.6% over 1986.

Above-normal increases were due to inflation and increased sales volume, the operation's need for expanded space in 1987, and a relocation study charged to publishing.

In early 1988 an additional price decrease was instituted, bringing to about 25% the decreases taken since the inception of the self-support effort. Literature is now sold to all purchasers at close to cost ("single pricing"), volume discounts remain in effect, and royalty expense is reduced in proportion to the retail price reduction.



RELOCATION: The A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards undertook a study of the possible relocation of the offices when the lease expires in 1991. A national consulting firm, Fantus & Co., was enlisted to evaluate cost and other objective factors associated with a move to various locations in the New York metropolitan area and elsewhere in the United States. The result was a recommendation by those boards that the office remain in the New York area and that intensive studies of relocation in the New York area be undertaken to control costs. The sense of the 1988 Conference supported this recommendation.

COMPUTER STUDY: One of the extraordinary expense items relates to a study of our computer needs. The need exists to improve our service to the growing Fellowship; our present system (now ten years old), is obsolete. We are seeking a system which will include new software (order entry, contributions, inventory, general ledger, record keeping, subscriptions, etc.) based on improved database capabilities, and new hardware (the computer itself). Some of these costs are reflected in the 1988 budget. This acquisition will serve the Grapevine as well as G.S.O.

GRAPEVINE: The Grapevine ended 1987 on a positive note with a total revenue of \$1,633,700; \$207,000 higher than 1986 and \$19,000 higher than budgeted. This resulted in large part from higher subscription rates (January 1, 1986) rather than higher average circulation.

Grapevine's expenses for 1987 were \$1,583,000, compared with a budget of \$1,644,700, and in comparison with \$1,647,300 in 1986 actual expenses. Therefore expenses were about \$61,000 less than budget and about \$64,000 less than 1986.

Grapevine's net income for 1987, including interest earned, was \$106,500, as opposed to a net loss of \$97,700 in 1986, and a budgeted net income in 1987 of \$26,300.

Grapevine's 1988 budget projects income at \$1,641,000, which is just slightly higher than 1987. Expenses for 1988 are anticipated at \$1,698,250, 7% higher than the 1987 actual.

RESERVE FUND: The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a balance at December 31, 1987 of \$6,961,400, yielding approximately 7.7% on book value. After drawing down \$200,000 in mid-1987, but transferring \$450,000, in March 1988, from the General Service Office, the Reserve Fund stands at 11.7 months as measured against 1987's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services Inc., the General Service Board of A.A., Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee is responsible for the custodianship of the Reserve Fund. As such it has been concerned about the Fund approaching its limit. The committee has spent the past year considering and finally recommending to the Conference, its proposal for handling Reserve Fund excesses. The Conference approved the Finance Committee's recommendation to use literature price reductions as the primary means of adjusting the Reserve Fund to the Conference-approved limit of one year's operating expenses.

The Finance Committee also recommended, and received Conference approval for a list of possible demands for which the Reserve Fund can be used.

Summary: As a result of major shifts in the makeup of G.S.O. income our literature will be sold on a single-pricing schedule to all buyers; close to fully-absorbed cost in 1988 and hopefully, at cost in 1989. Literature income thus foregone is being replaced with unprecedented contributions from the groups in response to the challenge of self-support. In 1987 G.S.O. moved most of the way toward the goal of being an entity that is sound in regard to tradition and finances.

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1987

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$8,354,886			\$8,354,886
Less: Discounts	(182,382)			(182,382)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>8,172,504</u>			<u>8,172,504</u>
Cost of products	(2,722,078)			(2,722,078)
Royalties	(1,018,966)			(1,018,966)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>4,431,460</u>			<u>4,431,460</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$3,652,163		3,652,163
Interest income	16,429	13,650		30,079
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>4,447,889</u>	<u>3,665,813</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>8,113,702</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,136,815	1,557,242		2,694,057
Pension expense	231,383			231,383
Rent and electric	296,938	217,780		514,718
Box 4-5-9		149,857		149,857
A.A. Directories		78,659		78,659
Other service materials		234,826		234,826
Shipping and mailing	860,834			860,834
Other office expenses	60,174	442,989		503,163
Insurance and payroll taxes		484,053		484,053
Professional services	151,404		20,875	172,279
Board, committee and staff meetings	44,444	13,031	105,275	162,750
Writers' fees	81,642			81,642
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	14,193		74,881	89,074
General Service Conference		209,204		209,204
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	58,318			58,318
Regional Forums and other			95,771	95,771
Film project			101,604	101,604
EDP system review			93,850	93,850
Relocation study	26,550			26,550
Leasehold improvements and construction			914,375	914,375
Self-support project			43,115	43,115
Foreign literature assistance (net)	(17,391)			(17,391)
<u>Total Expenses</u>	<u>2,945,304</u>	<u>3,387,641</u>	<u>1,449,746</u>	<u>7,782,691</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>1,502,585</u>	<u>278,172</u>	<u>(1,449,746)</u>	<u>331,011</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$6,161,097
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				500,000
Transfer to General Fund				(200,000)
Investment Income				500,329
Balance, December 31				<u>\$6,961,426</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The General Service Office INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1986

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund		General Service Office Total
		Office	Other	
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$7,485,685			\$7,485,685
Discount to A.A. Groups	(120,466)			(120,466)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>7,365,219</u>			<u>7,365,219</u>
Cost of products	(2,418,140)			(2,418,140)
Royalties	(912,548)			(912,548)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>4,034,531</u>			<u>4,034,531</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$2,665,634		2,665,634
Interest income	23,037	8,264		31,301
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>4,057,568</u>	<u>2,673,898</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>6,731,466</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	963,139	1,495,585		2,458,724
Pension expense	243,557			243,557
Rent and electric	181,137	194,163		375,300
Box 4-5-9		118,206		118,206
A.A. Directories		77,290		77,290
Other service materials		206,519		206,519
Shipping and mailing	755,973			755,973
Other office expenses	42,033	362,491		404,524
Insurance and payroll taxes		389,142		389,142
Professional services	139,922		19,114	159,036
Board, committee and staff meetings	37,117	11,778	104,458	153,353
Writers' fees	61,443			61,443
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	7,381		111,183	118,564
General Service Conference		193,657		193,657
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	89,715			89,715
Regional Forums and other			84,223	84,223
World Service Meeting			50,461	50,461
Film project			145,305	145,305
Grapevine management study			26,007	26,007
Leasehold improvements and construction			72,243	72,243
Foreign literature assistance (net)	3,351			3,351
<u>Total Expenses</u>	<u>2,524,768</u>	<u>3,048,831</u>	<u>612,994</u>	<u>6,186,593</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>1,532,800</u>	<u>(374,933)</u>	<u>(612,994)</u>	<u>544,873</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$4,641,025
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				750,000
Transfer to General Fund				(100,000)
Investment Income				870,072
Balance, December 31				<u>\$6,161,097</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1987

	1987	1986
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$1,633,684</u>	<u>\$1,426,695</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$185,730	\$219,176
Printing	219,160	213,087
Mailing — service	101,857	108,785
postage	142,262	149,893
Other production costs	103,054	98,503
Calendar costs	35,007	26,363
Occupancy costs	65,911	39,037
Telephone	1,546	1,792
Writers' fees	23,000	7,500
Office supplies and other	<u>7,779</u>	<u>16,657</u>
Total	885,306	880,793
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	298,166	297,180
Data processing costs	19,746	16,320
Stationery and supplies	10,537	11,665
Occupancy costs	65,911	39,037
Telephone	1,546	1,826
Office expense, including agency fees	15,304	23,281
Selling expense — Regular	36,792	50,330
GVR program	14,131	32,047
Postage	<u>42,661</u>	<u>42,388</u>
Total	504,794	514,074
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	4,746	5,496
Insurance	44,633	41,752
Professional fees	27,130	32,955
Payroll taxes	34,861	38,611
Meetings and conferences	15,621	17,496
Computer system development, etc.	21,070	18,486
Furniture and equipment	9,883	14,086
Contribution to Retirement Plan	33,963	22,308
Canadian exchange and other	1,188	1,139
Severance benefits	<u>—</u>	<u>60,142</u>
Total	193,095	252,471
Total Costs and Expenses	<u>\$1,583,195</u>	<u>\$1,647,338</u>
Income (Loss) from Operations	50,489	(220,643)
Interest earned	56,029	58,095
Cumulative effect of a change in accounting method	<u>—</u>	<u>64,862</u>
Net Income (Loss) for Year (Exhibit B)	<u><u>106,518</u></u>	<u><u>(97,686)</u></u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

December 31, 1987

	December 31, 1987		December 31, 1986	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
Assets				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 573,699	\$ 230,849	\$ 315,200	\$ 99,059
Short-term cash investments	902,158	154,868	585,833	113,975
Investment (Note C)	—	617,941	—	566,941
Accounts receivable	144,784	59,638	157,553	65,345
Due from Grapevine	26,339	—	11,538	—
Inventories	1,056,299	101,537	1,209,166	134,003
Prepaid expenses and deposits	144,666	61,933	120,299	79,977
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>2,847,945</u>	<u>1,226,766</u>	<u>2,399,589</u>	<u>1,059,300</u>
Deduct Liabilities				
Accounts and accruals payable	909,863	141,354	493,915	146,710
Deferred income	12,457	1,055,896	11,056	989,592
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>922,320</u>	<u>1,197,250</u>	<u>504,971</u>	<u>1,136,302</u>
Net Worth				
Balance, January 1	1,894,614	(77,002)	1,999,745	20,684
Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)	331,011	106,518	544,873	(97,686)
Transfer to Reserve Fund (net)	(300,000)	—	(650,000)	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,925,625</u>	<u>29,516</u>	<u>1,894,618</u>	<u>(77,002)</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,868,612		\$1,837,605	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,925,625		1,894,618	
Reserve Fund	6,961,426		6,161,097	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>8,887,051</u>		<u>8,055,715</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 260,624		\$ 11,375	
Short term cash investments	684,691		1,283,759	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(48,000)		(51,000)	
U.S. Treasury obligations	6,557,038		5,381,315	
Accrued interest	125,014		102,589	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(617,941)		(566,941)	
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>6,961,426</u>		<u>6,161,097</u>	

() denotes red figures

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS, DECEMBER 31, 1987

NOTE A — PURPOSES AND RESTRICTIONS OF DIFFERENT FUNDS

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was re-defined as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and, since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

NOTE B — After transfers of \$971,574 in 1987 and \$887,927 in 1986 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$617,941, represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, plus subsequent net investments of \$137,221 as shown below:

	Investment (Withdrawal)
1981	\$ (100,000)
1983	13,418
1984	60,000
1985	60,000
1986	52,803
1987	51,000
	<u>137,221</u>

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

1988 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: The sales income budget of \$7,888,900, is \$466,000 (5.5%) less than 1987. This budget reflects a major concept change, which is the elimination of 2 tier pricing. This results in *single pricing*. This will be accomplished *along with* the further reduction of A.A. prices (effective 3/1/88, book and booklets are being reduced about 12% and the discount available against pamphlets and other items will be increased to 22%).

This is being instituted to accomplish first, the reduction of excess income from outside sales and secondly, to reduce income from literature sales in response to — both past and anticipated — increased contributions. This will move us towards becoming fully self-supporting from our own contributions.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$3,183,000, an increase of \$237,700 over 1987.

Net: Net publishing income is expected to be \$505,600, a *reduction* of \$997,000 from 1987.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: The budget reflects a projected 15% increase in contributions over 1987 (1987 had a 37% increase over 1986), based on continued support to the Self-Support project.

Expenses: Total group expenses to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted to be \$3,787,800. Contributions will therefore be greater than the expenses charged against them, and the excess used to help offset General Fund — Other Expenses.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$926,900. This includes \$409,700 towards the acquisition of a new computer system (\$400,000) and completion of the system study (\$9,700). Exclusive of these costs, other expenses are budgeted \$75,700 higher than 1987. The 1988 budget includes World Service Meeting and related guest of the board expenses in the sum of \$84,400, for which there were no similar items in 1987. The total other expenses will be offset by the excess of contributions over group service expenses, as well as net publishing income.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1988 of "group services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$97,000. This is exclusive of the computer acquisition and study which will be offset by anticipated net income from publishing.

1988 Grapevine Budget

Total income: The budget presented shows income of \$1,641,000 at a circulation level of 121,000. This is slightly higher than 1987.

Total expenses: Printing of the magazine shows a \$6,800 (3%) increase over 1987. While we are changing printers to keep the production costs down, the current reports are that paper prices will be going higher in 1988.

Mailing service costs — It is expected that with the changing of printers we will be able to save some money by contracting the mailing operation.

Magazine mailing postage — We are budgeting the same as last year. While we do expect a raise in postal rates, we are currently expecting to mail fewer copies than budgeted for last year.

Total editorial and printing costs are budgeted at \$904,850, an increase of \$19,500 (2.2%) over 1987.

Total costs and expenses of \$1,698,250, are \$115,000, (7.3%) over the 1987 actual expenses, mainly due to increase in Selling expenses and full year's salaries of additional staff put on during 1987.

Net: After including interest income of \$58,000 we show a net income for the period of \$750.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

a. G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and Final Conference Report]:

1986

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$2,665,634
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,048,831		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board	\$ 612,994		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Construction	(72,243)	540,751	3,589,582
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(923,948)</u>

1987

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$3,652,163
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,387,641		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board	\$1,449,746		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Construction	(914,375)		
System review	(93,850)	441,521	3,829,162
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(176,999)</u>

1988 BUDGET

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,208,000
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,787,800		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board	\$ 926,900		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(400,000)		
System review	(9,700)	517,200	4,305,000
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(97,000)</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1988 BUDGET

	1988	
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales		<u>\$1,641,000</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	\$184,500	
Printing	226,000	
Mailing — service	112,000	
— postage	160,000	
Other production costs	134,250	
Occupancy costs	74,000	
Telephone	2,200	
Office supplies and expenses	7,300	
Other editorial expenses	<u>4,600</u>	
<u>Total</u>		904,850
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	354,300	
Data processing costs	22,000	
Stationery and supplies	7,500	
Occupancy costs	74,000	
Telephone	2,200	
Office expense, including agency fees	18,400	
Selling expense — regular	46,000	
— GvR program	26,000	
Postage	<u>46,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		596,400
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Compensation study	20,000	
Consultant fee	4,000	
Insurance	52,000	
Professional fees	22,000	
Payroll taxes	42,000	
Computer system development, etc.	1,000	
Meetings, conferences	18,000	
Furniture and equipment	5,000	
Contribution to Retirement Plan	30,000	
Canadian exchange	1,000	
Bad debts	<u>2,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		<u>197,000</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		<u>1,698,250</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(57,250)
Interest earned		<u>58,000</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR		<u><u>750</u></u>

1988 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: The sales income budget of \$7,888,900, is \$466,000 (5.5%) less than 1987. This budget reflects a major concept change, which is the elimination of 2 tier pricing. This results in *single pricing*. This will be accomplished *along with* the further reduction of A.A. prices (effective 3/1/88, book and booklets are being reduced about 12% and the discount available against pamphlets and other items will be increased to 22%).

This is being instituted to accomplish first, the reduction of excess income from outside sales and secondly, to reduce income from literature sales in response to — both past and anticipated — increased contributions. This will move us towards becoming fully self-supporting from our own contributions.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$3,183,000, an increase of \$237,700 over 1987.

Net: Net publishing income is expected to be \$505,600, a *reduction* of \$997,000 from 1987.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: The budget reflects a projected 15% increase in contributions over 1987 (1987 had a 37% increase over 1986), based on continued support to the Self-Support project.

Expenses: Total group expenses to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted to be \$3,787,800. Contributions will therefore be greater than the expenses charged against them, and the excess used to help offset General Fund — Other Expenses.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$926,900. This includes \$409,700 towards the acquisition of a new computer system (\$400,000) and completion of the system study (\$9,700). Exclusive of these costs, other expenses are budgeted \$75,700 higher than 1987. The 1988 budget includes World Service Meeting and related guest of the board expenses in the sum of \$84,400, for which there were no similar items in 1987. The total other expenses will be offset by the excess of contributions over group service expenses, as well as net publishing income.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1988 of "group services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$97,000. This is exclusive of the computer acquisition and study which will be offset by anticipated net income from publishing.

1988 Grapevine Budget

Total income: The budget presented shows income of \$1,641,000 at a circulation level of 121,000. This is slightly higher than 1987.

Total expenses: Printing of the magazine shows a \$6,800 (3%) increase over 1987. While we are changing printers to keep the production costs down, the current reports are that paper prices will be going higher in 1988.

Mailing service costs — It is expected that with the changing of printers we will be able to save some money by contracting the mailing operation.

Magazine mailing postage — We are budgeting the same as last year. While we do expect a raise in postal rates, we are currently expecting to mail fewer copies than budgeted for last year.

Total editorial and printing costs are budgeted at \$904,850, an increase of \$19,500 (2.2%) over 1987.

Total costs and expenses of \$1,698,250, are \$115,000, (7.3%) over the 1987 actual expenses, mainly due to increase in Selling expenses and full year's salaries of additional staff put on during 1987.

Net: After including interest income of \$58,000 we show a net income for the period of \$750.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

- a. G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and Final Conference Report]:

1986

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$2,665,634
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,048,831		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
	\$ 612,994		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Construction	(72,243)	540,751	3,589,582
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions			<u>(923,948)</u>

1987

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$3,652,163
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,387,641		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
	\$1,449,746		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Construction	(914,375)		
System review	(93,850)	441,521	3,829,162
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions			<u>(176,999)</u>

1988 BUDGET

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,208,000
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,787,800		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
	\$ 926,900		
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(400,000)		
System review	(9,700)	517,200	4,305,000
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions			<u>(97,000)</u>

1987 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	328	200	60.9%	\$ 20,362.33	4,368	\$4.66	61.	Rhode Island	177	103	58.1	13,500.84	3,329	4.06
2.	Alaska	191	83	43.4	6,911.57	2,509	2.75	62.	South Carolina	236	175	74.1	20,398.42	3,806	5.36
3.	Arizona	603	310	51.4	38,142.94	10,015	3.81	63.	South Dakota	132	76	57.5	6,635.33	2,576	2.58
4.	Arkansas	214	124	57.9	11,089.57	2,908	3.81	64.	Tennessee	375	216	57.6	24,320.21	5,632	4.32
5.	California								Texas						
5.	Southern	1,423	702	49.3	97,107.03	46,347	2.10	65.	Northeast	361	217	60.1	39,857.11	10,952	3.64
6.	N. Coastal	1,688	1,144	67.7	179,420.65	40,663	4.41	66.	Northwest	209	122	58.3	12,037.05	4,848	2.48
7.	N. Interior	521	274	52.5	45,328.37	11,545	3.93	67.	Southeast	410	224	54.6	27,602.36	11,607	2.38
8.	San Diego/Imp.	560	320	57.1	39,994.85	14,677	2.73	68.	Southwest	403	203	50.3	29,374.85	7,568	3.88
9.	Mid-South.	1,290	716	55.5	81,137.50	39,106	2.07	69.	Utah	177	108	61.0	11,158.36	3,056	3.65
10.	Colorado	559	307	54.9	36,222.94	12,018	3.01	70.	Vermont	173	93	53.7	13,494.90	2,804	4.81
11.	Connecticut	968	550	56.8	71,888.10	20,192	3.56	71.	Virginia	888	565	63.6	85,872.18	16,774	5.12
12.	Delaware	120	89	74.1	15,023.42	1,896	7.92	72.	Washington	977	570	58.3	71,037.11	17,781	4.00
13.	D.C.	347	236	68.0	49,006.08	10,656	4.60	73.	West Virginia	207	123	59.4	9,876.39	2,401	4.11
14.	Florida								Wisconsin						
14.	North	442	267	60.4	37,156.78	7,514	4.95	74.	N.Wis./Upper						
15.	South	1,095	663	60.5	106,774.81	17,979	5.94		Pen. Mich.	542	267	49.2	22,448.53	8,195	2.74
16.	Georgia	552	466	84.4	65,643.35	11,724	5.60	75.	South	685	345	50.3	32,300.24	12,435	2.60
17.	Hawaii	208	165	79.3	20,849.71	3,307	6.30	76.	Wyoming	121	73	60.3	5,369.90	1,859	2.89
18.	Idaho	164	98	59.7	8,907.68	1,905	4.68	77.	Puerto Rico	117	65	55.5	3,608.27	1,495	2.41
19.	Illinois							78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	517	232	44.8	24,677.02	6,627	3.72
19.	Chicago	891	443	49.7	58,527.42	20,444	2.86	79.	B.C./Yukon	594	320	53.8	35,973.87	8,874	4.05
20.	North	708	376	53.1	37,700.90	12,644	2.98	80.	Manitoba	153	70	45.7	6,569.43	3,517	1.87
21.	South	320	159	49.6	17,512.96	5,510	3.18	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	219	112	51.1	11,487.28	3,098	3.71
22.	Indiana							82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	256	112	43.7	8,433.57	2,831	2.98
22.	North	506	267	52.7	23,850.83	7,696	3.10		Ontario						
23.	South	290	200	68.9	23,418.74	5,633	4.16	83.	East	499	264	52.9	34,670.39	11,407	3.04
24.	Iowa	587	308	52.4	28,369.14	10,912	2.60	84.	Northeast	175	78	44.5	10,740.26	2,124	5.06
25.	Kansas	326	220	67.4	17,816.70	7,064	2.52	85.	Northwest	89	32	35.9	3,933.64	1,342	2.93
26.	Kentucky	432	279	64.5	44,480.15	6,886	6.46	86.	West	438	182	41.5	33,179.33	6,828	4.86
27.	Louisiana	459	246	53.5	23,417.83	7,394	3.17		Quebec						
28.	Maine	336	179	53.2	17,711.55	5,832	3.04	87.	Southwest	549	345	62.8	33,536.64	14,274	2.35
29.	Maryland	666	398	59.7	43,481.86	9,230	4.71	88.	Southeast	234	163	69.6	19,847.39	3,313	5.99
30.	Massachusetts							89.	Northeast	325	251	77.0	34,407.10	5,850	5.88
30.	East	948	527	55.5	90,029.93	27,492	3.27	90.	Northwest	313	257	82.0	62,464.79	5,662	11.03
31.	West	159	106	66.6	16,822.71	3,470	4.85	91.	Saskatchewan	323	190	58.8	13,853.80	3,985	3.48
32.	Michigan								Total U.S./						
32.	Central	391	217	55.4	32,343.86	7,976	4.06		Canada	42,912	24,274 ^①	56.6% ^①	\$3,106,554.64 ^②	852,730	\$3.64 ^①
33.	Southeast	461	243	52.7	42,169.67	10,049	4.20		Bahamas	8	4	50.0	400.00	129	3.10
34.	West	327	180	55.0	27,496.26	6,141	4.48		V.I. of U.S.	10	9	90.0	2,218.12	238	9.31
35.	Minnesota									42,930	24,287 ^①	56.6% ^①	\$3,109,172.76 ^②	853,097	\$3.64 ^①
35.	North	503	277	55.0	17,384.48	7,806	2.23		Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				\$ 184,899.46		
36.	South	893	439	49.1	44,525.22	25,370	1.76		Specials				321,863.84		
37.	Mississippi	216	128	59.2	8,795.89	2,533	3.47		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$3,615,936.06		
38.	Missouri								FOREIGN AND OTHER						
38.	East	439	260	59.2	28,063.51	6,049	4.64		Birds of a Feather				\$ 119.09		
39.	West	210	127	60.4	16,000.81	4,552	3.52		Correctional facility groups				21.00		
40.	Montana	314	140	44.5	10,910.23	3,978	2.74		Foreign				17,435.06		
41.	Nebraska	624	404	64.7	48,534.90	11,238	4.32		International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				15,000.00		
42.	Nevada	240	120	50.0	12,730.73	3,552	3.58		International Doctors in A.A.				589.00		
43.	New Hampshire	325	183	56.3	23,051.40	4,212	5.47		International Lawyers in A.A.				1511.31		
44.	New Jersey								Internationalists				225.00		
44.	North	1,020	496	48.6	69,544.79	22,236	3.13		Loners				1,438.18		
45.	South	268	161	60.0	25,303.30	4,068	6.22		Treatment facility meetings				287.92		
46.	New Mexico	242	140	57.8	13,925.97	3,695	3.77		World Hello				67.37		
47.	New York								Grand Total				\$3,652,629.99		
47.	Central	503	262	52.0	44,310.40	7,207	6.15								
48.	H./M./B.	496	255	51.4	26,980.88	5,872	4.59								
49.	Southeast	1,349	723	53.5	135,213.76	35,929	3.76								
50.	West	231	116	50.2	11,531.53	3,300	3.49								
51.	N. Carolina/Ber.	614	410	66.7	53,834.16	9,643	5.58								
52.	North Dakota	163	127	77.9	8,480.73	2,744	3.09								
53.	Ohio														
53.	Cent. & S.E.	441	215	48.7	28,785.59	4,780	6.02								
54.	Northeast	902	295	32.7	28,357.29	22,034	1.29								
55.	N.W. Ohio/														
55.	S.E. Mich.	230	128	55.6	17,748.89	3,256	5.45								
56.	S.W. Ohio	375	202	53.8	23,760.92	7,020	3.38								
57.	Oklahoma	331	267	80.6	25,875.89	4,683	5.53								
58.	Oregon	569	321	56.4	36,861.18	8,432	4.37								
59.	Pennsylvania														
59.	East	892	529	59.3	73,987.90	19,793	3.74								
60.	West	568	334	58.8	33,269.54	8,196	4.06								

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1987 Total Contributions — by State / Province

U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	248	148	59.6%	\$ 12,582.24	3,571	\$3.52
Alaska	191	83	43.4	8,510.47	2,509	3.39
Arizona	590	302	51.1	42,837.20	9,988	4.29
Arkansas	213	124	58.2	12,833.30	2,903	4.42
California	5,529	3,179	57.4	523,911.07	154,093	3.40
Colorado	559	307	54.9	44,756.13	12,018	3.72
Connecticut	977	557	57.0	84,759.18	20,438	4.15
Delaware	119	88	73.9	17,071.42	1,863	9.16
District of Columbia	153	93	60.7	24,842.75	4,692	5.29
Florida	1,618	983	60.7	197,432.99	26,697	7.40
Georgia	552	466	84.4	68,511.20	11,724	5.84
Hawaii	208	165	79.3	22,939.44	3,307	6.94
Idaho	208	119	57.2	13,217.91	2,352	5.62
Illinois	1,918	977	50.9	142,881.58	38,666	3.70
Indiana	824	486	58.9	59,508.72	13,752	4.33
Iowa	588	308	52.3	35,788.21	10,925	3.28
Kansas	325	220	67.6	26,218.93	7,055	3.72
Kentucky	404	261	64.6	43,444.28	6,492	6.69
Louisiana	460	246	53.4	26,046.22	7,406	3.52
Maine	320	170	53.1	22,440.84	5,657	3.97
Maryland	854	535	62.6	81,435.34	15,038	5.42
Massachusetts	1,130	641	56.7	120,607.28	31,267	3.86
Michigan	1,357	727	53.5	126,513.74	26,529	4.77
Minnesota	1,394	714	51.2	75,905.72	33,149	2.29
Mississippi	216	128	59.2	9,222.54	2,533	3.64
Missouri	649	387	59.6	50,803.94	10,617	4.79
Montana	314	140	44.5	12,122.27	3,978	3.05
Nebraska	625	404	64.6	59,794.21	11,250	5.32
Nevada	203	103	50.7	13,331.46	3,006	4.43
New Hampshire	327	185	56.5	26,229.40	4,211	6.23
New Jersey	1,286	657	51.0	105,616.84	26,260	4.02
New Mexico	247	148	59.9	25,749.21	3,680	7.00
New York	2,585	1,358	52.5	252,562.31	52,191	4.84
North Carolina	597	412	69.0	61,258.66	9,492	6.45
North Dakota	163	127	77.9	13,064.53	2,744	4.76
Ohio	1,912	822	42.9	110,873.59	36,175	3.06
Oklahoma	332	267	80.4	30,368.65	4,691	6.47
Oregon	569	323	56.7	40,532.59	8,415	4.82
Pennsylvania	1,478	879	59.4	118,866.94	28,259	4.21
Rhode Island	175	103	58.8	15,060.09	3,232	4.66
South Carolina	236	175	74.1	21,888.42	3,806	5.75
South Dakota	132	76	57.5	10,051.20	2,576	3.90
Tennessee	374	215	57.4	30,363.35	5,632	5.39
Texas	1,378	758	55.0	124,406.61	34,753	3.58
Utah	178	109	61.2	11,581.81	3,081	3.76
Vermont	174	92	52.8	13,585.54	2,836	4.79
Virginia	895	571	63.7	95,622.75	16,924	5.65
Washington	922	540	58.5	76,472.49	17,195	4.45
West Virginia	202	118	58.4	9,012.72	2,345	3.84
Wisconsin	1,090	548	50.2	53,174.17	19,140	2.78
Wyoming	124	74	59.6	6,137.05	1,900	3.23
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	117	65	55.5	4,296.97	1,495	2.87
Bahama Islands	8	4	50.0	400.00	129	3.10
Virgin Islands of U.S.	10	9	90.0	2,218.12	238	9.32
Bermuda	19	0	0	—	165	—
TOTAL for U.S.	38,276	21,696	56.7%	\$3,239,664.59	775,040	\$4.18

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alberta	455	212	46.5%	\$ 50,854.06	5,951	\$8.55
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	169	89	52.6	13,556.86	2,139	6.34
Newfoundland	101	38	37.6	4,176.71	871	4.80
Nova Scotia	154	75	48.7	8,791.74	1,925	4.57
Prince Edward Island	69	33	47.8	3,056.47	1,201	2.54
Labrador	2	0	0.0	—	37	—
British Columbia	629	336	53.4	60,864.73	9,252	6.58
Manitoba	153	70	45.7	9,579.00	3,517	2.72
N.W. Territories	26	6	23.0	642.49	265	2.42
Ontario	1,163	520	44.7	118,437.14	21,224	5.58
Quebec	1,402	1,018	72.6 ①	200,254.83	27,563	7.27
Saskatchewan	323	191	59.1	20,347.51	3,998	5.09
Yukon Territory	8	3	37.5	462.17	114	4.05
TOTAL for (Canadian CANADA dollars)	4,654	2,591 ①	55.6%	491,023.71	78,057	6.29 ①
(converted to U.S. dollars \$				376,271.47		\$4.82)
TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars)	42,930	24,287 ①	56.6%	\$3,615,936.06	853,097	\$4.24 ①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Birds of a Feather				119.09		
Correctional facility groups				21.00		
Foreign				17,435.06		
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				15,000.00		
International Doctors in A.A.				589.00		
International Lawyers in A.A.				1,511.31		
Internationalists				225.00		
Loners				1,438.18		
Treatment facility meetings				287.92		
World Hello				67.37		
GRAND TOTAL				\$3,652,629.99		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1987-1986 (IN U.S. DOLLARS)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1987	38,276	21,696	56.7%	\$3,239,664.59	775,040	\$4.18
U.S. 1986	36,002	18,666	51.8	2,402,836.54	727,145	3.30
Increase						
(Decrease)	2,274	3,030	4.9%	\$ 836,828.05	47,895	\$.88
Canada 1987	4,654	2,591 ①	55.6% ①	\$ 376,271.47	78,057	\$4.82 ①
Canada 1986	4,540	2,455 ①	54.1 ①	242,936.85	76,377	3.18 ①
Increase						
(Decrease)	114	136	1.5%	\$ 133,334.62	1,680	\$1.64
U.S. and Canada 1987	42,930	24,287 ①	56.6% ①	\$3,615,936.06	853,097	\$4.24 ①
U.S. and Canada 1986	40,542	21,121 ①	52.1 ①	2,645,773.39	803,522	3.29 ①
Increase						
(Decrease)	2,388	3,166	4.5%	\$ 970,162.67	49,575	\$.95



1988 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Jack Allison
Sandra Fox
¹Rita Jourdan
Ray Lynch
²Art McCord
Roger Mansfield
Bill Miller
Bob Watkins

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Finance

Beth Bowen
Gerry Flegel
¹Michael Fleming
Irv Hanson
Bobby Hobson
Jim Kenna
Dave Smoot
²Bruce Sutherland

Secretary: Ed Gordon

Policy/Admissions

Jack Cawkwell
Maxine Cramer
¹Denis Doyle
²Rege Flannery
Richard Gadoury
Marge Koch
Dick Rowell
Herb Wales

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Treatment Facilities

²Dale Abbas
Mary Beaudry
John Dunn
Joyce Korner
¹Tom Lichwa
Jim Schneck
Bill Sears
Frank Shea

Secretary: John Grant

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Louise Adams
²Hal Carty
Lucille Gifford
¹Michael Goldsmith
John MacDonald
Victor Rosario
George Sehon
Bill Smeal

Secretary: Cheryl Burke-Hughes

Grapevine

Terry Anderson
Diane Faulconer
Leo Gregory
Katherine Guy
Paul Hart
Becky Hathaway
²Chester Norton
¹Dean Rinehart
Arv Straatmeyer

Secretary: Ames Sweet

Public Information

Bonita Anselmo
Jim Ball
Micheline Duberger
Ken Gray
¹Larry Midworth
Larry Nelson
²Sam Parsons
Ernie Truax

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Trustees

Vern Bryce
Bacon Cravens
Elizabeth Currier
¹Denis Foster
Tom Heidler
Scott Johnson
Tim Martin
²Pete Peterson
Bubs Trahan

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

Correctional Facilities

Sylvia Abraham
²Joseph Clement
Bill Griffiths
Jake Ham
¹Al Hendricks
Carl McDonald
Bob Stenberg
Red Walker

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Literature

Dennis Daley
Gay Garner
Real McIntyre
Jim Magee
Ed Minarik
²Dick Pickens
¹Louise Robertson
Ben Williams
Larry Yarrington

Secretary: Lyla Bonney

Report and Charter

Dave Allen
²Ann Bruning
Simonne Clutts
¹Greg Muth
Gerry Ouellette
George Reid
Bob Watt
Judy Whitehouse

Secretary: Eileen Gatz

1995 International Convention Site-Selection Committee

Terry Anderson
Ann Bruning
Micheline Duberger
Gerry Flegel

Bobby Hobson
Jim Kenna
Tom Lichwa
Ed Minarik

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

NEW CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Conference Agenda	Bill Miller, Vermont	Roger Mansfield, W. Michigan
Cooperation With the Professional Community	John MacDonald, S.W. Quebec	Bill Smeal, Nebraska
Correctional Facilities	Jake Ham, Maine	Carl McDonald, Mississippi
Finance	Gerry Flegel, Saskatchewan	Irv Hanson, Idaho
Grapevine	Leo Gregory, W. New York	Arvid Straatmeyer, South Dakota
Literature	Dennis Daley, N. Illinois	Gay Garner, Georgia
Conference Policy/Admissions	Dick Rowell, Maryland	Richard Gadoury, N.W. Quebec
Public Information	Larry Nelson, San Diego/Imperial	Kenneth Gray, S.W. Ohio
Conference Report and Charter	Gerry Ouellette, W. Massachusetts	Simonne Clutts, Alaska
Treatment Facilities	Jim Schneck, N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan	John Dunn, Arizona
Committee on Trustees	Tom Heidler, Kansas	Betty Currier, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

1988 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Thomas Hills, *chairperson*
Laurance Allen
Dan Byrne
John Ford
Harold Greene
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Joseph Rhoads
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., *ex officio*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Ruth Jagodzinski, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Dan Byrne
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Webb Johnson
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
James Shannon
Jan Williamson
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
John King
Don Pritts
Amos Reed
James Shannon
John Sharkey
John Smith, M.D.
John Whitehouse
Cheryl Burke-Hughes, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Amos Reed, *chairperson*
Dan Byrne
Harold Greene
William Kubinski
Don Pritts
James Shannon
Jean Smith
Hylan Sperbeck
Jan Williamson
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
William Croke
Gary Glynn
Harold Greene
Joe Phelan
Shepherd Raimi
Amos Reed
Joseph Rhoads
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Jean Smith
Desmond Towey
John Whitehouse
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Edward Gordon, *secretary*

International

Don Pritts, *chairperson*
Laurance Allen
Dan Byrne
William Flynn, M.D.
John Ford
Webb Johnson
Amos Reed
John Sharkey
John Smith, M.D.
John Whitehouse
Sarah Price, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

John Ford, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Thomas Hills
Ruth Jagodzinski
Webb Johnson
Jan Williamson
Shepherd Raimi
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*
— *International Convention*
Eileen Gatz, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

John King, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
William Croke
Webb Johnson
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Jean Smith
John Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Jan Williamson
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Lyla Bonney, *secretary*

Nominating

Shepherd Raimi, *chairperson*
William Flynn, M.D.
John Ford
Thomas Hills
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Ruth Jagodzinski
John King
Joe Phelan
John Whitehouse
Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Public Information

William Croke, *chairperson*
Sam Elfert
Jill Hargrave
Renata Karlin
Edward McDougal
Don Pritts
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Jane Schulberg
John Sharkey
Desmond Towey
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., *chairperson*
James Ahern
Laurance Allen
William Flynn, M.D.
Hugh Freyer
Joe Phelan
Joseph Rhoads
John Sharkey
John Smith, M.D.
John Grant, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Dan Byrne, *chairperson*
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Gordon Patrick and John Bragg are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Gordon Patrick
First vice-chairperson
William E. Flynn, M.D.
Second vice-chairperson
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Secretary
John R. Ford
Treasurer
Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
Susan Ulseth
Assistant treasurer
Edward H. Gordon
The new slate of officers
(post-Conference)
is given on page 38.

1988 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Gordon M. Patrick (P.O. Box 774, Kingston, ON K7L 4X6, Canada) was elected to the board in 1975 and became its chairperson in 1982. Recently retired, he was a management consultant with a special interest in helping organizations develop programs for employees disabled by alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he has a continuing interest in employee assistance programs and professional education. A longtime friend of A.A., he considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

Michael Alexander (460 Park Ave., New York, NY 10022) was elected chairperson of the board at the board meeting following the 1988 Conference. Mike served as a trustee from 1976 to 1985, after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce and past president of the Consular Law Society.

William E. Flynn, M.D. (125 Daleview Dr., McLean, VA 22101) joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he is currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse. He also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital in Virginia. Bill chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the Nominating, International and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served on many local, state and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, she was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. She chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and is a member of the Archives, Conference and Nominating Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and Nominating Committees, and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Robert P. Morse (96 Cove Rd., Oyster Bay, NY 11771) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee from April 1981. A graduate of the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 18 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert is president of Morse Williams & Co., Inc., investment counsels, and is chairperson of the Wall Street Fund, a public mutual fund. He is also treasurer and an executive committee trustee of the Bermuda Biological Station for Research, Inc. Robert is chairperson of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies and has received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the International, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, B.C. V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. He is also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine and part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International, Literature and Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Donald J. Bruner (6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1988. Don has been active in area activities from home group to intergroup board member, and served as Panel 33 Conference delegate. He was trained as a civil engineer and was an officer of an international construction company and has served on the boards of several construction and engineering companies. Don is now retired.

Dan M. Byrne (2900 19th Ave., Marion, IA 52302) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1984. He has a background of group and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. He is currently employed by the Quaker Oats Cereal Company in Cedar Rapids, Iowa. Dan chairs the General Sharing Session and also serves on the trustees' Archives, Conference, Correctional Facilities and International Committees.

Phil J. Cels (5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, Manitoba, Canada R7A 6E5), who was elected Western Canada trustee in April 1988, served as a Panel 32 Conference delegate. He is involved in C.P.C. and P.I. work for Southwest Manitoba, as well as being active in local A.A. activities. For the past 12 years Phil has been an account executive with a brokerage house.

William H. (Bill) Croke (165 Perry Ave., Norwalk, CT 06850) was elected general service trustee in April 1986. He has been active in group service since 1970 and has served as A.A.W.S. director since 1983. Bill's background is in advertising/marketing, and he is currently a partner in a small advertising agency in New York City. Bill chairs the Public Information Committee and has been a member of that committee since 1976. He also serves on the Finance and Literature Committees and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹**John R. (Jack) Ford** (3092 West King Edward, Vancouver, B.C., Canada V6L 1V5) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1984. He has been active in group, intergroup, and area service; as a Panel 29 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. He is owner of an auto sales and service center. Jack chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Tom Hills (48 McGregor Road, Scarborough, ON M1P 1C8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1986. Tom has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. A former director of Ontario's Employees Benefits Branch, in 1985 he was chairperson of the Canadian Public Service Pension Advisors. Currently he is senior advisor to Ontario's Management Board of Cabinet on Public Service Pensions. Tom serves on the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Ruth C. Jagodzinski (2934 S. Lindell Rd., Las Vegas, NV 89102), elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1986, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. Ruth's background is in the home-health-care and nursing fields; she co-owns and administers a home-health-care program. She is a member of the governor's Advisory Board for Alcohol and Drug Abuse and vice-president of the We Care Foundation board of directors (a small rehabilitation house for alcoholic women). Ruth chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson (1105 Palmerston Ave., West Vancouver, BC V7S 2J5, Canada), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1987, has served his area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area treasurer, and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. Currently, Webb is a member of the finance committee for British Columbia/Yukon. A former stock broker and broker dealer, Webb is currently president of NTV Oil Services Industries, Inc. and director of U.C.A. Technologies, Inc. A golfer, Webb is also a member of the American Contract Bridge League. He serves on the Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums, International and Literature Committees.

¹**Joe Phelan** (272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328), elected Southeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1985, has been active in group and area service. As a Panel 30 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. Joe served on the Georgia Task Force on Alcohol, Marijuana, and Other Drugs and was president of the Metro Atlanta Council on Alcoholism. Now retired, his background is in the finance, marketing, and investment banking fields. Joe is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Nominating and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Don I. Pritts (1009 S. Lewiston Way, Aurora, CO 80017) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S., in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A part-time volunteer for adolescent treatment units, Don has been an employment counselor. Currently he is a sales director for the Conklin Company, establishing and training franchise holders. Don chairs the International Committee and serves on the Public Information, Correctional Facilities and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees.

Shepherd Raimi (1040 Park Avenue, New York, N.Y. 10028), elected general service trustee in April 1985, is an active member

of the Red Hook Group in Red Hook, N.Y. A native of Michigan, he is a lawyer in New York City, and has had a great deal of experience with the impaired lawyer and other aspects of law and alcoholism. Shep chairs the Nominating Committee and is also a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Finance Committees and the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹**Ralph Rosenberg Jr.** (410 West 24th St., New York, N.Y. 10011), elected general service trustee in April 1984, remains active in group and intergroup service. He has been a writer for radio and TV and is now employed in the advertising field. Ralph has served on the Grapevine Editorial Board and currently is a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He also is a member of the Public Information, Conference, Literature, and Finance Committees.

James Shannon (3106 Kingsbridge Ave., Bronx, NY 10463), elected general service trustee in April 1985, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service. He was a Panel 27 Conference delegate for Southeast New York and has been involved with the Grapevine, Public Information, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees as well as the S.E.N.Y. area convention. Jim worked as a supervisor at a management consulting firm and is now retired. He serves as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board and a member of the Correctional, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Conference Committees.

John A. Sharkey (9 Valley Way, West Orange, NJ 07052). Elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, John is a past area chairperson and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. He currently serves on the Essex County Alcoholism Advisory Board and was trustee of his intergroup committee. John, who owned and operated a tavern for seven years, is supply coordinator with New Jersey Bell Telephone Company. He is a member of the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees.

²**J. Desmond Towey** (115 East 86th St., New York, NY 10028) was elected general service trustee in April 1988. Des's introduction to service work was as a consultant on the trustees' Public Information Committee. He is a member of the Grapevine editorial board, serves as a Grapevine director, and has served on the trustees' Literature, Finance, Correctional Facilities and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees. He is owner and president of a firm specializing in shareholder relations and marketing financial products.

John R. (Jack) Whitehouse (2981 Lakeview Dr., Sanford, MI 48657) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 (Central Michigan, Area 32) Conference delegate. A practicing attorney for 30 years, he now serves as a mediator for the Workers' Disability Compensation Bureau for the State of Michigan's Department of Labor. Jack is chairperson of the Grapevine Corporate Board and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Finance and Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Jan Kelly Williamson (3208 Lampliter, El Paso, TX 79925), elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, has been active in her area's intergroup and in the Southwest Regional Delegate Assembly; she was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. A retired executive secretary, Jan serves on the boards of several local and state associations that deal with alcohol and drug abuse. Jan is primarily involved with local A.A. and her four grandchildren. She serves on the Conference, Literature, Correctional Facilities and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

¹ Retiring at the close of the 1988 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, April 30, 1988.

³ New chairperson of board, approved by the board at meeting following close of Conference.

A.A. World Services Directors

Joe Phelan, *chairperson*
John Bragg
William Croke
Harold Greene
Ruth Jagodzinski

Shepherd Raimi
Joseph Rhoads
Jean Smith
Susan Ulseth

A.A. Grapevine Directors

John Whitehouse, *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Laurance Allen
Thomas Hills
John King

Ralph Rosenberg, Jr.
Jim Shannon
Ames Sweet
Desmond Towey
Ann Warner

General Service Office Staff

John Bragg, *general manager*
Lyla Bonney
Cheryl Burke-Hughes
Lois Fisher
Eileen Gatzia
John Grant
Betty Liddle

Curtis Monahan
Sarah Price
Helen Turnquest
Susan Ulseth
Tom Jasper, *services director*
Frank Mauser, *archivist*
Vicente Mejia, *Spanish services*

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet Ann Warner

Others Assisting at the Conference (nonvoting)

G.S.O./Grapevine Personnel

Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
Ed Brady, *steno/clerical department*
Shelian Bryant, *steno/clerical department*
Joseph Dennon, *steno/clerical department*
John de Stefano, *editor*
Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Elizabeth Garcia, *manager, steno/clerical department*
Edward Gordon, *director of finance/business administrator*
Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
Robert Hiltzley, *steno/clerical department*
Margie Janicek, *steno/clerical department*
Madeline Jordan, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller*
Steve Linek, *purchasing department*
Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
Jim McConnell, *designer, Conference Report*
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
Miledy Martinez, *steno/clerical department*
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller/business administrator*
Nancy Moore, *editor*
John Nayduch, *Grapevine art director*
Carol Nielsen, *records department*
Tony Osnato, *office manager/events coordinator*
Elsie Oxman, *purchasing department*
Eve Ponzio, *steno/clerical department*
Ivelisse Rivera, *steno/clerical department*
Frank Segui, *steno/clerical department*
Darlene Smith, *steno/clerical department*
Joan Smith, *steno/clerical department*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
Shirley Sykes, *steno/clerical department*
Cynthia White, *steno/clerical department*
Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeriti

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D. John L. Norris, M.D.

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees are encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. They are also encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 38th Conference includes Panel 37 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 38 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

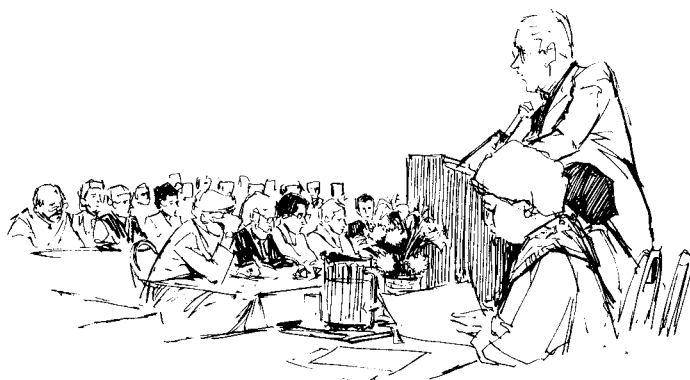
State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	37	Katherine F. Guy, 104 Guy Hollow Ln., Opelika, AL 36801
Alaska	2	38	Simonne Clutts, Box 154, Anchor Point, AK 99556
Arizona	3	38	John H. Dunn, 7080 W. Bopp Rd., Tucson, AZ 85746
Arkansas	4	37	Ann Bruning, 10728 Hunters Pt., Fort Smith, AR 72903
California Southern	5	37	Allen Hendricks, 4205 Deacon Rd., Bakersfield, CA 93307
Northern Coastal	6	37	Michael Goldsmith, 148 Saturn St., #3, San Francisco, CA 94114
Northern Interior	7	38	Tim Martin, 2600 Queenswood Dr., Rancho Cordova, CA 95670
San Diego/Imperial	8	38	Larry Nelson, 854 "A" Hollister St., San Diego, CA 92154
Mid-Southern	9	38	Maxine Cramer, 423 N. Emily St., Anaheim, CA 92805
Colorado	10	37	Bruce Sutherland, Box 1277, Basalt, CO 81621
Connecticut	11	37	Louise A. Adams, 49 Bette Circle, Vernon, CT 06066
Delaware	12	38	James Magee, Box 185, Ocean View, DE 19970
District of Columbia	13	37	David B. Smoot, 8500 Oak Dr., Brandywine, MD 20613
Florida North	14	37	Richard B. Pickens, 8000 Bay Meadows Circle E., #37, Jacksonville, FL 32216
South	15	37	Hal Carty, 607 West Palm Ave., Punta Gorda, FL 33950-5445
Georgia	16	38	Gay Garner, 528 Hammett Dr., Decatur, GA 30032
Hawaii	17	37	Greg Muth, 48-500 Kamehameha Hwy., Kaneohe, HI 96744

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	38	Irv Hanson, 744 Tenth, Idaho Falls, ID 83404	Missouri Eastern	38	37	Rita Jourdan, 404 Michael, Wentzville, MO 63385
Illinois Chicago	19	37	Beth Bowen, 6705 N. Greenview, Chicago, IL 60626	Western	39	37	Marilyn Parsons, 112 Brentwood, Liberty, MO 64068
Northern	20	38	Dennis Daley, 3903 John St., McHenry, IL 60050	Montana	40	38	Edward Minarik, 714 W. Thrush Ln., Glendive, MT 59330
Southern	21	37	James Cravens, 75 Montgomery Circle, Carmi, IL 62821	Nebraska	41	38	Bill Smeal, Box 62, Snyder, NE 68664
Indiana Northern	22	37	Benjamin H. Williams, 4126 E. Sixth Ave., Gary, IN 46403	Nevada	42	37	Louise Robertson, 608 Saylor Way, Las Vegas, NV 89107
Southern	23	38	Bobby J. Hobson, 303 S. Airport Rd., Seymour, IN 47274	New Hampshire	43	38	Lucille M. Gifford, 124 Mammoth Rd., A-3, Hookset, NH 03106
Iowa	24	37	Dale Abbas, 1103 58th St., Des Moines, IA 50311	New Jersey Northern	44	37	Tom Lichwa, 1410 E. Oak Tree Dr., North Brunswick, NJ 08902
Kansas	25	38	Tom Heidler, 10243 Conser, Overland Park, KS 66212	Southern	45	38	Bonita M. Anselmo, Box 443, Pleasantville, NJ 08232
Kentucky	26	38	Paul Hart, 1554 Meadow Hill Ct., Florence, KY 41042	New Mexico	46	38	Ernest L. Truax, 7017 Edwina N.E., Albuquerque, NM 87110
Louisiana	27	37	Richard Trahan, 3215 Landfair, Lake Charles, LA 70601	New York Central	47	37	Robert Watt, 41 Westminster Rd., Rochester, NY 14607
Maine	28	38	Jacob B. Ham, RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364	Hudson/Mohawk /Berkshire	48	38	Elizabeth Currier, Box 201, West Winfield, NY 13491
Maryland	29	38	Dick Rowell, 18 Carvel Circle, Edgewater, MD 21037	Southeast	49	37	Michael R. Fleming, 40-33 W. Fourth St., Patchogue, NY 11772
Massachusetts Eastern	30	37	John S. Allison, Jr., 110 Parker Rd., Needham, MA 02194	Western	50	38	Leo A. Gregory, 48 Park Blvd., Lancaster, NY 14086
Western	31	38	Gerard Ouellette, 10 Belvidere St., Springfield, MA 01108	North Carolina/ Bermuda	51	37	William Sears, 338 First Ave. S.W., Taylorsville, NC 28681
Michigan Central	32	37	Judith R. Whitehouse, 2981 Lakeview Dr., Sanford, MI 48657	North Dakota	52	38	R.B. (Bob) Stenberg, RR1, Lake Metigoshe, Bottineau, ND 58318
Southeastern	33	37	Joseph Clement, 12247 E. Ten Mile Rd., Warren, MI 48089	Ohio Central & Southeast	53	37	Marjorie Koch, 1706 B Lakeview Dr., Newark, OH 43055
Western	34	38	Roger Mansfield, 242 Ives S.E., Grand Rapids, MI 49504	Northeast	54	37	Joyce Korner, 1204 Hall, Lakewood, OH 44107
Minnesota Northern	35	38	Laurel Johnson, 209 S. First St. W., Aurora, MN 55705	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	55	38	Rebekah Hathaway, Box 145, Woodville, OH 43469
Southern	36	37	Jack Cawkwell, 1988 Longfellow Ave., St. Paul, MN 55119	Southwest	56	38	Kenneth O. Gray, Box 284, Waynesville, OH 45068
Mississippi	37	38	Carl McDonald, 5859 Ferncreek Dr., Jackson, MS 39211	Oklahoma	57	37	Dean Rinehart, 613 Matthews, El Reno, OK 73036
				Oregon	58	38	Ray Lynch, 3404 N.E. Tillamook St., Portland, OR 97212

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	59	37	William Griffiths, 501-C Edmunds Ave., Drexel Hill, PA 19026
<i>Western</i>	60	37	Regis Flannery, 212 Ormsby Ave., Pittsburgh, PA 15210
Rhode Island	61	38	Mary Beaudry, 54 Beach St., Coventry, RI 02816
South Carolina	62	38	James Kenna, 111 Axtel Dr., Summerville, SC 29483
South Dakota	63	38	Arvid Straatmeyer, 610 Garfield, R-4, Lennox, SD 57039
Tennessee	64	38	R. David Allen, 108 N. Greenwood St., Lebanon, TN 37087
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	37	Edmund Peterson, 4557 N. O'Conner Rd. #1281, Irving, TX 75062
<i>Northwest</i>	66	38	Herbert V. Wales, Box 3834, Midland, TX 79702
<i>Southeast</i>	67	37	George Sehon, Rte. 4, Box T-63, Beaumont, TX 77705
<i>Southwest</i>	68	38	Larry Yarrington, Box 208, La Coste, TX 78039
Utah	69	37	Terry Anderson, 3065 W. 8600 South, West Jordan, UT 84088
Vermont	70	38	William G. Miller, Box 23, Townshend, VT 05353
Virginia	71	37	James L. Ball, Madison #1, Presidential Apts., Marion, VA 24354-4433
Washington	72	37	Denis Foster, 1823 10th Ave. W., Seattle, WA 98119
West Virginia	73	37	Robert S. Watkins, 713-A Main St., Charleston, WV 25302
Wisconsin			
<i>N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.</i>	74	38	James M. Schneck, 3833 Carl St., Wausau, WI 54401
<i>Southern</i>	75	37	Larry Midworth, Rte. 1, Box 24, Merrimac, WI 53561
Wyoming	76	38	Sandra Fox, 2309 Milatzo, Cheyenne, WY 82007
Puerto Rico	77	38	Victor Rosario, Box 823, Manati, PR 00701

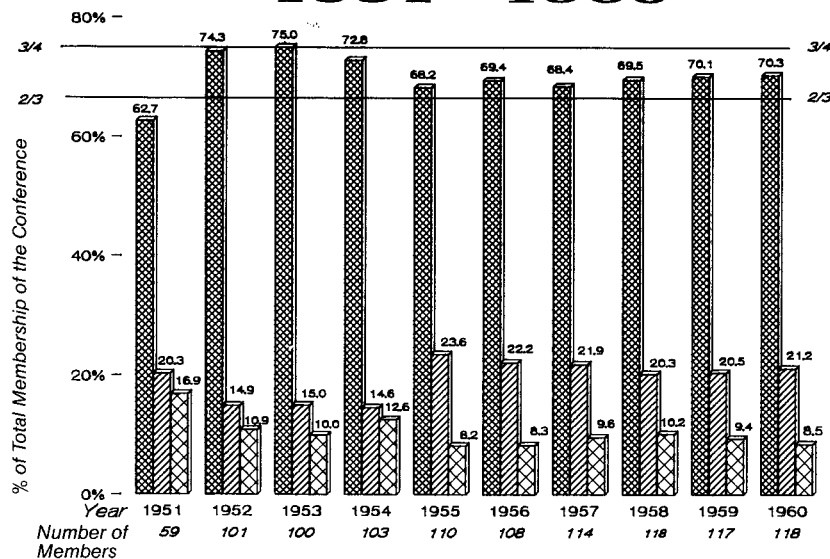
CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta / Northwest Territories	78	38	Red Walker, 1504-10140 113th St., Edmonton, AB T5K 2H7
British Columbia / Yukon	79	37	Chester Norton, Box 724, Vedder Crossing, BC V0X 1Z0
Manitoba	80	38	Vern Bryce, 768 Berkley Ave., Winnipeg, MB R3R 1K3
New Brunswick / Prince Edward Island	81	38	George Reid, Box 3354, Charlottetown, PE C1A 8W4
Nova Scotia / Newfoundland / Labrador	82	37	Sylvia Abraham, 2817 Connolly St., Halifax, NS B3M 3N3
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	37	Denis Doyle, RD #1, Bombay, NY 12914
<i>Northeast</i>	84	37	Art McCord, 24 MacDonald Ct., Elliott Lake, ON P5A 2V2
<i>Northwest</i>	85	37	Diane Faulconer, 403 Ray Blvd., Thunder Bay, ON P7B 4E7
<i>Western</i>	86	38	Frank Shea, 140 Danforth, Leamington, ON N8H 2R2
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	38	John MacDonald, Box 111, St. Laurent, PQ H4L 4V4
<i>Southeast</i>	88	37	Real McIntyre, 326 Sanatorium, Mont-Joli, PQ G5H 1V7
<i>Northeast</i>	89	37	Micheline Duberger, 903 Senneterre, Ste.-Foy, PQ G1X 3Y2
<i>Northwest</i>	90	38	Richard Gadoury, B.P. 531, Piedmont, PQ J0R 1K0
Saskatchewan	91	38	Gerry Flegel, Box 1246, Humboldt, SK S0K 2A0

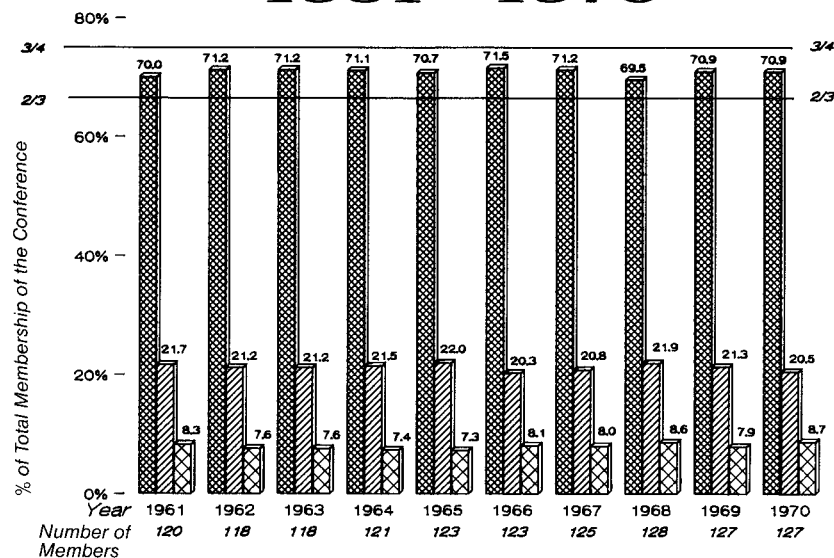


CONFERENCE MEMBERSHIP – 1951 to 1988

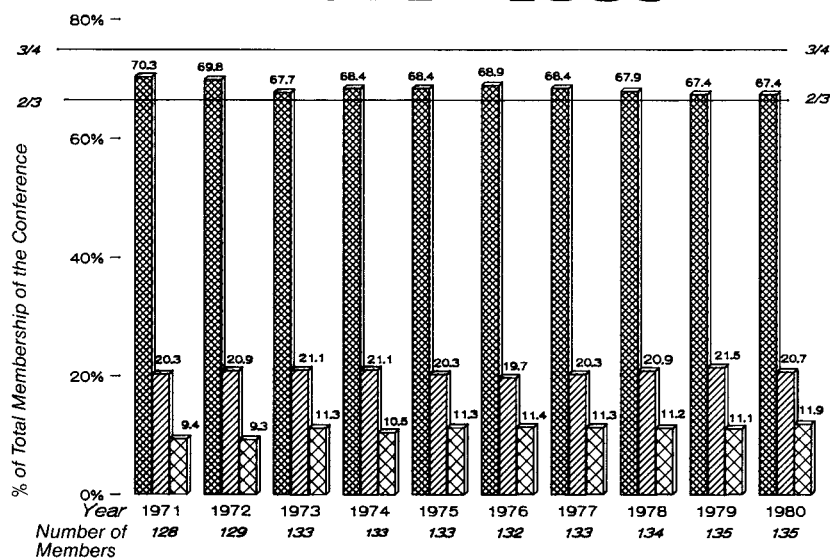
1951 - 1960



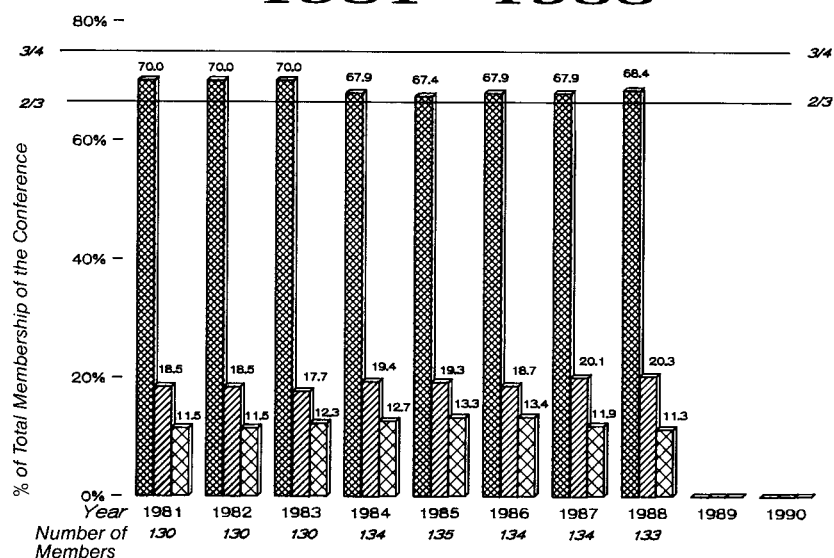
1961 - 1970



1971 - 1980



1981 - 1988



PERCENTAGE OF DELEGATES, BOARDS, STAFFS



Delegates



Board



Staffs